Regulation (EU) 2022/2065

Digital Services Act (DSA)

Systemic Risk Assessment and Mitigation Report for Facebook

August 2025

Table of Contents

Executive Summary

Meta's mission is to build the future of human connection and the technology that makes it possible. We help people discover and learn about what is going on in the world around them, enable people to share their experiences, ideas, photos and videos, and other activities with audiences ranging from their closest family members and accounts that they follow (or are a friend of) to the public at large, and stay connected everywhere by accessing our products.[1] For the 6-month period ending 31 December 2024, we had approximately 261.6 million average monthly active users on Facebook in the European Union (EU) who are reaping the benefits of connectedness.[2]

Although Facebook has been used to build communities, raise awareness, and grow small businesses, the risk remains for our services to be, in some instances, misused and manipulated. We take a risk-based approach for implementing mitigation measures to combat bad actors, behaviour, and content on Facebook. We refer to our collective work combating bad actors, behaviours, and content on Facebook as "Integrity Ecosystem" efforts, and the specific mitigating measures we deploy as "controls".[3] The backbone of our Integrity Ecosystem is our suite of Content Policies, specifically our Community Standards, Advertising Standards, and Commerce Policies, which outline what is and is not allowed on Facebook.[4,5,6] Meta employs a Three Lines of Defence (LoD) model to help effectively identify and manage risks, ensure accountability across our business functions, and enable risk-based decision making across Meta.

DSA Systemic Risk Assessment Overview

Meta Platforms Ireland Limited, as the provider of Facebook in the EU, has conducted its 2025 Systemic Risk Assessment ("Year 3 Assessment") for Facebook in accordance with Article 34 of the Digital Services Act (DSA). This document ("Report") sets out the results of the Year 3 Assessment for the period between 1 September 2024 and 31 August 2025. The data collection period was 18 May 2024 - 31 March 2025.

Any risks that are identified or mitigations that are implemented after this data collection period will be captured through next year's Systemic Risk Assessment. This includes additional mitigations such as:

- further recalibrations of Meta's enforcement strategy to address the risks of over-enforcement;
- introducing Teen Accounts on Facebook to provide further protections for minors[7];
- providing additional user education materials and tools to help users avoid scams.[8]

This also includes the launch of new products in the region, such as the introduction of Meta AI features to Facebook.

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[1] https://www.meta.com/about/company-info/
[2] Regulation (EU) 2022/2065 Digital Services Act Transparency Report for Facebook (October - December 2024)
[3] Controls are a combination of people, processes, policies, and tools that Meta has put in place to mitigate integrity risks and prevent, detect, or correct integrity issues. Controls include any system, process, policy, device, practice, or other actions which reduce the likelihood or impact of a given risk occurring.
[4] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/policies/community-standards/
[5] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards
[6] https://www.facebook.com/policies_center/commerce
[7] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/04/introducing-new-built-in-restrictions-instagram-teen-accounts-expanding-facebook-messenger/
[8] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/05/avoiding-investment-payment-scams-online/

We will release a public version of this Report.

Our Risk Assessment Methodology follows a phased approach to identify, assess, measure, validate, respond to, mitigate, and report on risks.

Meta's Content Policies, which include our Community Standards, Advertising Standards, and Commerce Policies, address various Systemic Risk Areas. To better align with Meta's risk categorisation approach, we have further divided these Systemic Risk Areas into more specific categories, which we refer to as 'Problem Areas.[9] For more detailed information, please refer to Section 4: Systemic Risk Landscape.

Meta continuously evolves our practices to respond to the evolving risk landscape and regulatory environment. Meta’s Integrity Governance, Risk, and Compliance (“Integrity GRC”) Programme and EU Integrity Compliance Office (ICO) provide ongoing risk governance and oversight of Meta’s services, systems, and processes.

Our Risk Assessment Process consists of six steps and is applied in our annual Systemic Risk Assessment. We have designed and implemented this process by leveraging guidance and standards relevant to integrity risks in the EU, such as ISO 31000:2018 and the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights. [10,11]

Key Enhancements

For the Year 3 Assessment, Meta made several methodology enhancements to improve the accuracy, consistency, and utility of the assessment. These improvements reflect lessons learned from previous assessments, informal feedback from the European Commission including via Request for Information (RFIs) and engagements, gathering external stakeholder feedback, and the evolving regulatory and risk environment. The most significant updates include:

1. **Refinements to the Integrity Risk Taxonomy:** In Year 3, we refined the Integrity Risk Taxonomy to better align with the platform violations as stated in the Community Standards. This has allowed us to be more precise when assessing the risks, as we can directly apply the enforcement data for policy-violating content to the risks in our Taxonomy. As part of the refinements, we reduced the number of individual risks from 122 in the 2024 Systemic Risk Assessment (“Year 2 Assessment”) to 71 in the Year 3 Assessment by consolidating similar risks into fewer categories based on the category of violation. Though the risks have been consolidated, this shift has enabled more precise measurement due to the direct linkage to the Community Standards violations for each risk. We also increased the number of Problem Areas from 19 to 22 to better align to the revised risks. For example, we created new Problem Areas for *Violent and Graphic Content*, *Spam*, and *Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language*. The risks within these new Problem Areas were assessed in Year 2, but under broader categories. This reclassification reflects a more granular and precise approach to risk identification and management.

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[9] These Problem Areas map to our Facebook Community Standards and may vary in naming convention.
[10] https://www.iso.org/standard/65694.html
[11] https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/documents/publications/guidingprinciplesbusinesshr_en.pdf

2. **Systemic Risk Landscape Updates:** As part of our efforts to enhance our Risk Assessment Process, we reassessed the mappings between Problem Areas and the eight (8) Systemic Risk Areas defined by the DSA. These changes were informed by external stakeholder feedback, internal cross-functional consultation, and updates to our Integrity Risk Taxonomy, ensuring alignment with the DSA while building on Meta's longstanding commitment to assessing real-world risks. In Year 3, we mapped four Problem Areas—including *Bullying and Harassment*, *Hateful Conduct*, *Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language*, and *Violent and Graphic Content*—to the *Fundamental Rights* Systemic Risk Area to better reflect the link between platform risks and users' rights. Other Problem Areas with mapping updates to Systemic Risk Areas in Year 3 include *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity*, *Coordinating Harm and Promoting Crime*, *Discriminatory Practices*, *Restricted Goods and Services*, *and Violent and Graphic Content*. Details can be found in the Section 4: Systemic Risk Landscape.
3. **Inherent Risk Framework Improvements:** We have updated our inherent risk rubrics to enable a more unified and data-informed perspective. Our likelihood assessments now more consistently integrate key factors, including the proportion of Monthly Active Users (MAU) in the EU online population, as well as enforcement trends and subject matter expert input to determine volume.
4. **Control Effectiveness Methodology Updates:** During the Year 3 Assessment, we have expanded our control effectiveness evaluation framework by incorporating a more comprehensive range of qualitative and quantitative data points. We have also updated our methodology for aggregating control effectiveness scores to now consider the additive impact of all relevant controls for each risk. This enhancement allows us to assess the value of adding new controls.

These methodology enhancements have enabled more consistent risk understanding and directly inform internal strategic investment and prioritisation.

Risk Results Overview

Although the updated methodology introduced greater variation in scores, many Problem Areas remained stable in residual risk tiers year-over-year. Areas such as *Human Exploitation* and *Dangerous Organisations and Individuals* remained in Tier 2, reflecting the continued impact of mature controls and targeted mitigation strategies. For eight (8) Problem Areas, the underlying risks changed significantly from Year 2, impacting the ability to make reliable year-over-year comparisons. For example, the *Adult Sexual Exploitation* Problem Area is now distinct from the *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity* Problem Area to better account for the difference in severity between the two areas. In prior years, these were one Problem Area, *Adult Sexual Exploitation and Adult Nudity*. As the Year 3 Problem Areas of *Adult Sexual Exploitation* and *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity* have different risks and risk scores, they are incomparable to the one Problem Area from Year 1 and Year 2.

Where residual risk tiers increased from last year—such as in *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity*, *Fraud and Deception*, *Intellectual Property (IP) Infringement*, *Misinformation*, *Privacy Violations*, *Voice and Free Expression*, *Restricted Goods and Services,* and *Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders (SSIED)*—the shifts were driven by a combination of refined risk measurement inputs and/or the control environment.

Looking ahead, our goal is to not only mature in our ability to assess Systemic Risks but also to act on that understanding through reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigation of risks—strengthening our ability to fulfil our obligations under the DSA and uphold the fundamental rights of users across the EU.

Inherent Risk Shifts

The methodological improvements significantly impacted the assessment of inherent risk, leading to a rebalancing of scores across several Problem Areas. The adjustments in taxonomy, data inputs, and classification logic, resulted in more precise measurements for Year 3, but it also limits direct comparability with Year 2 inherent risk scores. For example, minor nudity, which includes less severe violations like a parent posting a photo of a minor in a bathtub, is now categorised as lower risk, which reduces the inherent risk of the *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity area*. In some cases, the shift in inherent risk was also due to the evolving risk environment.

Control Effectiveness Shifts

In Year 3, the precision of control effectiveness assessments improved due to the incorporation of additional qualitative and quantitative data, allowing for more nuanced evaluations but also leading to greater variation in assessed control environments across risks. Notable changes were observed in the *Voice and Free Expression* and *Fraud and Deception* areas, with control effectiveness declining due to identification of increased false positives and limitations in our ability to proactively detect scams and violating networks, respectively. The *SSIED* area saw an increase in residual risk from Tier 2 to Tier 3, partly due to limitations identified in the control environment.

In many cases, observed changes in control effectiveness scores are due, not to actual changes in the underlying controls, but rather to improved data availability and more refined estimation approaches compared to prior years. As a result, direct year-over-year comparability is limited, as score shifts may reflect improved measurement rather than true improvement or deterioration. Meta has implemented new and enhanced controls designed to improve overall effectiveness, with ongoing efforts to address identified issues while respecting users' human rights. Some enhancements that have been implemented since we finished our analysis and scoring for this assessment can be found in Section 6: Risk Mitigation Enhancements.

Residual Risk Shifts

While many residual risk tiers remained stable year-over-year, some residual risk scores show a general increase from Year 2, which we attribute mostly to refinements in risk measurement and deliberate accuracy adjustments to our control effectiveness methodology rather than actual changes in risk exposure. *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity*, *Fraud and Deception*, *Inauthentic Behaviour, IP Infringement, Misinformation, Voice and Free Expression, Account Integrity and Authentic Identity, and SSIED*, increased in residual risk tier due primarily to methodology updates, and in some cases, limitations in the control environment. In addition, a direct comparison year-over-year cannot be determined for some risks within Problem Areas such as *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity* and *Hateful Conduct*, due to revisions in the risk statements from Year 2 as well as updates to Problem Area mappings in Year 3. As Meta's Integrity GRC function matures, year-over-year comparisons are expected to become more reliable, enabling more informed mitigation decisions that align with human rights commitments and DSA obligations.

The Road Ahead

We remain committed to providing a platform that provides value to our users and society at large and respects people's rights, including freedom of expression, while continuing to enable innovation.

We look forward to continuing to work with the European Commission and European Board for Digital Services to incorporate feedback from this Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment, and any additional guidance provided by the European Commission such as recently published Guidelines on the Protection of Minors, and to continue enhancing our integrity measures towards the shared objectives of minimising harm effectively, protecting and empowering people, and upholding their fundamental rights.[12]

1. Introduction

Pursuant to Article 34 and Article 42 of Regulation (EU) 2022/2065 (DSA), Meta Platforms Ireland Limited ("Meta") is pleased to provide our annual DSA Systemic Risk Assessment Report (the "Report") for Facebook. We are committed to maintaining a safe, reliable, and trustworthy online environment across all of our services, including Facebook. Our apps and services are designed to give people a voice and support fundamental rights, which is aligned with the EU's goal of creating "...a safer digital space in which the fundamental rights of all users of digital services are protected".[13]

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Report is to detail the results of Meta's annual DSA Systemic Risk Assessment and the reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigation measures in place to address Systemic Risks evaluated during this assessment in accordance with Articles 34, 35, 42(4)(a) and (b) of the DSA.

Meta has identified, analysed, and assessed the Systemic Risks in the EU that could stem from or be influenced by the following:

- Bad actors, behaviour (e.g., harassment), or content (e.g., hate speech) that violates our Terms and/or may be considered illegal;
- App design or functionalities, including but not limited to algorithmic systems (e.g., recommender systems); or
- The use made of our services.

1.2 Scope

Meta's third annual DSA Systemic Risk Assessment of Facebook is for the period of 1 September 2024 - 31 August 2025. The data collection period was 18 May 2024 - 31 March 2025.

The scope of this assessment is limited to the Systemic Risk Areas defined in Article 34 of the Digital Services Act (DSA), including the Deceptive and Misleading Systemic Risk Area, which was introduced in our Year 1 assessment to address behaviour and content designed to deceive, mislead, or defraud users, typically for personal gain.

The eight (8) Systemic Risk Areas analysed are as follows:

[12] On 14 July 2025, the Commission published its guidelines on the protection of minors under the DSA to ensure a safe online experience for minors and young people.
[13] https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/digital-services-act-package

Systemic Risk Areas

Deceptive & Misleading	Civic Discourse & Elections	Public Health	Public Security	Gender-based Violence	Protection of Minors	Fundamental Rights	Illegal Content

Pursuant to the European Commission's decision designating Facebook as a Very Large Online Platform (VLOP) in accordance with Article 33(4) of the DSA, the Facebook VLOP does not include private messaging services like Facebook Messenger which, based on its technical functionalities, does not meet the definition of an online platform. As such, Facebook Messenger is not in scope for this Report.

The focus of this assessment is on the Systemic Risk Areas defined in Article 34 of the DSA and our interpretation of the associated Systemic Risks in the EU. While our systems and policies are global in nature, this Systemic Risk Assessment reflects risks that could have an impact in the EU, as well as the reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigation measures Meta has in place to address the aforementioned Systemic Risk Areas.

Similarly to the Systemic Risk Areas, before deploying functionalities on Facebook in the EU that could critically impact Systemic Risks, Meta conducts a Critical Impact Risk Assessment (CIRA) in accordance with Article 34. This assessment identifies potential impacts on Systemic Risks and determines the reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigations required prior to launch.

1.3 Approach

Meta continues to evolve its practices and respond to content-related regulations, including by establishing and continuously enhancing our Integrity GRC Programme. This programme includes an Integrity Risk Management Process that pulls from ISO 31000:2018 as well as the Digital Trust and Safety Partnership (DTSP) frameworks, is tailored to meet the needs of our environment, builds on the existing integrity measures we have had in place for years, and accounts for feedback provided by the European Commission.[14]

1.4 Limitations and Assumptions

There were a number of limitations and assumptions associated with carrying out this Systemic Risk Assessment, including:

- **Guidance and Standards**: Meta has leveraged guidance and standards relevant to integrity risks in the EU, such as ISO 31000:2018 and the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, to inform the design and execution of our Integrity Risk Assessment Process.[15] We look forward to receiving guidance from the European Board for Digital Services to understand the lessons learned from industry Risk Assessments which we expect will contribute to the further development of guidance and standards for the industry.
- **Signal Parity**: To inform the evaluation of risks and controls, we gathered internal signals from various sources, including subject matter experts, our Issue Management Programme, assurance results, internal metrics, and publicly available transparency reporting data. These signals provide a

[14] https://www.iso.org/iso-31000-risk-management.html
[15] https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/documents/publications/guidingprinciplesbusinesshr_en.pdf

foundation for our Risk Assessment, however, signal quality and strength can vary across different risks and controls. Meta is on a journey of continuous improvement, and the quality of our risk and control signal will further improve and mature as we enhance our Risk Assessment Process and programme.

2. An Overview of Facebook

Meta builds technologies that help people connect, find communities, and grow businesses. Facebook helps give people the power to build community and bring the world closer together. It's a place for people to share life's moments and discuss what's happening, nurture and build relationships, discover and connect through shared interests, and create economic opportunity.

With over 261.6 million average monthly active Facebook users in the EU between 1 July 2024 to 31 December 2024, Facebook helps people make connections and navigate life's many milestones with its various features and services.[16] There are different types of content that enable our communities to interact, including:

- Organic content (e.g., content generated by users);
- Paid content (e.g., ads created by brands and businesses); and
- Commerce content (e.g., products listed by merchants on Facebook).

Facebook provides the tools for people to do more together and empowers them to support each other around the world. Examples of this include:

- **The Next Generation**: Facebook provides features like Marketplace, Reels, Groups, and Facebook Dating to cater to the next generation of social media users and support young adults through life transitions, which may include moving, going to college, and getting their first job or apartment.[17]
- **Creators and Monetisation**: As creators look for ways to connect safely and more widely with their communities, we are making it easier for anyone to become a creator and earn money on Facebook through new forms of expression, professional tools, and monetisation programmes. For example, we have evolved our payout model to pay creators based on how well their content performs on Facebook, simplifying how creators earn and expanding monetisation opportunities.[18]
- **Business Growth**: Facebook contributes to the EU economy by helping users discover new products and brands, and enabling businesses of all sizes to find customers and grow their presence through personalised advertising. There are more than 90 million small businesses on Facebook, and they make up a large part of our business. In fact, a global survey found that half of businesses on Facebook hired more people since they started using the product, demonstrating Facebook's role in creating millions of jobs.[19]

[16] EU Digital Services Act: Transparency Reports for VLOP Facebook (October - December 2024)
[17] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/05/the-future-of-facebook/
[18] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/05/the-future-of-facebook/
[19] https://about.fb.com/news/2019/01/understanding-facebooks-business-model/

- **Global Community Impact**: Facebook also empowers its global community to make a positive impact by raising money for non-profits and supporting important causes. This collective effort highlights the power of Facebook's community in driving positive change around the world.

3. A Balancing Act: Respecting Rights and Mitigating Risk

Meta is committed to respecting the fundamental rights of our users located in the EU as outlined in the DSA. Our third annual Human Rights Report demonstrates how we are living up to the commitments made in our Corporate Human Rights Policy.[20,21] We strive to respect human rights in every action we take and every product we build.

However, certain aspects of human rights can at times be in tension with one another, requiring, for example, a balance between freedom and prohibiting hateful conduct. At Meta, we strive to strike this balance:

- Our Community Standards outline what content is and is not allowed on Facebook. These policies are informed by international Human Rights Standards as outlined in our Corporate Human Rights Policy. This helps us strike a balance between promoting free expression and respecting other users' rights.
- We engage with our community and experts to inform our Community Standards, using a robust policy management engagement process that includes outreach to global stakeholders, including civil society organisations and academia, feeding into revised policy language in our Transparency Centre.
- As a part of the policy development process, the Human Rights Team conducts separate rights-based analysis and due diligence of proposed policies, submits analysis to policy leadership and presents views to each Policy Forum. Human rights impacts and mitigations are a consistent consideration in the policy development process.
- We assess potential human rights impacts through due diligence, aligned with United Nation Guiding Principles (UNGPs) 17 and 21, the International Bill of Rights and the EU's Charter of Fundamental Rights, among others.[22]
- We provide pathways for stakeholders to report potentially sensitive content, taking a remediation approach consistent with UNGP 31. We maintain multiple grievance pathways, including an appeals process to the Oversight Board.[23]
- We undertake proactive measures to address human rights-related risks, including our Comprehensive Human Rights Salient Risk Assessment (CSRA), ongoing product counselling, and integration of human rights risks into content risk forecasting. We offer human rights training, including customised training sessions tailored to specific teams, such as Regulatory Compliance

[20] https://humanrights.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/2023-Meta-Human-Rights-Report.pdf
[21] https://about.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/Facebooks-Corporate-Human-Rights-Policy.pdf
[22] https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/documents/publications/guidingprinciplesbusinesshr_en.pdf
[23] https://www.oversightboard.com/

and Content Policy, which may include specialised training on our commitments as a member of the Global Network Initiative (GNI) or the Rabat Plan of Action.[24]

- We have strengthened our governance systems, empowering the Oversight Board to provide independent review and decision-making on content moderation and enforcement. The Oversight Board has issued 292 non-binding recommendations across policy, enforcement, and transparency from January 2021 through 27 February 2025.[25]

3.1 Meta's Commitment to Respecting Voice and Enhancing User Safety

In our commitment towards balancing freedom of expression and safety, we developed our Community Standards that outline what is and what is not allowed on Facebook. These standards are based on feedback and advice from global stakeholders in fields like digital rights, freedom of expression, public safety, journalism, elections, and human and civil rights. We have developed an Inclusivity Framework to ensure that the views of our diverse stakeholders are considered in the development of our policies and Community Standards.[26]

At Meta, we believe and work to protect freedom of opinion and expression as foundational human rights that enable other rights. While we remain committed to respecting our users' voices, we also need to balance safety. For example, while we do not allow content that promotes or celebrates self-injury, content about recovery from suicide, self-injury or eating disorders is allowed; however, imagery that could be upsetting (such as a healed scar) is placed behind a sensitivity screen and we will also limit the ability to view the content to adults aged 18 and older.[27]

We also provide context about what users see and provide warning screens for content that some may find sensitive. This allows users to make their own decisions on what to read, and share.[28] In rare cases, we may allow content that may violate our Community Standards, if it is newsworthy and if keeping it visible is in the public interest. We do this only after conducting a thorough review that weighs the public interest value against the risk of harm.[29] We also look to international Human Rights Standards, as reflected in our Corporate Human Rights Policy, and trusted experts to make these judgments.[30]

In January 2025, Meta introduced changes to the Community Standards regarding *Hateful Conduct* and related guidance. These changes were made to enable more public debate and discussion about social issues of political and social importance, as well as to reduce possible over-enforcement.[31] Before introducing the changes, we identified and assessed the potential risks associated with the changes. We also confirmed through the assessment that we employed reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigations to address the potential risks associated with the changes.

We continue to conduct robust external engagement, including through our network of Trusted Partners composed of over 400 non-governmental, not-for-profit, national, and international organisations in 113

[24] https://www.ohchr.org/en/freedom-of-expression
[25] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/oversight/meta-H2-2024-bi-annual-report
[26] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/improving/stakeholders-help-us-develop-community-standards/
[27] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/suicide-self-injury/
[28] https://about.meta.com/actions/promoting-safety-and-expression/
[29] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/features/approach-to-newsworthy-content/
[30] https://about.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/Facebooks-Corporate-Human-Rights-Policy.pdf
[31] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/hateful-conduct/

countries who report content, accounts, and behaviour. We frequently benefit from having local context from our Partners when we review these reports.[32] We have also established mechanisms for reviewing reports of allegedly illegal content from "Trusted Flaggers" in compliance with the DSA.

3.2 Complaints and Appeals

As with any set of complex systems and processes, we recognise that it is not possible to always get enforcement actions right. Our complaints and appeals mechanisms have long been in place and made available to reporters of content and users who are affected by decisions. For example, in the first quarter of 2025, out of 3.4 million pieces of content related to *Violence and Incitement* that were actioned on Facebook globally, we received appeals for 479,000 pieces of content, of which 142,000 pieces of content were later restored.[33] If we change our decision, we notify the reporter and the user and implement our revised decision.

If we have reviewed an appeal and the user still does not agree with our decision, they may be able to appeal to the Oversight Board.[34] The Oversight Board independently reviews some of the most difficult and significant content decisions we make across our global operations. After completing its review and publishing their decision, the Oversight Board may issue non-binding recommendations related to transparency, policy, and enforcement. Meta responds to these recommendations within 60 days of the Board's decision with initial commitments and provides updates in regular reports. In the second half of 2024 alone, Meta completed work on 15 recommendations made by the Oversight Board. The recommendations we undertook in 2024 spanned our operations, policies, and services, contributing to broad and meaningful improvements in policy, transparency, and enforcement across the company and our global community.[35] Additionally, Meta provides a user-friendly process for users to appeal to certified Out-of-Court Dispute Settlement Bodies (ODS), as detailed in Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement and Section 5.2.1.6 User Rights and Recourse.

4. Systemic Risk Landscape

A core part of Meta's commitment to online safety is identifying and understanding potential Problem Areas, which are categories of content or behaviour that can pose risks to our users, and the specific risks that may arise within them. Our policies, teams, systems, and processes are organised around these Problem Areas and we have dedicated internal experts and targeted approaches to mitigate each of these Problem Areas.

The Systemic Risk Landscape depicts Problem Areas either mentioned in Article 34 of the DSA or understood by Meta to impact potential Systemic Risks in the EU. We used our deep knowledge of these Problem Areas and their associated potential risks to assess the DSA Systemic Risk Areas and define Facebook's Systemic Risk Landscape.

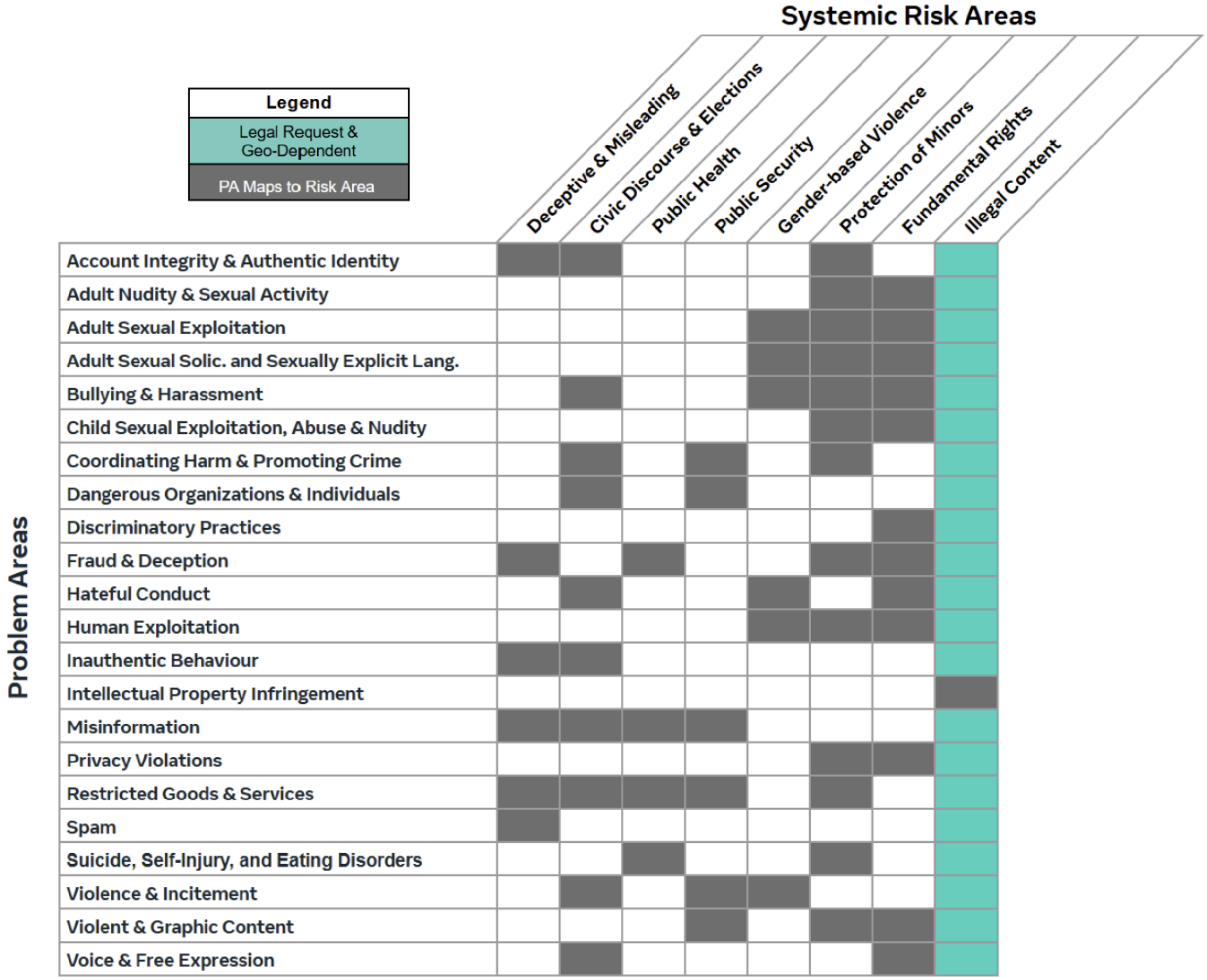
While the Risk Assessment Process mainly focuses on identifying and assessing known risks, we have established processes in place to assist us in identifying emerging risks and gathering signals on unknown risks. These processes include, but are not limited to, our threat intelligence capabilities, engagement with

[32] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/policies/improving/bringing-local-context
[33] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/violence-incitement/facebook/
[34] https://www.facebook.com/help/711867306096893
[35] https://transparency.meta.com/oversight/meta-biannual-updates-on-the-oversight-board/

external research institutions, advocacy groups, law enforcement, and industry information-sharing partnerships.

A visual representation of Meta's Systemic Risk Landscape and the Problem Areas aligned to each Systemic Risk Area is detailed in **Figure 1**. This landscape is meant to depict our most recent analysis and understanding between Problem Areas and the DSA Systemic Risk Areas. Some risks may map to multiple Systemic Risk Areas, and we periodically update these mappings. As referenced in the Executive Summary, we have revised the Problem Area to Systemic Risk Area mappings in Year 3.

Figure 1. Meta's Systemic Risk Landscape



Our approach to Illegal Content

Our Risk Landscape graphic above highlights Problem Areas that may be considered to be Illegal Content under certain regulatory regimes and legal frameworks. However, these are not directly mapped to the Illegal Content Systemic Risk Area (per Art 34(1)(a) of the DSA). Our globally applicable Community Standards outline types of content or behaviour that are not allowed on Facebook; Integrity Ecosystem supports and enforces these standards.

While our Community Standards may often overlap with common areas of illegality (e.g., minor exploitation), they do not map to specific laws due to variations across countries and nuances in legislation. In some cases, content that violates our policies may also be illegal. Our policies also cover Problem Areas that would not commonly be considered to be illegal (e.g., bullying).

In the EU, we provide dedicated reporting tools for illegal content, accessible from relevant content and in our Help Centre.[36] We may receive court orders to restrict content on Facebook or reports from governments, regulators, as well from non-government entities, and members of the public alleging content is unlawful. We review these requests in line with Meta's obligations under the DSA, our Corporate Human Rights Policy, and our commitments as a member of the GNI.[37] For example, in our DSA Transparency Report for Facebook covering 1 October 2024 to 31 December 2024, we reported 502 Authority Orders to act against illegal content (including Article 9 orders) addressed to Meta. In that same Transparency Report, we reported 248,748 notices submitted in accordance with Article 16 of which 53,045 (or ~21%) led to content removal or restriction.[38]

Our approach to Fundamental Rights

Meta has well established and enforceable policies for each Problem Area mapped above, with the exception of "*Discriminatory Practices*" that is mapped solely to Fundamental Rights. Meta embeds human rights considerations across our product development, policy decisions, and enforcement systems to proactively identify and address potential harms to users and communities, particularly those most at risk. More broadly, prevention of non-discrimination is embedded throughout our policies and enforcement systems, and human rights considerations inform how we develop our tools, technologies, and content moderation processes at scale. For further details, see 4.2.7 Fundamental Rights, 5.2.2.22 Voice and Free Expression, and 5.2.2.9. Discriminatory Practices.

Our approach to Physical and Mental Well-Being

Physical and Mental Well-Being is not listed as its own Systemic Risk Area in our Systemic Risk Landscape as potential impacts to physical and mental health are applicable to all Problem Areas and risks. Our Severity Principles consider Harm Type, which encompasses impacts on users' physical and psychological health, and we evaluate these risks as part of our Inherent Risk calculation within our Severity Rubric. Higher severity scores are assigned to risks deemed to have a potentially elevated impact on an individual's physical and psychological well-being. Meta also continuously develops resources to help support our users' well-being. These include external resources such as our Safety Centre and Help Centre, which provide tailored support materials for communities that can be most impacted by harmful content.[39] Given the importance of this risk and its potential impacts, such as *Suicide, Self-Injury and Eating Disorders (SSIED)*, we also assess and monitor a risk dedicated to how users might engage with Meta's platforms in ways that could lead to

[36] https://www.meta.com/help/policies/1138173423768570/
[37] https://globalnetworkinitiative.org/gni-principles/
[38] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/regulatory-transparency-reports/
[39] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/topics/wellbeing/

problematic use and affect their well-being. This ensures focused attention on these critical aspects alongside our cross-cutting evaluation.

See Appendix 8.2: Rubrics and Scoring for more information on the Severity Rubric and Section 4.2.3: Public Health for information on how we support users with digital wellness.

4.1 External Stakeholder Engagement

Meta actively engages external stakeholders to gather diverse insights on integrity risks and their potential impacts on users and society. These insights inform internal teams on how to improve integrity risk mitigation strategies. We receive a wide range of perspectives, often from competing global viewpoints, which we carefully balance to guide decision-making.

In line with Recital 90, we have continued to engage with Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) and consider their feedback in the Year 3 Assessment. In addition, in the relevant time period, we participated in a series of DSA stakeholder engagement forums organised by the Global Network Initiative and the Digital Trust & Safety Partnership, which provided opportunities to exchange insights on platform-related risks.

We collaborate closely with internal stakeholders to understand CSO input and integrate it into our assessment. For example, based on CSO feedback and continuous learning, we refined our Systemic Risk Landscape by updating the mapping of key Problem Areas—namely *Bullying and Harassment, Hateful Conduct, and Violent and Graphic Content*—with Fundamental Rights to better reflect evolving risks. This is merely one example; below are additional examples of how we work with external stakeholders to inform our approaches and processes:

- **Labelling AI-Generated Content:** Meta's approach to labelling Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) content and manipulated media is informed by feedback from external stakeholders, including the Oversight Board. We engage with external stakeholders to gather diverse insights on integrity risks and their impact on users and society.[40]
- **Brussels Artificial Intelligence Forum (November, 2024):** Meta convened academics and researchers to evaluate Meta AI, Meta's GenAI assistant, focusing on EU-specific use cases and regional risks before its anticipated launch in the EU. Participants included experts from policy think tanks and academia, covering areas such as persuasive design, formal verification, AI personalisation, and AI ethics and regulation. This engagement enhanced our understanding of regional AI risks, including the spread of false information, contested foreign policy issues, narratives surrounding refugees, and contentious historical subjects.
- **Women's Safety:** Meta collaborates with external women's safety advisors, specialising in non-consensual intimate images (NCII), adult sexual exploitation, and other online harms affecting women. Their expertise shapes the design of our policies, products, and programmes to prevent and respond to online abuse, including efforts to detect and remove NCII and support victims of online harassment.[41]
    - **Meta Roundtable for Women's Safety & Human Rights Partners (March 2025):** During the UN Commission on the Status of Women, Meta hosted a small roundtable with Women's

[40] Our Approach to Labelling AI-Generated Content and Manipulated Media | Meta (fb.com)
[41] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/

Safety and Human Rights Partners to discuss new tools, safety features, and policy updates. Participants included global organisations, such as the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), and the Global Network of Women's Shelters (GNWS). The discussion enhanced our understanding of platform risks and emerging trends in Women's Safety and Human Rights. We also shared planned policy updates on sensitive images and NCII services (e.g., Nudify apps) and collected feedback to inform future policy launches.

- **Minor Safety:** At Meta, protecting young people from harm is a top priority, as such we implement a number of ongoing and new mechanisms to support this effort. Meta is a founding member of the "Take It Down" platform, in partnership with the National Centre for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC), to prevent the spread of intimate images of minors and support their removal. This initiative addresses online harm at its root and reflects our approach to protecting vulnerable populations through expert and industry collaboration. Since 2023, Meta has partnered with ThinkYoung as well as Our Feed Our Future, engaging youth from France, Germany, Spain, Belgium, Denmark, and Italy to discuss the digital future.[42]
    - **Engaging through Meta Youth Summit (February 2025):** In February 2025, Meta hosted the Meta Youth Summit in Brussels, focusing on "Youth Safety in a Digital World." The event gathered over 130 stakeholders, including representatives from the European Parliament (EP), and European Commissioner for Intergenerational Fairness, Youth, Culture and Sport, representatives from member states, youth organisations, parent networks, civil society, industry experts, and policymakers from various institutions, as well as media and creators.
- **Oversight Board:** In Half 2 (H2) 2024, we worked alongside the Board to enhance transparency and external accountability regarding its governance role across Meta's platforms. For details on Oversight Board recommendations and their implementation, see Section 5.2.1.6: User Rights and Recourse and Section 6: Risk Mitigation Enhancements.
- **Out-of-Court Dispute Settlement (ODS) Bodies:** Meta collects insights from external stakeholders via the non-binding decisions submitted by certified Out of Court Dispute Settlement (ODS) bodies as part of the dispute settlement process set forth by DSA Article 21. Members of our Operations team conduct regular assessments of non-binding decisions to identify potential opportunities to improve integrity systems and policies and, thus, Meta's enforcement outcomes.

For additional examples of how external stakeholder engagement informs our policies and enforcement, please see:

- 4.2.1 Deceptive and Misleading
- 4.2.2 Civic Disclosure and Elections
- 4.2.5 Gender-based Violence
- 4.2.6 Protection of Minors
- 5.2.2 Detailed Risk Observations and Mitigating Measures

[42] Launching Our Feed Our Future, a Youth Advisory Network in Partnership with ThinkYoung

4.2 Systemic Risk Areas

The following sections detail how Meta understands and approaches managing the DSA Systemic Risk Areas for Facebook with respect to the EU. We continued to evaluate the risk landscape across all Systemic Risk Areas in Year 3, recognising that risks are not static and can be impacted by both internal and external factors. Each Systemic Risk Area is mapped to one or more Problem Areas and Meta has implemented compensating controls to help manage these risks across the Problem Areas. Please see Section 5.2.2: Detailed Risk Observations and Mitigating Measures of this Report for an overview of each Problem Area and the risks and controls associated with each DSA Systemic Risk Area.

4.2.1 Deceptive and Misleading

With the ongoing rise of new technologies and increasing interconnectedness, bad actors find new ways to target victims with evolving deceptive tactics that may be fraudulent or seek to exploit others for money or property. Our goal is to detect and mitigate these risks while continuously updating our mitigations as bad actors evolve their behaviour.

Meta takes a multifaceted approach to reducing inauthentic behaviour and associated content. We prohibit people from misrepresenting themselves on Facebook, using fake accounts, artificially boosting content popularity, or engaging in behaviours that enable other Community Standards violations. To help users protect themselves, Facebook allows users to complete a privacy check-up and update their settings to choose who can contact them and who can see their personal information, such as their online status, profile photo, and activity. This helps, for example, avoid unwanted contact from accounts users don't know that may be scammers. In addition, in the EU, we are rolling out measures that use facial recognition technology to help detect and prevent scams and enable faster account recovery on Facebook.[43]

Moreover, Meta is proud to be one of the founding members of the Tech Against Scam Coalition (TASC) and a member of the Global Anti Scam Alliance (GASA). Additionally, our Fraud and Deception Team engages with a number of external, trusted third parties, such as CSOs, to gather information about scam-related accounts and content.

For our assessment of Deceptive and Misleading risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by the continued high number of EU elections, which may lead to inauthentic behaviour risks across the platform impacting political figures and groups, including through the use of GenAI-powered tactics. Foreign influence operations, including from Russian operations, and cross-internet Coordinated Inauthentic Behaviour (CIB) campaigns have continued to persist as a trend on the platform. Additionally, we've observed a trend in attempts to deceive or scam users through fraud, deception, and misinformation tactics (e.g., deepfakes and digitally created or altered photorealistic video or audio). Lastly, threat actors continue to exploit user reporting systems with false reports and appeals, making it more challenging to accurately identify benign requests such as hacked accounts recovery support.

4.2.2 Civic Discourse and Elections

Meta continues to invest in a comprehensive approach to managing risks related to Civic Discourse and Elections with a focus on preventing interference, increasing transparency, reducing the spread of misinformation, and empowering people to vote. We have dedicated teams responsible for identifying and

[43] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/10/testing-combat-scams-restore-compromised-accounts/

addressing emerging threats, including foreign interference and domestic influence operations. We regularly review and update our election-related policies and approaches to ensure they remain effective in mitigating risks. In Europe, we rely on fact-checkers who are independent from Meta and certified through the European Fact-Checking Standards Network (EFCSN) to address misinformation on Facebook.[44,45]

Last year, more than two billion people went to the polls across some of the world's biggest democracies, including the EU.[46] Meta increased its investment in election-specific mitigation measures, including activating a dedicated team to develop a tailored approach to help prepare for the EU Parliamentary Elections. As a result, we implemented the following election-specific risk mitigation measures:

- **External Engagement:** In November 2024, Meta participated in the DISICON, an Information Integrity Conference convened by the National Democratic Institute in Croatia, which brought together different field experts to discuss threats to information integrity. Meta organised a roundtable with CSOs from the Balkan region to discuss cooperation methods ahead of elections and explain our work on mitigating adversarial threats. Following the event, we added more civil society groups to our Rapid Response System (our dedicated channels of intel / signal exchange) to support our election integrity efforts. Additionally, last year, Meta signed the AI Elections Accord alongside dozens of other industry leaders, pledging to help prevent deceptive AI content from interfering with global elections.[47] For details on external stakeholder engagement more broadly, see Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement.
- **Managing Inauthentic Behaviour:** Meta has been an active member of the EU Disinformation Code Taskforce's Election Working Group and participates in its Rapid Alert System. Meta attended a roundtable on 10 July 2024, to discuss our efforts in countering misinformation and foreign interference in France.[48] Additionally, in 2024, our teams took down around 20 new covert influence operations around the world, including in Europe.[49]
- **Proactive Measures:** Our teams of expert investigators work with engineers to feed the insights collected through investigations of global adversarial networks into automated detection systems. Through this cycle, we are able to proactively detect other bad actors engaged in similar violating behaviours, including networks that attempt to re-enter the platform after being removed. Meta continues to report publicly on the efforts to disrupt CIB and detect and remove fake accounts or spam through our Community Standards Enforcement Report, Newsroom posts, and Adversarial Threat Report.
- **Awareness of GenAI Images and Media:** Last year, Meta signed the AI Elections Accord alongside dozens of other industry leaders, pledging to help prevent deceptive AI content from interfering with global elections.[50]

[44] https://efcsn.com/code-of-standards/
[45] https://transparency.meta.com/features/how-fact-checking-works
[46] https://about.fb.com/news/2023/11/how-meta-is-planning-for-elections-in-2024/
[47] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/12/2024-global-elections-meta-platforms/
[48] Meta France Post-Election Report November 2024
[49] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/12/2024-global-elections-meta-platforms/
[50] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/12/2024-global-elections-meta-platforms/

For our assessment of Civic Discourse and Elections risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by continued trends that Meta monitors around EU elections and GenAI advancements. Our previous report (Year 2) covered the period leading up to the EU Parliamentary Elections, which took place in June 2024. This year's report (Year 3) covers the close-out of the EU Parliamentary Elections. While the EU Parliamentary Elections have concluded, our assessment showed that elections continue to pose a persistent, though reduced, risk. Additionally, foreign influence operations, including from Russian operations, and cross-internet CIB campaigns have continued to persist as a trend on the platform.

4.2.3 Public Health

Meta strives to foster an environment that supports public health globally, including within the EU, and strives to empower users by increasing access to credible health information, enabling people with similar health issues to connect with one another, and empowering them to make informed decisions about their health and well-being.

We have targeted measures to identify and manage Public Health risk on the platform. We take steps to limit the visibility of potentially harmful content on our platforms, such as hiding search results for restricted goods and services and deploying search enforcement interstitials to connect individuals with resources to report content (please refer to Section 5.2.2.17: Restricted Goods and Services for more information). For minors, Meta applies age-gating restrictions to specific harmful content, such as content related to diet products, cosmetic procedures, real money gambling, alcohol, tobacco, among other content types, and leverages enforcement actions to reduce visibility of this type of content to minors. For example, Meta has invested in classifiers and infrastructure to limit minors' exposure to self-injury and other age-inappropriate content, even if the content is shared by someone they follow on Facebook.[51]

We consult with leading health organisations to identify health misinformation likely to directly contribute to imminent harm to public health and safety. This includes misinformation about vaccines, promotion or advocacy for harmful miracle cures for health issues, and misinformation about health during public health emergencies.

Although Public Health risks can potentially arise from the use of Facebook, the platform also enables people to seek help and support. We offer resources, including Crisis Support, the Bullying and Harassment Safety Centre, Suicide Prevention Resources, our Emotional Health Hub, and our Family Digital Wellness Guides.[52]

For our assessment of Public Health risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape continued to be impacted by trends, including scams being masked as drug sales, exposure of content related to alcohol, tobacco, and real money gambling to minors, and threat actors targeting minors with weight loss products and cosmetic procedures. Additionally, it was observed that there has been an increase in videos, pictures, and ads sponsored by gambling companies featuring gambling branding in the background, but otherwise do not contain any gambling content, and are therefore harder to detect and enforce.

4.2.4 Public Security

Meta is dedicated to securing our services and negating potential Public Security risks that could arise through the use of Facebook. We use targeted enforcement measures to identify and enforce against users

[51] https://about.fb.com/news/2023/12/combating-online-predators/
[52] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/crisis-support-resources

advocating for or posting dangerous or violent content on our platforms, including enhanced automated detection technology, proactive enforcement by human reviewers, and detection tools that highlight early warning signs of real-world threats. Additionally, we assess high risk events using our Crisis Policy Protocol to identify those likely to pose a heightened risk of on-platform challenges.[53] If we designate an event, we conduct an operational assessment to determine the scale and complexity of these risks and whether additional levers are required. For example this could include issuing additional policy guidance to remove content which calls for people to bring arms to certain locations, or updating market-specific terms to improve the accuracy of enforcement against content which violates our Community Standards.

Meta continues to invest in countering the misuse of our services by authoritarian governments, terrorist groups, or other threat actors who may attempt to surveil regime critics, opposition figures, and Human Rights Defenders (HRDs).[54] Meta blocks domain infrastructure linked to malicious operations from being shared on our services. When appropriate and in line with our Terms of Service and applicable laws, we notify users who are likely targeted by these operations. These notifications are delivered through secure, indirect channels such as in-app alerts or verified emails to protect user privacy and safety.

Where appropriate, we continue to share findings about threats we detect with our industry peers and security researchers to help our entire community better understand and counter internet-wide challenges, including threats to fundamental societal interests, such as threats to the functioning of essential public services and large-scale threats to life, such as aspects of terrorism. Additionally, we have a robust process for reviewing and prioritising countries with the highest risk of offline harm and violence every six months.[55] To help support users who may be experiencing public security concerns on our platforms, Meta has developed safety tools, such as Crisis Support in our Safety Centre, where users can get urgent expert local support.[56]

For our assessment of Public Security risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by continued trends that Meta monitors around EU elections and GenAI advancements. We have also observed ongoing trends related to violent and graphic content shared in the EU, particularly related to the continued conflicts in Gaza.

4.2.5 Gender-based Violence

Meta is committed to protecting freedom of expression and ensuring that women and people of all gender identities can safely use our platforms to share their voice, build community, and access opportunity. We recognise that certain communities, including the lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer (LGBTQ+) community, may face challenges when engaging on our platforms.

Over the years, we have sought the help of experts in the field to ensure our platforms are safe for women. Our five-pillar approach works to keep abuse off our platforms:[57]

- **Resources:** We continue to offer access to resources designed with the safety of women in mind. The Facebook Help Centre provides step-by-step guides to protect users against threatening or unsafe

[53] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/policies/improving/crisis-policy-protocol/
[54] https://humanrights.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/2023-Meta-Human-Rights-Report.pdf
[55] https://about.fb.com/news/2021/10/approach-to-countries-at-risk/
[56] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/crisis-support-resources/
[57] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/women/

content. We also have our Women's Safety Hub, which is a centralised location for our online safety resources geared towards women.

- **Policies:** We maintain policies to help protect women from online abuse, including instituting rules against behaviours that disproportionately impact women, such as the sharing of NCII and harassment. These policies have been developed in partnership with Meta's Global Women's Safety Expert Advisors.[58]
- **Tools:** We continue to build tools to help people take control of their online experience, stay safe from unwanted content and contact, report problems, and fight against the sharing of private images without consent and sextortion.
- **Expert Engagement:** Meta actively collaborates with external stakeholders to deepen our understanding of integrity risks and effective mitigations, focusing on the safety of our users, particularly women and vulnerable groups. Notable engagements include the Meta Roundtable for Women's Safety & Human Rights Partners held in March 2025, ongoing partnerships with NGOs throughout the year, and a virtual panel hosted by the Council of Europe in January 2025 discussing technology-facilitated gender-based violence and Meta's efforts to address it. These collaborations provide valuable insights that inform our strategies to create safer online environments globally. For details on external stakeholder engagement more broadly, see Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement.
- **Community Engagement:** We continue to gather input and support from external experts to develop the policies, tools, and resources that promote women's safety online. For example, we have been expanding on-device nudity controls, combatting nudify apps, and managing sensitive images. More examples of community engagement can be found in 5.2.2.3 Adult Sexual Exploitation.

For our assessment of Gender-based Violence risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by the high number of elections in the EU, which may lead to hateful conduct and bullying and harassment risks on the platform. Additionally, due to conflicts in adjacent regions, trends associated with human exploitation have continued to persist, including human smuggling. Lastly, new and emerging trends have been identified that may impact risks related to adult sexual exploitation (e.g., AI kissing apps, nudification tools, and breastfeeding content).

4.2.6 Protection of Minors

At Meta, minor protection remains a top priority. We are committed to protecting young people from harm and ensuring that our platform is a positive and enriching experience for them. We've developed a three-pronged, industry-leading approach to protecting young people online. First, we focus on preventing harm from happening in the first place by enforcing zero-tolerance policies and developing cutting-edge, preventative tools. Second, we make it easy to report potential harms, and we respond to take action. Third, we continue to collaborate with global experts and industry partners to update our tools that keep young people safe.[59] Our three prongs are enabled through implementing a robust, proactive, and responsible approach to online safety of minors, including but not limited to following:

[58] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/women/#partners
[59] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/onlinechildprotection/

- **Safety by Design:** Meta takes steps to embed safety by design to help users engage safely online and on our products, particularly for minors. In order to use Facebook, users must be at least 13 years old. On Facebook, additional protections for minors include limiting messages from people they don't follow, and blocking certain words on comments.
- **Support Resources:** Meta continuously develops a library of tools and resources to help users stay safe online and understand our policies, reflecting our Community Standards and fostering a culture of respect and empathy. This includes, for example, Meta's Safety Centre, Meta's Crisis Support resources by country and offers guidance for parents, educators, and law enforcement, as well as Family Centre that provides users with resources, insights and expert guidance to help users support their families' online.[60]
- **Detection:** Meta uses automated detection mechanisms designed to detect and remove policy-violating content. For example, in Q1 2025, globally, we removed 4.6 million pieces of content on Facebook for violating our Child Sexual Exploitation Policy, out of which 95.8% of the content was found before users reported it.[61]
- **User Reporting:** We continue to maintain and quickly respond to user reporting channels, which help prevent the spread of harmful content in violation of our policies including, for example, harassment, bullying, graphic violence, and sexually explicit content. Meta made reporting functionality available and easily accessible across Facebook to all users, including minors.[62]
- **Protection of Minors' Privacy, Safety, and Security:** Year-over-year, we continue to invest in protection of minors' privacy, safety, and security**.** On Facebook, we default everyone who is under the age of 16 into more private settings when they join. This means that when a minor creates a new Facebook account, their location will not be shared unless they explicitly enable it. Given that minors can make this choice, Facebook has implemented mechanisms, including tooling and classifiers, to help protect minors from interacting with potentially suspicious adults. However, this continues to be challenging when threat actors leverage private groups and pages to evade detection and enforcement, which is why we remain committed to continually adapting and improving our safeguards.
- **Enforcement:** We take comprehensive action against accounts that violate our policies related to minor sexual exploitation, abuse, and nudity, including online grooming of minors. This includes disabling linked accounts and devices across all our products, not just the original offending account. Furthermore, Meta's Global Response Operations (GRO) team maintains an escalation channel where internal teams can escalate complex, sensitive, and urgent issues including those pertaining to protection of minors.
- **External Engagement:** Meta collaborates with industry partners, law enforcement, and specialist stakeholders, such as the NCMEC, to tackle online safety of minors. For example, we partner with external organisations, like Orygen that developed #chatsafe for Educators and suicide provention and Thorn's NoFiltr brand, to enhance our educational materials on topics such as youth safety and

[60] https://familycenter.meta.com/
[61] Community Standards: Child Endangerment: Nudity and Physical Abuse and Sexual Exploitation
[62] https://www.facebook.com/help/1380418588640631/

minor protection.[63,64] Furthermore, Meta is part of the WeProtect Global Alliance industry committee. WeProtect brings together experts from government, the private sector, and civil society to protect minors from sexual exploitation and abuse online. For more details on external stakeholder engagement more broadly, see Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement.

For our assessment of Protection of Minors risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by the evolving GenAI technologies, including nudification tools and GenAI tools that create imagery depicting minors that are not real. Furthermore, Meta has continued to observe trends related to bullying and harassment of minors, increased risk of exposing minors to content related to alcohol, tobacco and real money gambling, and threat actors targeting minors with weight loss products and cosmetic procedures.

4.2.7 Fundamental Rights

Meta seeks every day to translate human rights principles into meaningful action. The foundation of our work is the Meta Corporate Human Rights Policy. Our commitment and approaches are informed by the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights plus the international and regional Human Rights Standards listed in our Corporate Human Rights Policy.

These approaches include (1) applying Human Rights Standards to our policies, products and operations; (2) conducting due diligence and disclosure; (3) providing access to remedy; (4) maintaining oversight, governance, and accountability; and (5) protecting Human Rights Defenders.[65] Further details are available in our annual Human Rights Reports. These approaches inform and are complementary to our DSA regulatory compliance work.

Through our day-to-day due diligence work, many different teams collaborate to continuously integrate Human Rights Standards into our activities. For example, a specialised subject matter team at Meta provides ongoing advice to assess and mitigate rights-related risks with regard to Content Policies, product development, crisis and conflict response, and election preparation. To support the Content Policy development process, our experts review proposals through the lens of human rights law and the EU human rights framework to take account of freedom of expression and the right to non-discrimination, among other rights risks. In 2024, this included refining our Dangerous Organisations and Individuals Policies, Commercial content with potential health and safety risks, and the removal of sensitive imagery.

We provide dedicated human rights and civil rights training. These trainings help employees understand human rights concepts and principles, how to identify issues and concerns in their work, and where to go for help.

In parallel, we continue to provide users with pathways to report concerns and appeal decisions made about their content. We have enabled the Oversight Board to make fully independent content moderation decisions and recommendations about Content Policy, services, and operations. A member of the Global Network Initiative, Meta stays committed to the GNI Principles of Freedom Expression and Privacy in responding to

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[63] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/topics/wellbeing/suicideprevention/educators
[64] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/childsafety
[65] https://about.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/03/Facebooks-Corporate-Human-Rights-Policy.pdf

government content takedown and user data requests, and is currently undergoing its periodic independent assessment of our implementation of the GNI principles.[66, 67, 68]

We recognise the importance of meaningful engagement with stakeholders from marginalised communities.[69] Engagement with external stakeholders, including European civil society groups and fundamental rights experts, helps us live up to our human rights responsibilities, creates an important lever for accountability and transparency, and strengthens our work. Beginning in 2024, Meta has convened an expert roundtable of global human rights experts to share insights with the company about human rights best practices. Additional information on how we approach fundamental rights via our efforts to champion respect for human rights in our actions and products is outlined in Section 3: A Balancing Act: Respecting Rights and Mitigating Risk and Section 5.2.2.11: Hateful Conduct.

In Year 3, we undertook a comprehensive reassessment of the mappings between Problem Areas and the Systemic Risk Area framework for Fundamental Rights, that identified opportunities for improvement. As a result, we refined our approach by explicitly mapping *Bullying and Harassment, Hateful Conduct, and Violent* and *Graphic Content Problem Areas* to Fundamental Rights. Additionally, we incorporated the new *Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language* Problem Area into the Fundamental Rights mapping.

For our assessment of Fundamental Rights risks in 2025, we identified that the risk landscape could be impacted by the high number of elections in the EU, which may lead to discrimination, bullying and harassment, especially against women candidates, and hateful conduct risks on the platform. Additionally, due to conflicts in adjacent regions, trends associated with human exploitation have continued to persist, including human smuggling. Lastly, new and emerging trends have been identified that may impact risks related to adult sexual exploitation, in addition to child sexual exploitation, abuse, and nudity (e.g., AI kissing apps, nudification tools, breastfeeding content).

Meta recognises that the other Systemic Risk Areas identified in the DSA, such as Civic Discourse and Elections, Public Security, Public Health, Gender-based Violence, Illegal Content, or Protection of Minors can all have potential fundamental rights implications.

4.2.8 Illegal Content

We provide user-friendly reporting for content alleged to be illegal or violating our Community Standards. Users across EU member states can refer decisions on illegal content to a designated Out-of-Court Dispute Settlement Body. We also notify law enforcement of suspected criminal offences involving threats to life or safety. In 2024, we responded to over 124,527 government requests in the EU across our platforms.[70]

Our process reviews reports of content alleged to be illegal under applicable member states and EU law(s) by first assessing compliance with our Community Standards. Content violating our policies is removed unless deemed newsworthy. Our Community Standards cover many harms overlapping with illegality, such as Hateful Conduct and Child Sexual Exploitation, as mentioned above in Section 4: Systemic Risk Landscape.

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[66] https://globalnetworkinitiative.org/gni-principles/
[67] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/content-restrictions/
[68] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/government-data-requests/
[69] https://humanrights.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/2023-Meta-Human-Rights-Report.pdf
[70] https://transparency.fb.com/reports/government-data-requests/data-types/

For IP Infringement, rights holders can report various content types, which are reviewed by our IP operations team.

If reported content violates applicable local law(s) within the EU but not our Community Standards, we may restrict its availability in the relevant country or region, consistent with our Corporate Human Rights Policy and GNI membership.

For our assessment of Illegal Content Risks in 2025, we did not identify any new trends since Year 2 that could impact the risk landscape.

4.3 Influencing Factors

As detailed in **Figure 1**, we evaluated the impact of our Integrity Ecosystem and its operations on the Systemic Risk Landscape and the associated risks. We refer to these factors collectively as **Influencing Factors**, which includes those outlined in Article 34(2), and encompasses design-related factors that can influence systemic risks. We also consider other cross-cutting features or factors beyond the list in Article 34(2), such as the presence of industry GenAI. These considerations and risks were identified through our Risk Assessment Process, which evaluated the potential impact on all Systemic Risk Areas. Specifically, through the **Assess Phase,** we engaged with integrity teams and posed a series of questions for each Problem Area to deepen our year-over-year understanding of how these systems influence Problem Areas and the associated risks. Through the **Measure Phase,** and for each Problem Area, we took into consideration insights from integrity teams including any issues and improvement areas identified through various signals, including assurance testing, where applicable, and analysed data, where available.

This section details the overall objective and scope of each factor, circumstances by which it introduces or reduces risks, and key insights and learnings. Specific details on how we mitigate these factors using Meta's set of controls are provided in Section 5.2: Mitigating Measures Analysis.

4.3.1 Recommender Systems

Facebook's recommender systems are designed to help users discover content that is useful, interesting, relevant, and valuable. To determine what content is eligible for recommendations, we have established Recommendation Guidelines, which are published in the Facebook Help Centre, providing context on why some types of content are not included in the recommendations and may not be distributed as widely.[71]

We provide information to users on how content is recommended and offer various tools to help them manage their online experience. These tools include customisable feeds, such as Most Recent, Favourites, Feed, and Content Controls, enabling users to adjust the types of content they see and interact with. We also provide tools to users to control the amount of political content they see.[72]

Our recommender systems are also designed to prevent the recommendation, recirculation, or amplification of potentially policy-violating or otherwise potentially sensitive content. We filter content to remove items that potentially violate our policies and standards, and then use machine-learning algorithms and human curation to select content that users are most likely to be interested in.[73] This multi-step approach helps ensure that our recommendations are both relevant and responsible. While our recommender systems have

[71] https://www.facebook.com/help/1257205004624246
[72] https://www.facebook.com/help/1932710690579979/
[73] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/04/introducing-our-next-generation-infrastructure-for-ai/

robust controls in place, some potentially sensitive content may still be recommended before we can detect and remove it.

We are taking steps to enhance the transparency and control of our recommendation systems. Specifically, we will be recommending more political content based on personalised signals, allowing users who want to see more of this type of content in their feeds to do so.[74] This change is part of our ongoing effort to give users more control over their online experience and to promote a more diverse range of perspectives on our platform. To support these efforts, we have updated our system cards in the Transparency Centre, to provide more clarity on how recommender systems function (e.g., Facebook Dating's AI System Card explains how the content that users see on Facebook Dating is selected, ranked, and delivered).[75] We implemented a refresh cycle for all system cards across each recommender system to ensure our documentation remained accurate, up-to-date, and reflective of the latest developments in our systems.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to recommender systems:

- **Content Ranking:** We routinely evaluate whether the signals we use to enable users to get relevant content could lead to exposure of potentially sensitive content. We reduce this risk by limiting the role of shares and comments in the distribution of sensitive topics.[76] We continue to work on enhancing our capabilities to address mitigations needed on Facebook, including improving existing or introducing new mitigations as appropriate.
- **Recommendation Surfaces:** Meta has taken steps to improve user safety across our recommendation surfaces by launching risk mitigations measures on Facebook Search, which aim to reduce the spread of harmful content. In addition, Meta employs a robust filtering system that identifies and demotes groups that are likely to violate policies from both connected and unconnected search results, aimed at reducing the visibility of potentially harmful content.
- **Recommendation Features:** We continuously work to improve and enhance our capabilities to address mitigations needed on Facebook. As an example, the People You May Know (PYMK) feature is designed to help users connect to the people who matter to them most and to help them make new friends on Facebook. Some of these features could connect bad actors to minors, which has an impact on risks in the *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Nudity* and *Human Exploitation* Problem Areas. To mitigate these risks, we utilise specialised tooling to identify suspicious actors and take appropriate action, including removing them from recommendation surfaces. On Facebook, we default everyone who is under the age of 16 into more private settings when they join.[77] Additionally, users can remove unhelpful suggestions, which helps improve the PYMK feature by reducing similar suggestions in the future. Users also have the option to block someone, preventing them from appearing as a friend suggestion and vice versa.[78]

[74] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/01/meta-more-speech-fewer-mistakes/
[75] https://transparency.meta.com/features/explaining-ranking/fb-dating/
[76] To help inform users about what they see and read, we include warning screens over potentially sensitive content on Facebook, such as: violent or graphic imagery; posts that contain descriptions of bullying or harassment, if shared to raise awareness; some forms of nudity; and posts related to suicide or suicide attempts.
[77] https://about.fb.com/news/2022/11/protecting-teens-and-their-privacy-on-facebook-and-instagram/
[78] https://www.facebook.com/help/415968568455523

- **Infrastructure Capabilities:** We have implemented new infrastructure capabilities to optimise our recommendation systems. This involves exploring innovative technologies, such as elastic ranking and GenAI, which can facilitate more efficient, scalable, and responsive ranking processes. By introducing these enhancements, we aim to provide users with more personalised and engaging recommendations, ultimately enhancing their overall experience and satisfaction.

4.3.2 Content Moderation Systems

Facebook's **content moderation systems** ("integrity systems") are designed to detect and review potentially violating content and accounts, including organic, paid content, and commerce. We utilise technology and user reports to identify potentially policy-violating content, and use both technology and human review to confirm policy violations and take action on content and accounts that go against our policies. We continue to invest extensively in updating our integrity systems to keep up with new behaviours and trends.

While our detection technology has proven effective in detecting violating content before anyone reports it, as with any complex system, there are certain limitations. That's why we also leverage users' reports so we can identify and take appropriate action. In addition, signals from our Trusted Partner and Trusted Flagger reporting channel (the latter as defined under the DSA) help inform proactive detection of emerging trends, potential policy violations, and certain types of illegal content. We may remove, reduce the distribution of, or inform users of potentially sensitive content based on our Community Standards. We also have our Strike System to hold users accountable for continuous violations of the Community Standards. For most violations, the first strike will result in a warning with no further restrictions. If we remove additional posts that go against our Community Standards, we may also apply additional strikes to the user's account, who may lose access to some features for longer periods of time. In addition, we seek to prevent threat actors from creating new recidivist accounts to engage in continued abusive/violating behaviour.

Our integrity systems enable policy-violating content to be detected and removed systematically, helping to keep users safe online. At the same time, making mistakes in enforcement can impact user voice and user exercise of freedom of expression and other fundamental rights on our platform. The latter directly impacts the Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Area and is a delicate balance we must strike when managing risk and user rights.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to content moderation:

- **Detecting Infrequent, High-Risk Content:** Our automated-detection systems are trained and improved when a specific type of content occurs more regularly on our platform, generating a sufficient body of examples to build effective classifiers. However, for low prevalence yet high-risk content such as suicide and self-injury, we have to rely more on user reporting and human review due to the limited availability of training data.
- **Enforcements:** Starting in Q4 2024, Meta implemented several changes to our policies and enforcement measures for both content and users in order to protect free expression on Facebook. By improving the accuracy of our enforcement and preventing mistakes, we were able to significantly reduce "over-enforcement" of our users and their content. Through monitoring of harm prevalence and reports, we are confident these changes did not significantly impact enforcement against related harms, with minimal integrity regressions and maintenance of existing protective guardrails that

mitigate risk to users. Meta teams continue to work on protecting user voice while also balancing the prevention of high harms on our platforms.

- **Recidivism Prevention:** We continue to invest in recidivism prevention as it remains a challenge that we manage across Problem Areas. We have enhanced our recidivism enforcement by implementing additional cross-platform propagations and establishing measurement for under and over-enforcement. This enables more consistent removal of Violation Actor Networks (VANs) and improves the accuracy and fairness of enforcement actions. For example, in Q4 2024, Meta has applied over 87 million account restriction termination measures for Account Integrity violations in the EU for Facebook.[79,80]

- **Circumvention:** Threat actors continue to test new strategies and behaviours to evade detection and enforcement requiring Meta to consistently update and strengthen systems and processes in place (e.g., use of emojis and hashtags, implicit threats, slurs, and coded language). Meta has proactive teams and mechanisms to identify and subsequently integrate these patterns into the automation detection system, all within respect of existing personal data protection laws. In addition, within the human review process, reviewers may be able to use a highlighting tool for slurs and dangerous organisations based on the region where the content is reviewed, tooltips that explain the definitions of certain words, and guidance regarding how they should use these details to inform decisions.[81]

4.3.3 Terms of Service and their Enforcement

Facebook is a global community, so the Facebook Community Standards apply equally to everyone, everywhere and to all types of content. Our Terms of Service and Content Policies, including the Community Standards, are designed to help define what is and isn't allowed on Facebook and manage systemic risks by providing clear guidelines on our approach to these issues in a way that is easy to understand for users. They form the foundational structure of our Integrity Ecosystem so that we can help keep users safe and maintain a trusted, equitable, and secure environment. We also provide further information on how those policies and other relevant procedures are applied. All of our policies can be accessed through the Help Centre and Transparency Centre, both of which are readily available to users on the platforms, and are available in more than 90 languages, including the official EU languages.

Our foundational policies that determine how we operate Facebook include, but are not limited to, the following:

- **Terms of Service:** These terms detail the services we provide, how our services are funded, user commitments to Facebook and our community, additional provisions, and other Terms and Policies applicable to users;[82]

- **Community Standards:** These standards outline our approach to content that users post to Facebook and user activity on Facebook and other Meta services;

- **Advertising Standards**: These standards apply to partners who advertise across Meta's services and specify what types of ad content are allowed and prohibited;

[79] Account restriction terminations restrict access to a user's account in its entirety.
[80] EU Digital Services Act: Transparency Reports for VLOP Facebook (October - December 2024)
[81] EU Digital Services Act: Transparency Reports for VLOP Facebook (October - December 2024)
[82] https://www.facebook.com/legal/terms

- **Commerce Policies:** These policies outline the policies that apply when users offer products or services for sale on Facebook;
- **Privacy Policy:** This policy details how we collect, use, share, retain and transfer information, along with detailing user rights;[83]
- **Corporate Human Rights Policy:** This policy commits to respecting human rights as set out in the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights; and
- **Code of Conduct:** This Code of Conduct defines the expectations we have for how we act and how we make decisions as a company.[84]

We have processes in place to review, maintain, and validate our policies, standards, and terms to reflect the evolving world. Specifically for our Community Standards, our Content Policy Team includes subject matter experts in issues like hateful conduct, minor safety and terrorism as well as people with experience in criminal prosecution, rape crisis counselling, academics, human and civil rights, law, and education.[85] The Content Policy Team consults with internal and external stakeholders from around the globe to discuss potential policy updates on a routine basis. These updates are communicated to our engineering teams and human review teams who will adjust our detection and enforcement systems. Additionally, our enforcement systems are routinely trained using data sets of human decisions. We review metrics to validate that our precision against our standards is accurate.

Sometimes it is not possible for us to get the enforcement of our terms right (e.g., over-enforcement), which can impact a user's fundamental rights like freedom of expression or other fundamental rights. Like content moderation systems, Terms of Service, Community Standards, and other policies and their enforcement can have both a positive (e.g., establishing behavioural and content guardrails and enforcing them) and negative influence (e.g., over-enforcement). As a result, this Influencing Factor could have an impact on all Systemic Risk Areas.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to Terms of Service:

- **Policy Governance:** The integrity risk landscape is always evolving with the changing internal and external factors and emerging trends. This requires us to continuously review our policies to stay ahead of new trends and adversarial actors. Meta is working to improve our policy governance and policy update processes to maintain tight alignment with other cross-functional teams, provide transparency at all levels, and establish accountability across teams.
- **Unified Community Standards:** On 22 August 2024, Meta announced a shift to a unified set of Community Standards across Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, and Threads. By consolidating multiple policy frameworks into a single set of standards, Meta aimed to reduce fragmentation across services and improve clarity for users about what content is permitted, how enforcement decisions are made, and how to seek recourse. This change took effect in 2024, and was accompanied by a Terms of Service update relevant to EU users.[86]

[83] https://www.facebook.com/privacy/policy
[84] https://www.meta.com/people-practices/code-of-conduct/
[85] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/policies/community-standards/
[86] https://transparency.meta.com/integrity-reports-q2-2024/

- **Change Management:** At Meta, we recognise that policy changes have far-reaching implications, affecting multiple aspects of our operations and user experience. Any policy change has upstream and downstream impacts, such as related product design changes, legal approvals, user notifications, internal process changes, lags in system updates, and updates to Terms of Service. To address these complexities, we are committed to ongoing year-over-year efforts to improve and enhance our coordination across various cross-functional teams to enable seamless change management as we work towards addressing the various integrity systems risks.

4.3.4 Ads Systems

Facebook's ad systems and processes are designed to help the millions of people who use our services to discover ads that they will hopefully find interesting and help businesses build a community, increase online sales, drive in-store traffic, and find new customers. Our Advertising Standards provide policy detail and guidance on the types of ad content we allow, our ad review process, and ad transparency requirements for EU users pursuant to Article 39 of the DSA. We want our users to feel empowered and provide options to all users to control or customise their ad preferences on Facebook, which may include, but are not limited to, the following: hide an ad, hide all ads from an advertiser, select "Why am I seeing this?" to get more context, manage their ad preferences, and restrictions around targeting ads to minors. Additionally, Meta strives to provide transparency around ad targeting through our Ad Library.[87]

As part of our ads review process, all ads are automatically reviewed against our Advertising Standards before launching on Facebook. We also use human reviewers to improve and train our automated systems, and in some cases, to manually review ads. Ads remain subject to review and re-review at all times, and may be rejected or restricted for violation of our policies at any time. We continue to improve our existing enforcement systems by testing and implementing new approaches to ensure a fair and effective ad review process. More information on how our ad systems work and how user data is leveraged to provide personalised ads can be found in our Advertising Standards. As part of our DSA compliance efforts, Meta established advertiser self-disclosure of beneficiary / payer as part of the ad buying process. We also updated our ads systems to prohibit the use of sensitive categories of data for ads generally.

While ads systems are a core feature of our platform and we have an extensive ecosystem of controls in place to manage them, some potentially sensitive content that does not violate our guidelines and policy-violating paid content may be disseminated before we can detect and remove it. In other instances, some violating accounts may evade our content moderation systems. This Influencing Factor could have an impact on all Systemic Risk Areas. This insight was derived through the execution of our Risk Assessment where we evaluated and accounted for ads systems as an Influencing Factor.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to ads systems:

- **Intentional Manipulation:** Similar to what was observed in Year 2, threat actors continue to exploit our systems to evade detection and enforcement, such as disguising encoded content as organic. Our mitigation strategies remain consistent, including limiting account posting capabilities, removing accounts, and conducting thorough research on potential network operations. Our ads approach continues to mature, with increased action at the account level.

[87] https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/

- **Ad Technology:** Facebook's ad systems and processes are constantly innovating and improving. Meta has also increased investment in the fraud and scams space. Specifically, we have devoted additional resources to fraud and scams prevalence and detection, including classifiers and enforcement.

- **Less Personalised Ads:** People in the EU have the option to choose between subscribing for an ad-free experience or continuing to access our services for free. For those people who choose to continue using our services for free, they'll now also be able to choose to see less personalised ads. This less personalised ads option relies on less data, so we'll show ads based only on context. We firmly believe that personalised ads are a vital component of the ad-supported internet and we will continue to advocate for regulations that support the responsible use of personalised advertising, allowing us to maintain the high-quality, free services that people have come to expect from us.[88]

4.3.5 Data Related Practices

Privacy and the protection of personal information are fundamentally important values for Facebook. As expectations around privacy evolve, it's critical Meta continues investing in guardrails and processes to meet people's privacy needs and expectations. We work hard to safeguard a user's personal identity and information, and we do not allow people to post certain types of personal or confidential information about themselves or others.[89] We have a robust Product Compliance and Privacy Programme in place, led by our Chief Privacy and Compliance Officer, with extensive controls to protect privacy and security across Meta's services in line with privacy regulations, including the EU's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), and our GNI commitments. Since 2019, we have overhauled privacy at Meta, investing over $8 billion in a rigorous privacy programme that includes people, processes, and technology designed to identify and address privacy risks early and embed privacy into our services from the start. We have grown our product, engineering, and operations teams focused primarily on privacy across the company from a few hundred people at the end of 2019 to more than 3,000 people at this time.[90]

Additionally, our Privacy and Data Policy Team leads our engagement in the global public discussion around privacy, including new regulatory frameworks, and ensures that feedback from governments and experts around the world is considered in our product design and data use practices.

Furthermore, we want our users to feel empowered and provide options to all users to control their privacy on Facebook, including, but not limited to, the following: easy access to manage user information, controlling user experiences across our services with tools such as "Why Am I seeing this Ad", our privacy check-up Tool, and Two-Factor Authentication.[91] Our technology detects the vast majority of privacy-related risks, but like any complex infrastructure, there are limitations.

Maintaining good data practices is critical to upholding our users rights (e.g., data retention allows us to restore accounts and actioned content that has been successfully appealed) and protecting our most vulnerable population from harmful content (e.g., age-gating content and deployment of controls that protect minors).

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[88] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/11/facebook-and-instagram-to-offer-subscription-for-no-ads-in-europe/
[89] https://transparency.fb.com/en-gb/policies/community-standards/privacy-violations-image-privacy-rights/
[90] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/01/meta-8-billion-investment-privacy/
[91] https://about.meta.com/actions/protecting-privacy-and-security/#privacy-controls

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to data practices:

- **Privacy-Focused Identity Verification Tools:** In March 2025, Meta began testing a voluntary facial recognition feature in the EU to help users recover compromised accounts and reduce impersonation-based scams. The tool requires explicit opt-in and promptly deletes biometric data after use, reflecting Meta's commitment to privacy-by-design. This approach enhances account security while respecting user autonomy and data minimisation principles—core to protecting user rights under the DSA.[92]
- **Data Retention Policies:** Meta has enhanced its data retention policies, specifically for geo-blocking actions, to align with evolving content regulations. This includes thorough documentation and transparent communication of our data handling practices to ensure accountability.
- **Data Use Limitations:** Meta does not utilise user level data in the EU due to an EU privacy regulation that restricts Meta from collecting and analysing personal data to identify if a medical or life-threatening issue is at hand. While protecting EU user data is a priority, this particularly impacts our ability to provide resources and a greater level of support to many users as it relates to suicide and self-injury risks. Additionally, Meta does not collect data regarding certain protected characteristics or types of users, to protect user privacy, making it difficult to determine if certain groups are being targeted disproportionately.

4.3.6 Intentional Manipulation

Intentional manipulation negatively influences experiences on our platform and manifests in a variety of ways including, but not limited to, manipulated media, inauthentic use, or automated exploitation of our services. While we have an extensive ecosystem of controls in place to manage intentional manipulation, some threat actors can continue to evade our controls and safeguards which could result in policy-violating and illegal content and behaviour occurring on the platform. This Influencing Factor could have an impact on all of the Systemic Risk Areas.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, we have identified several key risk considerations related to intentional manipulation:

- **Circumvention:** Circumvention continues to be a challenge as threat actors test new strategies and behaviours to evade detection and enforcement requiring Meta to consistently update and strengthen systems and processes in place (e.g., use of emojis and hashtags, implicit threats, slurs, and coded language).
- **Spam and Platform Manipulation:** Spammy content continues to be one of the challenges on Facebook. Year-over-year, we continue to invest in improving our processes and leveraging existing mitigations, for example we manage adversarial spamming by launching Strategic Network Disruptions (SND), which allow us to disable multiple threat-related accounts at once and also help address coordinated attacks. Furthermore, we are investing more to remove accounts that coordinate fake engagement and impersonate others as well as exploring steps to lower the reach of accounts sharing spammy content. These changes aim to preserve the authenticity of content

[92] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/10/testing-combat-scams-restore-compromised-accounts/

distribution and reduce systemic manipulation, aligning with Meta's broader risk mitigation strategy.[93]

- **Coordinated Inauthentic Behaviour:** CIB, including coordinated interference in elections, remains a persistent challenge. Meta has dedicated teams to address this issue, including to counter the anticipated surge in adversarial activities around elections. Furthermore, we continue to invest in our detection and enforcement systems to mitigate these risks, including enhancing our capabilities to respond to an expanding range of adversarial behaviours as global threats evolve.

4.3.7 Generative Artificial Intelligence

As a leader in the AI space, Meta continues to drive innovation through major investments and maintains its dedication to open innovation in our foundational AI technologies.[94] Meta also believes that an open ecosystem brings transparency, scrutiny, and trust to the development of AI and leads to innovations that everyone can benefit from.[95] We continue to engage with external stakeholders, organisations, academics, civil society groups, and other experts to better understand the AI ecosystem and deepen our understanding of the complex factors influencing our work.[96] Examples of our external engagement efforts can be found in Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement (e.g., specifically the Brussels AI Forum, November 2024).

As GenAI technology continues to advance, the risk of third-party misuse or exploitation becomes increasingly concerning. Through our ongoing collaboration with MLCommons, we're working alongside researchers, security experts, and industry peers to create a set of third-party tools for evaluating and mitigating a wide-range of possible risks. This maximises the power of the AI community to develop the safest and most useful models.[97]

To support management of this Influencing Factor and associated risks, we have set up a number of activities to monitor and respond to the use of GenAI by users. For example, we work to understand the comprehensive landscape of the use of GenAI on our platforms by analysing potential GenAI violations. We are also implementing transparency labelling, such as utilising synthetic data to improve labelling performance against AI content and providing signals to human reviewers when we know something is created by GenAI.[98] We will continue to keep a pulse on the evolving use of GenAI and scale monitoring and response activities to address identified risks.

While we have an extensive ecosystem of controls in place to manage the evolving use of GenAI, some potentially sensitive content may still be generated and disseminated before it is detected and removed. This Influencing Factor could have an impact on all of the Systemic Risk Areas.

As a result of the **Assess** and **Measure Phases** of the assessment, including our evaluation of the impact of GenAI on inherent risk, we have identified several key risk considerations related to GenAI:

- **Deepfakes Detection:** Our processes continue to evolve year-over-year to detect content that violates our policies and this issue specifically gets more complicated with regard to deepfakes and

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[93] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/04/cracking-down-spammy-content-facebook/
[94] Accelerating Open-Source Innovation Across Sub-Saharan Africa: Introducing the Llama Impact Accelerator Program
[95] https://engineering.fb.com/2024/03/12/data-center-engineering/building-metas-genai-infrastructure/
[96] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/04/metas-approach-to-labeling-ai-generated-content-and-manipulated-media/
[97] https://ai.meta.com/blog/responsible-ai-connect-2024/
[98] Synthetic data is artificially generated rather than data that is collected from actual events, observations, or people.

any other forms of altered content, including impersonation of celebrities and high-profile individuals. We are improving detection of AI generated content with visible and invisible markers to further mitigate this issue.

- **Scaled Content Volumes:** GenAI makes possible the creation of large volumes of content, which could impact areas, such as *Child Sexual Exploitation, Spam, Abuse and Nudity, Misinformation, Fraud and Deception,* and *Inauthentic Behaviour*. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape, and we continue our investment in mitigating risks arising from increased GenAI adoption.

5. Our Detailed DSA Systemic Risk Assessment Results

Meta is committed to maintaining a safe and trusted environment on Facebook. Risks can arise on our service not only when users share policy-violating content or engage in policy-violating behaviour, but also from system-level design choices that may contribute to or facilitate harm. We recognise that these risks can be influenced or exacerbated by certain 'Influencing Factors' (as described in Section 4.3: Influencing Factors), which have the potential to create or extend risks beyond user-generated content—such as through recommendation systems or product features—and that we have also sought to mitigate. Despite our best efforts, we alone cannot identify and address every risk that may arise. To address this limitation, we empower our Facebook community with tools to help us identify potential risks. We also respond to lawful requests from law enforcement, regulators, and courts, and work closely with other external partners in an effort to learn and to help keep users in the EU safe on our service (as described in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls).

Meta is committed to identifying, assessing, and mitigating systemic risks associated with use of Facebook, using the DSA Systemic Risk Assessment as one of our key primary assessment instruments.

5.1 Risk Analysis

Meta evaluated the inherent risk of 71 risks that cut across the 22 Problem Areas and determined the effectiveness of controls for Facebook to determine the residual risk for each in-scope risk. Notably, this year's assessment involved a more focused evaluation of risks, with fewer risks assessed compared to last year, but a greater number of Problem Areas considered, reflecting our continued maturation of the Risk Assessment methodology, as detailed in the Executive Summary. Controls were evaluated individually to determine how effectively they mitigated each risk, as applicable.[99] All residual risk scores were ranked and rated using an ordinal tiering scale from Tier 1 to 5 that allows us to measure Problem Areas consistently.

[99] More information on our Integrity Risk Assessment Methodology and Severity, Likelihood, and Control Effectiveness Rubrics can be found in Appendix 8.1 Risk Assessment Process.

5.1.1 Risk Rating

These Tiers denote the significance of the risk to users in the EU and are described as follows:

RISK RATING BY TIER

Tier	Description
TIER 1	Taking into consideration the severity and likelihood of the risk and the overall effectiveness of the suite of controls in place to manage and mitigate this risk, **it has been determined that the remaining exposure for this systemic risk is extremely low.**
TIER 2	Taking into consideration the severity and likelihood of the risk and the overall effectiveness of the suite of controls in place to manage and mitigate this risk, **it has been determined that the remaining exposure for this systemic risk is low.**
TIER 3	Taking into consideration the severity and likelihood of the risk and the overall effectiveness of the suite of controls in place to manage and mitigate this risk, **it has been determined that the remaining exposure for this systemic risk is moderate.**
TIER 4	Taking into consideration the severity and likelihood of the risk and the overall effectiveness of the suite of controls in place to manage and mitigate this risk, **it has been determined that the remaining exposure for this systemic risk is elevated.**
TIER 5	Taking into consideration the severity and likelihood of the risk and the overall effectiveness of the suite of controls in place to manage and mitigate this risk, **it has been determined that the remaining exposure for this systemic risk is extremely elevated.**

5.1.2 Problem Area Analysis: Inherent Risk

Inherent risk is a measurement of risk without mitigations in place. Meta currently has integrity risk mitigations in place, therefore, these inherent risk measurements are based on estimates. In order to measure this risk, we estimate the significance of: 1) the potential negative impact of a systemic risk to users and society ("Severity"), and 2) the possibility that the risk will occur in a specific time frame ("Likelihood"), **absent any mitigation measures**. As part of this evaluation, we consider how various Influencing Factors increase or reduce each of the Problem Areas and the associated risks.

During the assessment, we considered certain trends that could potentially impact the inherent risk exposure across the platform, such as elections in the EU, increasing adoption of GenAI, and conflicts in adjacent regions.

The Inherent Risk Results for each Problem Area are included in **Figure 2** and details on how inherent risk is calculated and broken down into Tiers can be found in Appendix 8.2.1: Inherent Risk Rubrics.

Figure 2. Inherent Risk Results

Problem Area	Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3	Tier 4	Tier 5
Account Integrity & Authentic Identity				■	
Adult Nudity & Sexual Activity			■		
Adult Sexual Exploitation				■	
Adult Sexual Solic. and Sexually Explicit Language			■		
Bullying & Harassment			■		
Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse & Nudity				■	
Coordinating Harm & Promoting Crime			■		
Dangerous Organizations & Individuals				■	
Discriminatory Practices		■			
Fraud & Deception				■	
Hateful Conduct			■		
Human Exploitation			■		
Inauthentic Behaviour				■	
Intellectual Property Infringement			■		
Misinformation			■		
Privacy Violations			■		
Restricted Goods & Services				■	
Spam			■		
Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders					■
Violence & Incitement			■		
Violent & Graphic Content			■		
Voice & Free Expression				■	

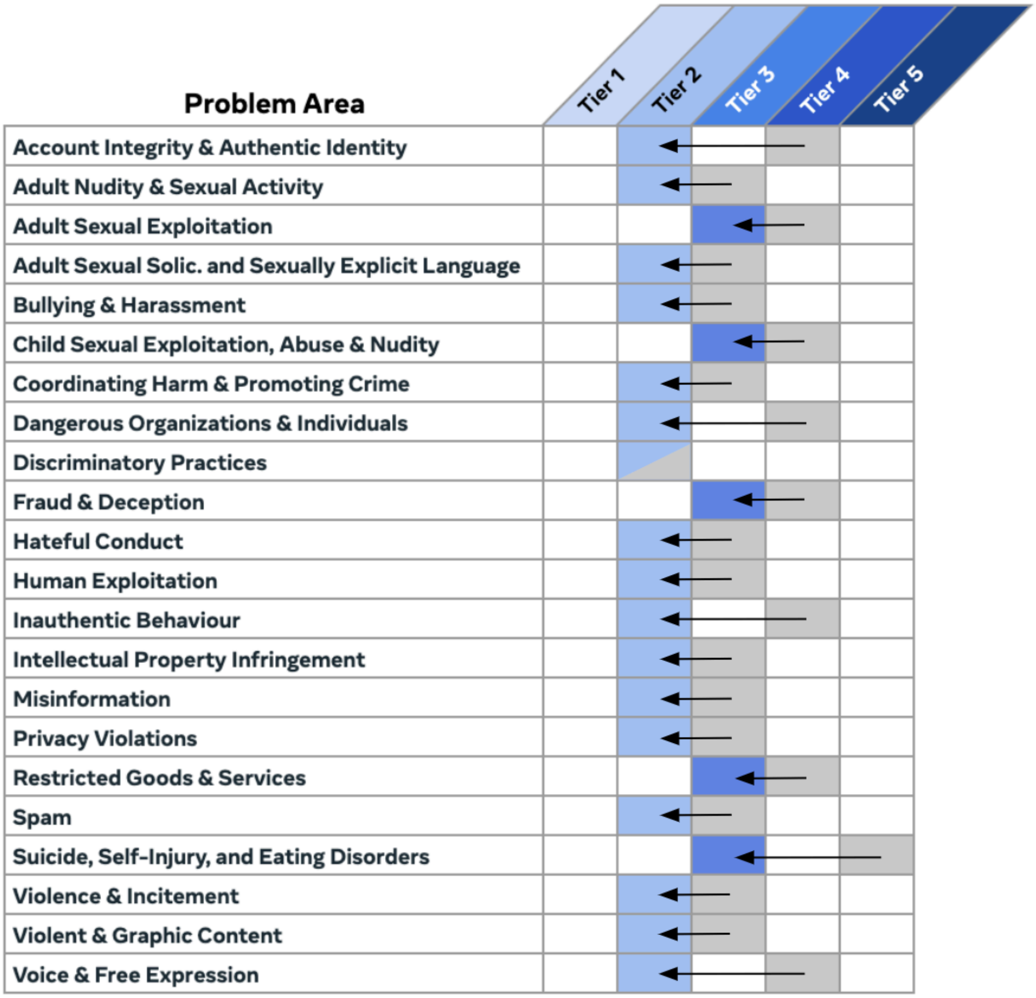
5.1.3 Problem Area Analysis: From Inherent Risk to Residual Risk

Inherent Risk represents the level of risk without controls or mitigating factors. Figure 2 illustrates the inherent risk levels for each Problem Area in the Year 3 Assessment. While most Problem Areas encompass a variety of risks with varied Inherent Risk Scores, the *Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders* Problem Area has the most risks with high Inherent Risk Scores. When factoring in our controls designed to mitigate and control risk, the overall inherent risk is reduced across all Problem Areas, resulting in a measurement of the residual risk.

Some of the Problem Areas with the highest average inherent risk, which also have some of the most notable reductions in residual risk due to the effectiveness of mitigations, are: (1) *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Nudity*, (2) *Adult Sexual Exploitation*, (3) *Dangerous Organisations and Individuals,* (4) *Voice and Free Expression*, *and* (5) *Suicide, Self-Injury and Eating Disorders*. The actual and foreseeable risk context of these

Problem Areas are further described in Section 5.2: Mitigating Measures Analysis along with controls in place to mitigate and control for their associated risks.

Figure 3. Residual Risk Results



The visual in **Figure 3,** demonstrates the residual risk results with the grey box representing inherent risk. The evaluation we conducted reveals our controls meaningfully reduce the inherent risk across all Problem Areas, shifting residual risk to Tier 2 and Tier 3. *Adult Sexual Exploitation*, *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity*, *Fraud and Deception*, *Restricted Goods and Services*, and *Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders* moved to Tier 3 residual risk due to a combination of methodology updates and in some cases, identified limitations in the control environment during the assessment period.

5.1.4 Scoring Overview: Year-Over-Year (YoY) Comparisons and Drivers of Change

In Year 3, Meta enhanced its Risk Assessment methodology to improve accuracy and reliability. These updates included refinements to our risk taxonomy, incorporation of additional quantitative and qualitative inputs, and improvements to how control effectiveness is modelled. As a result, these changes led to more Tier 3 and Tier 2 designations, reflecting a more precise distribution of scores—not a material increase in risk. For a summary of our control effectiveness modelling, see Section 8.2.2. Control Effectiveness.

While these methodological changes enhance the precision of our scoring, they also limit direct comparability with Year 2 scores. Still, both assessments offer valuable insights into platform-wide Systemic Risk and demonstrate the evolution of our risk measurement practices. Details outlining the methodology changes can be found in the Executive Summary.

Inherent Risk Changes

These methodological improvements are most apparent in our assessment of inherent risk—where changes in taxonomy, data inputs, and classification logic led to a rebalancing of scores across several Problem Areas.

We saw some of the most notable changes from Year 2 scores in relation to the *Voice and Free Expression* and *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity* Problem Areas. The majority of differences in inherent risk between DSA Systemic Risk Assessment Year 2 and Year 3 can be attributed to the methodology improvements implemented for Year 3, detailed in the Executive Summary. By more closely aligning the risk taxonomy with Community Standards and incorporating additional data on historical enforcement trends, we are able to better assess the inherent risk environment, which results in differences from the Year 2 Assessment. For example:

- The *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity* Problem Area was refined to better represent the range of severity. For example, previously, a parent posting a photo of their minor in the bathtub—which, while in some circumstances may be policy-violating, would generally be considered non-malicious—was not distinguished from more severe violations. The updated taxonomy now categorises such behaviours separately, while maintaining high scrutiny for severe cases.
- In the *Voice and Free Expression* Problem Area, in addition to the noted methodological changes, we also observed that as our content moderation systems and processes have become more complex over time, over-enforcement of our policies has consequently increased.

Control & Mitigation Updates

Generally the changes in control effectiveness observed from Year 2 are due to increased precision of our assessment in Year 3. We incorporated additional quantitative and qualitative data into the control effectiveness calculation and adjusted the calculation to better recognise the additive value of layered mitigations, which resulted in greater variation in the control environment between risks.

However, we did observe changes with the *Voice and Free Expression*, *Fraud and Deception*, and *SSIED* Problem Areas that are also due to changes in the control environment.

- Control effectiveness for the *Voice and Free Expression* Problem Area declined due to an increase in false positives driven by the growing complexity of content moderation systems. For example, in Q1 2025, 1.1 million of 2.5 million appeals on content removed under the Adult Nudity Community Standards were ultimately restored. Similar insights informed residual risk scoring.[100]

[100] Community Standards: Adult and Sexual Activity

- The reduction in control effectiveness in the *Fraud and Deception* Problem Area is due to limitations in Meta's ability to proactively detect scams and violating networks, as observed during the assessment period; remediation efforts are underway.
- The *SSIED* Problem Area saw a shift in residual risk, increasing from Tier 2 in Year 2 to Tier 3 in Year 3. While this change is partly attributable to the revised methodology, it also reflects identified limitations in the control environment during the assessment period—specifically, regarding pathways for escalating credible threats of suicide. These issues have been prioritised and remediation efforts are underway. The control environment will be reassessed once improvements are confirmed.

We worked to improve the overall effectiveness of our control environment. Since Year 2, Meta implemented new controls and enhanced existing controls, which are described in detail in Section 5.2: Mitigating Measures Analysis. Some enhancements that have been implemented since we finished our analysis of this assessment can be found in Section 6: Risk Mitigation Enhancements.

Our approach to risk mitigation involves developing and executing mitigations that are reasonable, proportionate, and effective to reduce risk exposure while maintaining our commitment to respect the human rights of our users, including the fundamental rights recognised in the EU Charter.

Residual Risk Movements

Many residual risk tiers remained stable year-over-year, while some risks increased in tier. In most cases, the shift in tiers reflects refinements in measurement and deliberate accuracy adjustments to our control effectiveness methodology rather than changes in the platform's underlying risk exposure.

- Differences in Year 2 and Year 3 residual risk tiers were observed for *Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity, Fraud and Deception, Inauthentic Behaviour, IP Infringement, Misinformation, Voice and Free Expression*, *Account Integrity and Authentic Identity*, *Restricted Goods and Services*, and S*uicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders* due to revised methodology as noted above, as well as limitations in the control environment in some cases.
- The *Violent and Graphic Content, Violence and Incitement, Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity, Adult Sexual Exploitation, Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language, Disinformation*, *Discriminatory Practices,* and *Spam* Problem Areas were either refined or new for Year 3, preventing year-over-year comparisons.

As Meta's Integrity GRC function continues to mature, we expect year-over-year comparisons to become increasingly reliable. Our evolving methodology enables more precise measurement of Systemic Risk, positioning us to make more informed, proportionate mitigation decisions in alignment with our human rights commitments and obligations under the DSA.

5.1.5 Systemic Risk Area Analysis: Residual Risk Ratings

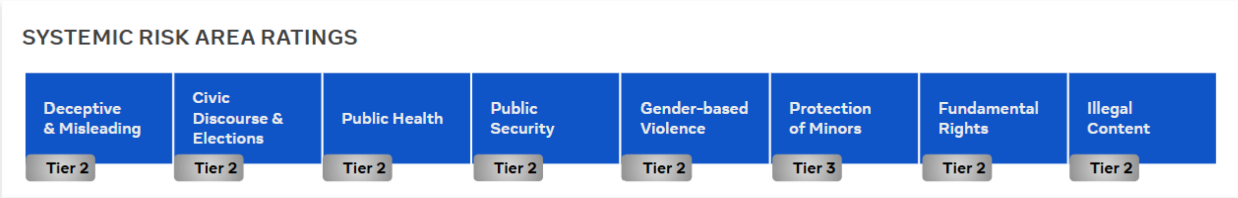
Once we assessed, evaluated, and measured all the identified Problem Area risks and accounted for mitigating measures in place, we then derived an overall risk rating for each Systemic Risk Area by combining the risk scores of each Problem Area associated with a Systemic Risk Area based on the Systemic Risk Landscape described in Section 4: Systemic Risk Landscape.

The image below depicts the current Tier Ratings across all Systemic Risk Areas, with a comparison to their relative rankings. Several Systemic Risk Areas have undergone tiering changes since 2024, including Deceptive & Misleading, Protection of Minors, and Illegal Content.

- The Protection of Minors Systemic Risk Area has shifted year-over-year from Tier 2 to Tier 3 due to the methodology updates that revised inherent risk by more consistently integrating key factors such as enforcement trends and subject matter expert input. Additionally, increased qualitative and quantitative signals enabled greater variation in control effectiveness, highlighting the improved accuracy of our assessment. This Systemic Risk Area has the greatest number of Problem Areas mapped, including the highest risk harms, so it was impacted the most from the scoring changes that occurred as a result of the methodology improvements.

- The Deceptive & Misleading Systemic Risk Area has shifted year-over-year from Tier 1 to Tier 2 due methodology updates as well as assessed limitations in proactive detection of *Fraud and Deception* (e.g., scams) on our platforms, as well as challenges in enforcing against violating actor networks.

- The Illegal Content Systemic Risk Area has shifted year-over-year from Tier 1 to Tier 2 due to methodology updates including a revised estimation of Inherent Risk for *IP Infringement* driven by severity and historical enforcement trends that indicate a high volume of counterfeit content and IP infringements.



5.2 Mitigating Measures Analysis

Meta has a robust set of controls in place to identify, mitigate, and manage risks. We continuously improve our ecosystem of controls and the Integrity GRC Programme to address evolving risks and regulatory requirements, including Article 35 of the DSA.

Our **Integrity Common Control Framework** groups documented integrity measures across our lines of defence including, but not limited to, governance models, platform infrastructure, operating processes, Facebook services, and the Integrity GRC Programme. We maintain an inventory of these controls, which maps them to risks ahead of assessment execution (see **Figure 4**).

This framework allows us to document controls clearly and consistently maintaining a single source of truth across all efforts requiring an understanding of Meta's hundreds of integrity controls.

Figure 4. Meta's Integrity Common Control Framework: Control Domain

5.2.1 Meta's Ecosystem of Controls

As illustrated in **Figure 4** above, Meta's controls are organised into control domains, encompassing controls that are implemented across Problem Areas and specific Problem Areas.

This subsection details how these control domains operate, in particular highlighting foundational controls. Information on some of the critical controls for each Problem Area is detailed below.

5.2.1.1 Policies and Standards

Meta is committed to giving people a voice while keeping them safe through globally applicable policies and standards, including our Terms of Service, Community Standards, and Advertising Standards. These define what is allowed and prohibited on our platforms.

We collaborate with global experts—spanning technology, public safety, human rights, CSOs, activist groups, thought leaders, and academics—to develop and update these policies. We prioritise collecting input from all communities, particularly marginalised communities. Our policies guide the development of safety features and enforcement through technology and human review. Transparency is maintained via our Transparency Centre, where policies, enforcement impacts, and reports are publicly available. Our Community Standards are translated into over 97 languages to ensure accessibility.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
AI Studio Policy	Meta maintains the AI Studio Policy, which governs the standards users must comply with when utilising AI Studio to create characters. The AI Studio Policy is public-facing and outlines standards such as subjects, names, photos or embodiments, attributes, and intellectual property that users must adhere to.
Child Safety Playbooks	Meta maintains playbooks that document how teams operationalise minor safety measures across Meta's platforms. These playbooks, which are embedded into the Meta Integrity Standards, inform the deployment of technology and enforcement activities related to minor safety at the content or account/actor level, including detection technology, classification systems, machine-learning (ML) algorithms, reactive user reporting, and root cause evaluations.
Commerce Policies	Meta publicly maintains Commerce Policies within our Transparency Centre Community Standards and other Policies page to provide guidance to sellers and buyers over products sold on Meta's platforms. The Commerce Policies are accessible by both users and non-users and include specific policies over prohibited and restricted content, as well as steps to take to appeal decisions, as needed.
Facebook Community Standards	Meta maintains public Facebook Community Standards that provide policy detail and guidance on what is and is not allowed on Facebook. The Facebook Community Standards detail the policies in place, rationale and aims of the policies, and behaviours that may result in a violation of the Community Standards.
Internally Assigned Turnaround Time (TAT) on User Initiated Reports	Meta maintains a process to respond to user initiated reports within the appropriate internally assigned turnaround times (TATs). Meta's Problem Integrity Operations sets and executes the Service Level Agreements (SLAs). Operational teams monitor performance against SLAs and put interventions into place so reports that pose the highest risk to users and society are reviewed expeditiously.
Meta Advertising Standards	Meta maintains public Advertising Standards that provide policy detail and guidance on the types of ads allowed at Meta and the types of ad content that are prohibited. The Advertising Standards also detail the ads review process and advertiser behaviour that may result in ads restrictions. The standards are reviewed periodically and updated on an as-needed basis.
Meta Integrity Standards	Meta maintains the Meta Integrity Standards (MIS) which are a set of standards that inform integrity mitigations to products prior to launch. Meta Integrity Standards require product integration with Meta's applicable integrity systems and apply to product launches that impact user-generated content and/or what users will be able to view on Meta's platforms.
Meta's Code of Conduct	Meta maintains a Code of Conduct that defines the expectations for behaviour and decision making for Meta personnel. The Code of Conduct is readily accessible on the People Portal to ensure that all employees are informed and accountable for maintaining integrity standards.
Policy Change Management	Meta develops and maintains a policy change management process to enable governance over changes made to Meta's Integrity policies. The policy change management process provides guidance over how teams at Meta can draft, propose, and make changes to existing Integrity policies, including references to the relevant sign-offs and forums used throughout the process. This policy change management process also covers vendor change management that impacts integrity work.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Policy Lab	Meta maintains internal Implementation Standards which outline how multiple vendors can differentiate between content that constitutes violations, and those that do not. The standards are broken down by Problem Area and include policy rationale and types of content that fall within different tiers of violation.
Privacy Policy	Meta maintains the inventory of its Privacy Policies, and ensures the completeness and accuracy of the inventory. The team reviews and, as appropriate, updates its privacy policies and disclosures when there is a material change in the way Meta collects, uses and shares Covered Information.
Product Policies	Meta's teams develop product-specific policies that are published on the Transparency Centre that aim to protect users and society from potentially harmful content or behaviour on Facebook and other Meta technologies, while also seeking to show them the content they want to see, thereby enhancing user value. These policies establish guidelines on how these products are managed, established, and governed for user safety.
Terms of Service (TOS)	Meta maintains and updates the Terms of Service which outline the restrictions and guidelines that govern the use of the platform. The Terms are written in clear, unambiguous language, and are easily and publicly accessible.

5.2.1.2 Systems and Product Integrity

Beyond standards enforcement mechanisms, we embed safety by design to protect users—especially minors and marginalised communities. Measures include age-gating certain content, parent guides (additional control details in Section 5.2.1.7 External Awareness and Support Resources), and default privacy settings for minors. We remove inappropriate content from minors' experiences, even if shared by friends, and automatically place minor users into stricter content control settings to reduce exposure to sensitive or potentially sensitive content.[101] Safety features like prompts, friction, blocking, and snoozing help users avoid or limit policy violations and unwanted interactions.

To maintain system integrity, we prioritise investment in new tools, routine training, evaluation, and monitoring of detection and enforcement systems. This includes testing efficacy, monitoring metrics, and triggers, preventing coordinated attacks, and reviewing new or updated services before launch.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Account Integrity and Verification	Meta maintains verification processes for official accounts related to elections, commerce, and paid content on Meta's platforms. Accounts may be reviewed by Meta prior to these accounts being able to post content and interact with users.

[101] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/01/teen-protections-age-appropriate-experiences-on-our-apps/

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Actor and Behavioural Framework (ABF)	Meta maintains the Actor and Behavioural Framework (ABF) to leverage behavioural signals and patterns for proportional actor-level enforcement actions. The ABF Framework is used to inform automated systems and human reviewers who work on enforcement across various policy areas.
Ad Restrictions for Minors	Meta has safeguards and restrictions around advertising, including minor-specific safeguards. This is done by limiting the types of ads that can be shown to minors; limiting both the ad targeting available to advertisers as well as the data used to reach minors with ads across Meta's platforms; and enabling a pause on serving ads for those users that we identify as minors in the relevant jurisdictions.
Age Appropriate Content Experiences	Meta implements processes to provide users under 18 years with age-appropriate content experiences on Meta's platforms. Meta leverages age-appropriate content detection and filtering methods to reduce minors' exposure to potentially harmful and inappropriate content.
Age Identification and Verification	Meta has processes to identify and verify users' ages on its platforms allowing Meta to provide age-appropriate experiences. Depending on the platform, Meta requires users seeking to change their age from under 18 to over 18 to verify their age through various verification options, such as uploading an identification (ID), and/or recording a video selfie.
Age-related Recommendation Restrictions	Meta implements age-related recommendation restrictions to reduce the likelihood of minors encountering potentially sensitive or low quality content. Through the Recommendations Guidelines, Meta works to avoid making recommendations that could be low-quality, objectionable, or particularly sensitive, and/or also inappropriate for younger viewers. Meta's integrity systems classify content as recommendable or not.
Age-Related Safety Measures	Meta has built age-related safety measures through features that minors can access to further protect themselves. Minors can adjust their settings and curate the content they see.
AI Labelling (Meta-generated)	Meta maintains tools to automatically label photorealistic images created using MetaAI and posted on Meta platforms. The GenAI Trust team uses a tool to label and identify images exhibiting certain industry standard AI technical identifiers which users post to Facebook that were generated using MetaAI.
Behaviour	Meta maintains a Behaviour Pillar to address and fight abuse across a spectrum of scale and sophistication from scripted and coordinated activity to deceptive links to various types of scams. Meta builds on multiple enforcement strategies (a mix of actions on actors, content, pages, links, etc.) and complex sets of signals to respond to sophisticated adversaries.
Best Interest of the Child (BIOC) Framework	Meta maintains the Best Interest of the Child (BIOC) Framework to help product and research teams understand and apply the UN's Convention's Guidance when building products for youth. The framework is intended to be referenced by all product teams during roadmapping efforts, strategic planning, and investment decisions at Meta, whether or not they are explicitly designed for youth in order to ensure that the best interests of the minor are actively considered in product design.
Blocking Function	Meta operates a technical blocking mechanism that allows a user to prevent another user from seeing their activity on Meta's products, including the user's profile, posts, or stories. Users can either go into their settings or profiles of another user to block.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Bug Bounty Programme	Meta maintains and promotes a Bug Bounty Programme to incentivise external individuals to responsibly disclose security bugs that could compromise the integrity of Meta user data, circumvent the privacy protections of Meta user data, and/or enable unauthorised access to a system within the Meta infrastructure. Individuals submit their findings, which are then triaged, validated, and remediated, as needed. The Bug Bounty Programme then compensates individuals for discovering impactful vulnerabilities to the organisation accordingly, with cash or other incentives.
Celeb-Bait Playbook	Meta maintains the Celeb-Bait Playbook which provides holistic guidance for the detection and enforcement of Celeb-Bait Ads. The Playbook guides Market Specialists on detecting both content, as well as actor behaviour signals, to retrieve relevant data points for effective enforcement.
Civic Actors (CVA) List	Meta maintains and updates the Civic Actors List to quickly provide protections for people in high risk election countries, as deemed by the Global Response Programme, due to their contributions to civic affairs, either online or offline. Individuals are identified to be Civic Actors (CVAs) through an internal submission form where approved employees may provide evidence of a high-risk individual's authentic account for consideration. Individuals are also identified based on vetted sources and through various platform signals. The CVA List is used to apply specialised protections, including enforcements related to impersonation, account compromise, and harassment.
Content Interstitials	Meta maintains content interstitials to warn or provide contextual information to users with regards to content that is not policy-violating but that may be sensitive for certain users. The interstitial is introduced to enable users to decide how to engage with potentially sensitive content.
Coordinated Attack Prevention	Meta maintains and uses the Coordinated Attack Discovery System to defend against coordinated attacks on Meta's platforms related to authenticity/identity verification. This system includes near-real-time visualisations of possible attacks, along with investigation tools to find and explore connections among attack clusters, particularly looking at recent traffic patterns.
Dangerous Organisation and Individuals (DOI) Designation	Meta oversees the process by which entities (organisations and individuals) that qualify as a 'Dangerous Organisation and Individual" (DOI) are added to the DOI Designations List. Designations are proposed through a designations nomination form and assessed by a cross-functional team of experts. This cross-functional team conducts a review of both on-platform and off-platform information to see if the nominated organisations or individuals meet the threshold for designation. If designated, measures are taken to remove all of the DOIs assets from the platform, as well as bank terms and images that represent the DOI in order to bolster continued scaled enforcement. All glorification, support, and representation of the designated DOI is also prohibited.
Design Taxonomy	Meta has a taxonomy of design patterns that have been identified as likely to be deceptive in order to avoid implementing such designs on Meta's platforms. The taxonomy utilises patterns flagged as noteworthy by key external sources (i.e., Digital Services Act DSA), European Data Protection Board (EDPB), and Federal Trade Commission (FTC)) to provide examples that represent deceptive designs that may lead a reasonable person to feel tricked, misled, coerced, or unduly pushed into doing something they wouldn't have otherwise chosen to do. The taxonomy is used by product designers as guidance for their designs to avoid deceptive designs.
Differential Review	Meta maintains a code review process within the Differential Tool where peer review is performed by an independent reviewer prior to the change being committed to the Central Code Repository. The author and reviewer of the change cannot be the same person. Once code has been reviewed and committed to the Central Repository, changes to the code cannot be made without re-initiating the code review process.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Epsilon	Meta maintains the Epsilon checkpoint which protects accounts that have been compromised and blocks bad actors from continuing to access the account. When there is suspicion that an account has been accessed by a bad actor, the account goes through four steps: block (lock down account so no further harm can be caused), authenticate (make person attempting to access account prove they are account owner), secure (help account owner secure account from future attacks), and restore (return account to former state).
Facebook Well-Being	Meta maintains a programme to support users on Facebook and prevent problematic use on the platform. Users are encouraged to access time management tools and resources to have better control and feel more agency over their experience on Facebook.
GenAI User Safety Measures	Meta protects users from potential harm or discomfort when interacting with Meta's AI products. Meta has mechanisms to respond to potentially sensitive issues.
Hack and Leak Playbook	Meta removes content claimed or confirmed to be from hacked sources, except in limited cases of newsworthiness. When a suspected hack and leak of material becomes known, the Strategic Response Policy team will drive a review of the content and actors, and escalate to leadership for a decision.
Hidden Words Function	Meta maintains the Hidden Words Function to empower users to filter out potentially offensive messages and comments on Meta's platforms. Users can better control their experience on Meta's platforms by hiding what they may find to be offensive, abusive, or otherwise unwanted interactions.
Identification of Suspicious Adults (Detection)	Meta maintains processes to proactively identify adults who display suspicious behaviour towards minors before they potentially perform policy-violating actions. Meta uses detection systems to identify risky interactions which are likely to be policy-violating behaviour.
Identity Verification and Authenticity	Meta has processes in place to verify a user's identity on Meta's platforms. Meta requests users provide a copy of an item with their name and date of birth or name and photo on it as proof of identification, such as a photo identification (ID) issued by a government, an ID from a non-government organisation, an official certificate, a licence that includes the user's name, with potential special ID requirements for some cases, such as advertisers running ads about social issues, elections or politics. Proof of identification is checked for usability and forgery via machine-learning models or human reviewers, then matched against the account profile.
Individual Verification for Account Ownership	Meta maintains processes for individuals to regain access to their accounts on Meta's platforms. When individuals are unable to access their accounts, they can recover them by following steps detailed on the specific platform's Help Centre based on the login issue they are experiencing, such as forgot password, forgot username, and disabled account, following necessary individual verification processes.
Large Language Model Safety	Meta maintains processes to improve the quality and safety of its large language models (LLMs). Quality processes include but are not limited to finetuning, hotfixing, redteaming, and pre-launch review.
Log Out	Meta maintains mechanisms to protect user accounts through a Log Out feature on Meta platforms. Users can log out of their account on different devices by navigating to the "Security and Login" section of the settings feature and view the "Where You're Logged In" section. Users are able to view a list of devices that have been recently used to log in to their account and have the option to log out of those accounts by following the instructions provided.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Login Challenges	Meta maintains a Login Challenges flow that is triggered after a user successfully logs into an account on a device not attributed to the user in the past. After a user successfully logs into an account on a new device, the user is required to approve the login via an approval push or jewel notification from another device which has already been attributed to the user or pass another authentication challenge.
ML Model Change Management	Meta maintains a code review process that requires any changes to machine-learning (ML) models and algorithm code to be reviewed by at least one other engineer before being pushed to the production environment. Differentials are drafted and reviewed by engineers who provide feedback on the code to help identify bugs and increase code quality. The differential review process tracks changes and ensures no one engineer can make changes to code on their own.
Pages, Groups, and Communities Admin Controls	Meta maintains in-product controls for admins running pages, groups, and or communities in apps to moderate certain types of content, keywords, and behaviour (e.g., harassment), even if it doesn't violate policy, to create a better space for the conversations they want to promote. Meta allows admins for pages, groups, and or communities to adjust controls.
Privacy Checkup	Meta manages the Privacy Checkup feature designed to help inform users on various privacy-related topics and adjust their privacy settings on Facebook. The feature is available on the settings page where users can review and change their privacy settings related to who can see what they share. Users can also explore a module of topics with information on how to keep their accounts secure, how people can find them on Facebook, their data settings on Facebook, and their ad preferences.
Risk Review	Meta maintains the Risk Review process to review new product launches across Meta's platforms, covering Privacy, Integrity, AI and Youth. Risk Review leverages a methodology that assesses products against established standards, identifies potential risks and provides mitigations, facilitated through the Launch Manager (LaMa) tool.
Private Accounts	Meta maintains privacy settings to protect user accounts, including minors, from their content being visible to users outside of their approved network. On Facebook, users have the option to limit who can see their content and profile details. When minor users under the age of 16 in the EU sign up for Facebook, specific privacy settings are defaulted to be only visible by accounts that the user follows or is a friend of.
Scam Account Score (SAS)	Meta maintains and develops an actor level signal, the Scam Account Score (SAS), that predicts the likelihood of an active account being a scammer on Facebook. The SAS is a score inclusively between 0 and 1 that is available on internal Meta platforms that provides a canonical signal for the probability that a Facebook user is a scammer. Teams across Meta can leverage the score to take action against accounts, such as restrictions or disable, depending on relevant thresholds.
Screen Time Insights	Meta provides guardians with visibility of their linked minor's screen time from usage of Meta's products. Guardians are able to view their linked minor's app screen time for the last seven days via a time chart on the Family Centre.
Security Checkup	Meta maintains security resources for users to access on Facebook, respectively. Security Checkup enables the review and addition of security measures to Meta users' accounts. Facebook users can enable Security Checkup at their own discretion and review password, two-factor authentication (2FA), and login alert features.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Snooze Function	Meta maintains a mechanism for users to control their online experiences by selecting what type of content and activities they see from other users on Facebook. On Facebook, users can enable this feature and choose who to mute which stops the user from seeing the muted user's stories. Facebook users are further able to control their online experiences with the snooze feature which is a mechanism for users to stop seeing posts in their feed from a snoozed user's profile, page or group for 30 days.
Strategic Network Disruption (SND)	Meta maintains the SND process which guides the strategic removal of actors and organisations involved in coordinated behaviours that facilitate real-world harm via the Meta family of apps and services. SND is done via Integrity, Investigations, and Intelligence's (i3) intelligence lifecycle which involves developing intelligence to understand the threat landscape, delivering targeted deference by proactively discovering and disrupting complex cases, enabling scaled problem reduction through institutional knowledge, and engaging the security and safety stakeholder community to build legitimacy and build programming.
Tag and Mention Controls	Meta maintains Tag and Mention controls to allow users to choose and customise when and who can tag them or mention them on Facebook. Tag review is not on by default, but users can use in-product settings to customise when they tag other people, when others tag them, and when they mention others or get mentioned.
Two-Factor Authentication	Meta maintains a two-factor authentication (2FA) process to increase security and decrease an account's vulnerability to hacks or unauthorised access on Meta platforms. There are several 2FA methods which send a notification to users at the time of login and allow users to utilise a second factor during the login process. A second factor can be a Short Messaging Service (SMS) sent with a code once or a security key that generates a code (a first factor is generally a password) which helps Meta authenticate a user's identity.
Unwanted Contact Restrictions	Meta maintains processes to protect minors from unwanted contact with adults. Features and resources on surfaces provide additional friction between adults and minors to prevent unwanted or unsafe behaviour.
User Consent Flow	Meta maintains an Internal Data Policy for User Consent Experiences which are product experiences that request permission to process user data. Each consent flow contains privacy elements including the consent request and consent options.
User Facing Privacy Controls - FB	Meta maintains user facing privacy controls to permit users to manage their privacy settings on Facebook. Users can navigate to the Privacy Settings page to adjust settings related to their privacy preferences.
User Mental Well-being Support	Meta maintains a repository of resources and tools to promote healthy online behaviours and provide resources for users on Meta's platforms. Resources and tools on mental health and well-being are accessible on the Safety Centre.
Why Am I Seeing This (WAIST)	Meta maintains the Why Am I Seeing This (WAIST) tool to provide users with information about why a particular ad appears in their feed or other surfaces across Meta's platforms. WAIST generates an explanation, based on machine-learning models and algorithms to personalise a user's experience, to highlight the most relevant factors that contribute to the ad shown to a user.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Youth Cross-Functional (XFN) Reviews	Meta manages the Youth XFN Review process which reviews applicable new product launches that target or impact youth users in order to protect youth users and comply with various regulatory obligations. New products or feature changes, with identified youth impact, are reviewed to help identify, assess and mitigate potential youth risks to user safety, rights, and protection. If potential youth risks are identified, relevant youth XFN teams document and communicate mitigation requirements.

5.2.1.3 Detection

Meta has automated detection systems to identify and act on content that violates our Facebook Community Standards, Advertising Standards, Commerce Policies, and other applicable policies and guidelines. Our technology proactively detects and removes the majority of violating content across formats (e.g., image, text, and video) before it is reported, as demonstrated in our Quarterly Community Standards Enforcement Reports.[102] Engineers, data scientists, and review teams continuously enhance these systems and measure their accuracy through precision metrics.

While no detection system is 100% accurate due to technical limitations that impose trade-off decisions between over and under enforcement (i.e. precision vs recall optimisation), we train models on the latest policies developed with input from CSOs, human rights defenders, marginalised groups, international organisations, Trusted Partners, investors, advertisers, and users.[103] This stakeholder engagement helps improve detection and understand the impact on diverse global communities.[104]

Working in close partnership with members of our Trusted Partner Network, we enhanced the Network's signal-sharing capabilities by standardising escalation channels and integrating them more effectively with our case management tools. The Trusted Partner Programme enables select civil society organisations to report harmful content directly to a specialised global escalations team via a dedicated submission form or email—separate from standard user reporting. The programme focuses on addressing content that may contribute to imminent harm, escalate social tensions, or undermine democratic processes, with priority given to content posing the highest salient human rights risk. Over a two-year period, spanning from Q2 2022 to Q4 2024, these improvements led to a 120% increase in content reported via the Trusted Partners in Europe, enabling us to better identify complex cases, novel harms, and inform policy and enforcement updates.[105]

We continue investing in technology, including model training on safety guidelines, content labelling, and support for detection efforts.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

[102] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/
[103] Precision tells us the percentage of cases that were genuinely true, out of the cases Meta labelled as true. Recall tells us the percentage of true cases Meta found, out of the possible true cases in the population.
[104] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/improving/bringing-local-context
[105] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/governance/tracking-impact/measuring-performance/

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Automated Proactive Detection Technology	Meta develops and maintains automated proactive detection tools for different content types across different surfaces. The automated proactive detection tools proactively detect and route potentially policy-violating content for automated decisions or manual review.
External Sharing of Blocklist	Meta develops and maintains processes and infrastructure to ingest and externally share signals related to harmful content on Meta's platforms. Depending on the programme, various APIs and processes are used to connect Meta and industry partners, non-governmental organisations (NGOs), and trade groups, governments to fight harm both on and off Meta. Sharing involves heavy privacy, legal, policy, and other stakeholder reviews, as well as a variety of contracts.
Fact Checkers	Meta partners with independent third-party fact-checkers in certain jurisdictions, who are certified through the non-partisan groups EFCSN within Europe and International Fact-Checking Network (IFCN) outside of Europe, to address viral misinformation. Fact-checkers review a piece of content and rate its accuracy. This process occurs independently from Meta and may include, but is not limited to, calling sources, consulting public data, and authenticating images and videos.
Limits for Repeated Non-Violating Reports	Meta maintains mechanisms to identify users, entities, or individuals that frequently submit notices or complaints that are manifestly unfounded. Meta suspends the processing of these notices or the user's ability to submit notices for a reasonable period of time. A query is run on a quarterly basis to identify potential repeated non-violating reporters and findings are reviewed with Legal. If confirmed, a prior notice will be sent out to the identified reporter and limits may be applied by tagging reporters via highlighting, which indicates to reviewers to ignore incoming reports from this reporter after receiving the prior notice for a reasonable period of time.
Proactive Detection Quality and Governance	Meta develops and maintains quality and governance measures to ensure proactive detection systems are operating effectively and efficiently, while also minimising the risk of false positives, biases, and other potential negative consequences. Meta establishes policies and protocols, develops and maintains high-quality training, monitors and evaluates model performance, and conducts regular audits and reviews.
Proactive Detection Systems - GenAI	Meta's AI Safety Team implements and adapts Meta's proactive detection technology to enable identification of potentially violating GenAI prompts and responses. Proactive detection systems are trained with synthetic data to identify and improve performance against GenAI content on Meta’s platforms. The AI Safety team determines strategy, confidence and accuracy requirements, and determines which systems should be leveraged to meet their goals. The team also works with cross-functional partners to review automated proactive detection results, identify areas of improvement, and train the model with new examples and/or data.
Proactive Detection Systems Implementation / Adaptation	Meta implements proactive detection systems through a combination of technology, data analysis and human expertise for relevant Problem Areas on Meta's platforms. Proactive detection systems are adapted by each Problem Area team to address concerns and nuances aligned with their respective policies by developing and maintaining high-quality training data, building and optimising detection models, and continuously improving and updating models.
Repeated Offender Identification - Manifestly Illegal Content	Meta maintains an internal tracking mechanism to identify individuals or entities that frequently post manifestly illegal content. This mechanism operates by tracking the number of times a user posts illegal content, and then on a case-by-case basis applying temporary suspension at the account-level based on set thresholds after having received a prior warning.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Rights Holders Reporting Tools	Meta maintains a variety of tools to support right holders to protect their content on Meta's platforms. The tools provide proactive and reactive levels of support, as well as the ability to request dedicated digital rights support, review channels, and enforcement methods.
Strike Policy	Meta maintains strike and persistent violator processes to identify repeat policy-violating offenders on in-scope platforms. Meta identifies repeat offenders through a variety of detection methods and continuous review over organic, commerce, and paid content areas.
Takedown Requests - Specialised Platforms Intake System (SPInS)	Meta maintains the Specialised Platforms Intake System (SPInS) to enable external parties such as governments, regulators, and law enforcement the ability to report and request the takedown of locally violating content. Meta administrators configure access or create new forms for external parties to submit relevant takedown requests. These submissions are then routed to the appropriate review teams.
Trusted Flaggers	Meta maintains Trusted Flaggers who are designated by the relevant regulatory authority. They are prioritised through their onboarding to a dedicated reporting channel via Specialised Platforms Intake System (SPInS). Trusted Flaggers submit reports of alleged illegal content on an ad hoc basis through a single point of contact form which are prioritised for review.
User/Entity Initiated Reports - Escalated	Meta operates and maintains forms that allow users and non-users to escalate potentially policy-violating or illegal content that are high-risk. The forms allow users and non-users to submit reports pertaining to potential policy-violating or illegal content that may require faster review turnaround times and higher priority. The report submissions contain relevant information, including substantiation and explanation of the content, the electronic information of the content, and the name and email address of the individual or entity submitting the report, as applicable.
User/Entity Initiated Reports - Policy Violating	Meta operates and maintains forms that allow users and non-users to report potentially policy-violating content and entities. The forms allow users and non-users to submit reports, either through in-app reporting options or through a form linked on the FB Home Page, containing relevant information, including substantiation and explanation of the content's illegality, the electronic location of the content, and the name and email address of the individual or entity submitting the report, as applicable.

5.2.1.4 Enforcement

Meta uses technology and review teams to detect and assess potentially violating content and accounts on Facebook. Enforcement is triggered by automated detection or user reports. Our machine-learning models and human review teams are trained on Facebook Community Standards, other policies, and human decision data to enforce content rules.

We apply a three-part enforcement approach to content enforcement:[106]

- **Remove:** Policy-violating content is removed;
- **Reduce:** Distribution of potentially sensitive but non-violating content is reduced; and

[106] https://transparency.meta.com/enforcement

- **Inform:** Users receive additional context to make informed decisions.

Meta holds users accountable for repeated violations of our Community Standards through mechanisms like our Strike System and associated account restrictions. Content may be restricted in a particular country following regulatory requests, court orders, or reports of unlawful local content after Meta's review.

Meta continuously evolves enforcement to balance effectiveness, user experience, and regulatory compliance. Key Year 3 updates related to enforcement include the following:

- In Q4 2024, Facebook implemented changes to its policies and enforcement measures. This improved the accuracy of our enforcement, helped prevent mistakes, and resulted in a significant reduction of "over-enforcement."

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Ad Review Process	Meta proactively reviews all advertisements before they are able to be published on Meta's platforms and implements an automatic 24 hour hold on distribution while in review. Some ads are also selected for reactive review after they are published for various reasons, including if a user reports the ad as potentially violating. The entire ad is reviewed to determine if it violates Meta's Advertising Standards. The decisions made during these reviews determine whether ads are approved and go live, or if they are disapproved and returned to the advertiser.
Automated Enforcement Decisioning	Meta develops and maintains enforcement technologies that review content and behaviours identified as potentially violating Meta's policies and determine whether to take enforcement action. The enforcement technologies leverage training data, including previous decisions made and policy language, to determine if the content or behaviour is in violation of Meta's policies. If the content or behaviour is deemed policy-violating, the enforcement technologies assign the appropriate enforcement action based on the severity of the violation and language in Meta's policies. If there is insufficient information to make an automated decision, the content or behaviour is sent for manual review by the human review teams.
Automated Enforcement Decisioning - Accuracy and Consistency	Meta maintains mechanisms to ensure its automated systems for detection are operating as intended. Meta has both quality assurance processes (e.g. training of models) and monitoring processes (e.g. metrics) to maintain and improve its quality of automated review processes.
Content and Entity Removal	Meta utilises enforcement technologies to remove individual accounts, complex objects, content, commercial listings, and ads found to be violating Meta's policies. Enforcement technologies leverage signals from automated and/or manual decisioning processes and remove violating entities from Meta's platforms.
Content and Entity Restriction	Meta utilises enforcement technologies to restrict content and/or entities on both paid and organic surfaces that violate Meta's policies across violation types. Each problem team may take different actions to restrict content and/or entity based on policies and protocols, including using enforcement technologies and leveraging signals from automated and/or manual decisioning processes.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Content Review Prioritisation	Meta maintains a content review prioritisation process to rank and prioritise content in order of importance for reviewers to action on potentially policy-violating content on Meta's platforms. The content review prioritisation process for enforcement considers the severity, virality, and likelihood of violation when determining what the human review team should prioritise.
Enforcement Actions - Accuracy and Consistency	Meta maintains mechanisms to ensure its automated systems for detection are operating as intended. Meta has both quality assurance processes (e.g., training of models) and monitoring processes (e.g., metrics) to maintain and improve its detection capabilities, the quality of automated review processes, and its enforcement mechanisms.
Integrity Actions Platform (IAP)	Meta maintains a centralised actioning tool to execute various enforcement actions. The centralised actioning tool is integrated with decision processes and tools to intake appropriate enforcement actions to apply.
Language and Cultural Coverage	Meta incorporates language and cultural coverage into its products and services, such as translation tools, to support agnostic review for automated and manual review processes. Meta also develops and maintains knowledge management tooling and internal repositories of policy documents, operational guidelines, and user education tools to be utilised in its automated and manual review processes.
Manual Enforcement Decisioning	Meta has dedicated review teams for manually reviewing potentially violating content and entities identified through proactive detection systems and third-party reports and determining whether the content and/or entities are in violation of Meta's policies. Human reviewers utilise review tools and guidelines to make enforcement decisions in accordance with Meta's policies.
Manual Enforcement Decisioning - Accuracy and Consistency	Meta maintains mechanisms to ensure the manual enforcement processes are operating as intended. Meta uses operational guidelines to establish standards, measurement systems to evaluate performance, and performance monitoring and continuous improvement processes to maintain performance.
Repeated Offender Enforcement - Manifestly Illegal Content	Meta applies warnings and enforcement actions on repeated offenders who frequently post manifestly illegal content by leveraging records of previous violations and determining appropriate action based on the number of violations and their severity.

5.2.1.5 Response and Notification

Meta has established response actions for crises that may impact platform risks, imminent threats to life, and when there is illegal activity. These include escalation and reporting to law enforcement and relevant authorities, following our Terms of Service and legal requirements. Cooperation with law enforcement agencies and collaboration with CSOs through dedicated reporting channels is central to our crisis response.

We also notify users and inform them of decisions related to their content and accounts in line with our standard processes.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Crisis Response Protocols	Meta maintains Crisis Response Protocols to help appropriately respond to an external event that may impact how Integrity risks materialise on Meta's platforms. Meta's response consists of cross-functional groups with varied areas of expertise (Global Ops, Policy, Comms, and Product Integrity) to evaluate risks associated with the crisis and their potential impacts, assess the effectiveness of controls to mitigate these risks, determine whether additional measures or actions are needed to address impacts, and implement measures to mitigate risks.
Elections Readiness	Meta maintains elections readiness processes to ensure rapid support for the period immediately around critical events. XFN stakeholders collaborate to establish operational handbooks, policy clarifications, and response processes, and training for relevant external parties on how to leverage existing content reporting channels (such as our Trusted Partner programme), and may also create new content reporting channels within the requirements set out by local law, as appropriate.
Enforcement Notification Processes	Meta maintains a notification process to notify users/non-users when Meta takes an enforcement action, including in response to a report of potentially illegal content or Community Standard violations, by sending notifications and statements of reason. The notification and statement of reason informs the recipient of the use of automation in decision-making and whether a review can be requested to appeal the decision. Where applicable, other potential options of redress, including out of court dispute settlement rights, are also provided to the user. Notifications are communicated in a timely manner, for both initial enforcement and relevant appeal decisions.
Mandatory User Data Preservation and Disclosure Obligations	Meta maintains processes to identify mandatory user data preservation and disclosure obligations. Meta reviews these processes to ensure compliance with user data preservation and disclosure obligations.
Potential Threat Investigation	Meta maintains a process to investigate potential threats to life or safety on Meta's platforms on a case by case basis and determine if law enforcement disclosure is necessary, in accordance with Meta's Terms of Service and applicable laws.
Reporting Acknowledgement Processes	Meta maintains a report acknowledgement process to inform users that their reports have been received. For in-app reporting, users receive automatic in-app confirmations on their reports, and there is a display for the status of their requests. For out-of-app reporting using the contact form, users receive the acknowledgement via email.
Reporting Credible Threats to Authorised Government Authorities	Meta maintains processes for reporting credible threats to life or safety, when identified on Meta's platforms, to authorised government authorities via established processes on a case-by-case basis. Meta reports credible threats to life or safety in accordance with Meta's Terms of Service and applicable laws.
Statement of Reasons	Meta provides a statement of reasons in notifications sent to users after Meta takes an enforcement action that explains why the respective enforcement action was taken and informs users which of the Community Standards, or other relevant terms or policies have been violated. Meta notifies users of their decisions, and provides a formal "statement of reasons" explaining any decision to remove or restrict visibility to a specific item of content and/or a user's account and to inform users of what redress mechanisms are available to appeal the decision.

Targeted Search	Meta maintains a process where individuals with relevant clearance can search Facebook on an ad-hoc basis for measurement, intelligence gathering, and/or enforcement purposes, given that the search meets a defined search criteria. They are intended to identify contents violating Meta's Community Standards where there is a sense that searching for such content could be broadly justified (e.g., real-world threat of harm). Targeted Searches are initiated, tracked and determined to be eligible for legal approval (meets the defined search criteria) through the Targeted Search Form. The Targeted Search Form incorporates within it the legal guardrails to ensure that the Targeted Search meets the criteria legal has determined to be permissible.
Temporary Risk Reduction Measures	Meta deploys temporary processes or tools to reduce the likelihood that people see harmful content on its platforms during critical moments or in situations with elevated risk of violence or other severe human rights risks. Meta's teams of specialised cross-functional experts closely monitor trends on and off platform and investigate situations to determine whether and how best to respond. Meta also may coordinate with teams to determine responses. As appropriate, Meta may apply limited, proportionate, and time-bound measures that can be quickly implemented to address a specific emerging risk.
Voter Interference	Meta prohibits content conveying incorrect information regarding methods and logistics of voting (how to vote/when to vote), or instructions or intent to commit voter fraud. Meta aims to remove all instances of voter interference by identifying new violating claims, finding similar violating claims, and removing any violating claims.

5.2.1.6 User Rights and Recourse

Meta is committed to respecting the fundamental rights of our users located in the EU and upholding human rights in all actions. Users can appeal content removal decisions through dedicated review teams and technology, which reassess the content against our Community Standards. Users are then notified if their content is reinstated or confirmed as violating standards.

Users may also appeal to the independent Oversight Board, which reviews complex content moderation cases and issues recommendations based on international Human Rights Standards. Since inception, the Oversight Board has reviewed 146 cases, and Meta has responded to 309 of the Oversight Board's recommendations with details published in our Transparency Centre.[107] These include, among others, decisions about content regarding explicit images generated through AI and updates to our Transparency Centre about "Our Approach to Dangerous Organisations and Individuals" where we provided details about how and why we designate an organisation or individual.[108, 109, 110]

Additionally, Meta provides a user-friendly process for users to appeal to certified ODS bodies as required by DSA Article 21. Users are informed of their right to escalate disputes, and Meta supports ODS bodies via a secure portal and API to exchange dispute information. Human reviewers assess ODS decisions and communicate outcomes accordingly.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

[107] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/oversight/overview
[108] https://transparency.meta.com/en-gb/oversight/oversight-board-cases/explicit-ai-images
[109] https://transparency.meta.com/oversight/oversight-board-cases/shaheed-pao
[110] https://transparency.meta.com/oversight/oversight-board-recommendations/

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Ads Targeting	Meta maintains technical and organisational measures to ensure information with special protections (including Sensitive Categories of Data (SCD)) are not used to show users personalised ads. Meta uses automated systems to prevent this information from being used for ads profiling and verifies the effectiveness of these measures.
Appeals Handling Standard Operating Procedures SOPs	Meta maintains Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) that detail processes and activities to ensure complaints such as appeal processes are handled in a timely, impartial, and non-arbitrary manner regardless of the content or user involved. SOPs include processes and criteria for consistent decision-making, training and human reviewers, user notifications, record-keeping, and turnaround times for handling of appeals.
Appeals Process - Actors	Meta maintains a process for actors to appeal Meta's enforcement decisions over content the actor created/posted and that was taken down. If the actor chooses to appeal Meta's original enforcement decision, the content is re-reviewed to determine if it violates Meta's Content Policies. Actors may appeal the original enforcement decision within six months and are able to provide further context for Meta to review.
Appeals Process - Reporters	Meta maintains a process for reporters to appeal Meta's enforcement decisions. If reporters choose to appeal Meta's original decision, the content is reviewed to determine if it violates Meta's policies or where applicable, local law. Reporters may appeal the original enforcement decision within six months and are able to provide further context/rationale for Meta to review.
Automated Review of Appeals	Meta utilises automated review systems to determine whether the appealed content violates Meta's policies. These systems perform tasks including recognising content in photos, videos, or text in accordance with Meta's policies to inform appropriate enforcement actions for appealed content. This excludes unlawful content appeals and other appeals that are regulatorily required to be reviewed manually. The automated review systems undergo governance measures including sampling and feedback loops to update the systems as needed to ensure they are operating effectively and efficiently.
Content and Account Restoration and Reinstatement	Meta maintains processes to restore content, reinstate suspended accounts, or reverse an enforcement action after a successful appeal. After an appeal is accepted, the applicable enforcement action is reversed by restoring removed content, removing warning labels, removing demotion actions, or reinstating accounts and account features.
Content Experience Personalisation	Meta offers users the ability to control how much of certain types of content (sensitive) they see in their feeds. Users can control if they wish to see more or less (depending on the content type) of this content in their feed.
Edit Rejected Ad	Meta provides capabilities in Ads Manager for advertisers to edit ads that have been rejected due to non-compliance with Meta's policies. Advertisers can edit an ad by reviewing the rejection details in Ads Manager and can edit the ad, request another review of the ad, and monitor the review status. Editing the ad also triggers an integrity re-review for violation of Meta's ads policies.
Newsworthy Inform Treatment	Meta maintains and operates a tool to label content as newsworthy. Upon escalation, Meta determines and may allow newsworthy content potentially in violation of Community Standards on their platforms for public awareness, even if it violates the Meta Community Standards.

Non-Profiling Experience	Meta offers experiences not based on profiling across different product surfaces, which allows users in specific jurisdictions to experience those products without the use of *the GDPR definition of profiling in* content ranking or recommendations. Users are able to access the non-profiling options directly in the browsing surface as well as through alternative experiences, and are thus provided with a choice if they do not want to use recommender systems based on inferences that Meta's systems make based on the profiling options.
Out-of-Court Dispute Settlement Options	Meta educates users/non-users on their out-of-court-dispute settlement options. Meta engages in good faith with out-of-court dispute settlement bodies (ODS bodies), such as DSA Article 21 certified bodies, to resolve these disputes.
Product Specialist Reviews	Meta regularly monitors bugs and reports from users and reports out to product teams. Product specialists perform a monthly analysis of the user bugs and document actions being taken on the product side to resolve the issues.

5.2.1.7 External Awareness and Support Resources

Meta continuously develops a library of tools and resources to help users stay safe and understand platform policies, reflecting our Community Standards and fostering a culture of respect and empathy.

Our Safety Centre offers support on topics, such as mental health and well-being, bullying and harassment, online minor protection, intimate image abuse, and sextortion. It includes tailored resources for vulnerable communities, including women, youth, journalists, human rights defenders, public figures, and the LGBTQ+ community.

We provide crisis support resources by country and offer guidance for parents, educators, and law enforcement.[111] The Facebook Help Centre also offers safety information for users.

In the last year, Meta updated its external resources, including updates to our policy documentation on the Transparency Centre related to new or enhanced AI features like AI-generated images.[112]

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Ad Blueprint Training	Meta provides external e-Learning training through its Meta Blueprint programme for agencies, marketing partners, clients and Small Business Groups. Content is readily available on Meta Blueprint and enables people to gain foundational knowledge on Meta's advertising practices, including explaining how ads work and restrictions that apply.
Branded Content Tool	Meta maintains the Branded Content Tool, which provides users with the opportunity to declare that their content contains commercial communications by adding the "paid partnership" label to their content via a self-serve tool provided by Meta. The user can indicate a relationship with the affiliated Brand/Company before being able to tag them and tagged branded content must comply with the content-level prohibitions and restrictions prescribed in Meta's Branded Content Policies for FB.

[111] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/crisis-support-resources
[112] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/other-policies/meta-AI-disclosures

Family Centre	Meta maintains the Family Centre, which provides users with resources, insights and expert guidance to help users support their family's online experiences on Meta's apps and across the internet. The Family Centre has information about the tools across products, as well as the Education Hub which provides informational resources and tools across Meta's products.
Help Centre	Meta maintains the Help Centre, which provides users with a centralised hub for support across Meta products and services. The Help Centre provides links to product support, Meta shops, Meta help, specific help centres for Meta apps, and support for different types of users.
Parent's Guide	Meta proactively maintains and updates the Parent's Guide to support parents and guardians with policies, resources and tools that help to protect the safety and well-being of minor's online experiences on Meta's platforms. The guide is accessible to Parents through the Family Centre which includes information on how to manage minor's privacy, interactions, comments, time security, and supervision tools and resources across Facebook platforms.
Privacy Centre	Meta maintains the Privacy Centre with resources for users, including minors, to access and learn how to manage and control privacy across Meta Products. The Privacy Centre provides references, tools, education, and answers to privacy-related questions to empower users to customise their privacy experience.
Quick Promotions on Campaign Studio	Meta updates, deploys, and monitors Quick Promotions (QP) that are created via the Campaign studio tool or directly via API provided by QP team. These QPs are running on off-app channels (i.e., notifications and emails) and in-app Meta-to-User communication platform across the Family of Apps. The Quick Promotions team launches QPs to drive growth/engagement for products, deliver critical legal notices, educate users, deliver surveys, or provide any other communication with users. The Campaign Studio tool and QP creation APIs allows for the creation and management of QPs, including choosing the surface it will appear on, defining the eligibility rules and content, testing the QP, and deploying it in production and monitoring it.
Safety Centre	Meta maintains a Safety Centre to house documentation about Meta's approach to safety across Facebook. The Centre, available in over 60 languages, can be accessed by users and non-users and includes information, resources, and news to document Meta's approach toward safety for all users on their platforms. These resources can be accessed by users and non-users for specific safety topics and communities to empower individuals to obtain the support they need, specific to the area they are looking for.
Self-Disclosed Transparency Reporting	Meta maintains self-disclosed reporting and report writing processes to develop and publish their self-disclosed transparency reports and to ensure compliance with their self-disclosed reporting requirements. This process is managed by a cross-functional team that develops and publishes transparency reports supporting materials, templates and roles and responsibilities in accordance with Meta's reporting cycle and by the required timelines.
Sponsored and Paid Partnerships Labels	Meta maintains "Sponsored" Labels for paid ads across Meta's platforms to communicate to users that the content being viewed is being promoted in an advertisement. This is done through applying a prominent "sponsored" label on this content.
Suicide and Self-Injury Content Response	Meta sends resources to users who have posted/reported content that is identified as being suicidal or self-harm related. If the content indicates credible intent, the team escalates the content for further action as appropriate. Users reporting such content are also provided with a link to resources that direct them to the Help Centre page that has information and resources, including the suicide hotline.

Transparency Centre	Meta maintains its publicly accessible Transparency Centre that provides further information regarding Meta's content moderation policies, how Meta enforces its policies, complaints handling process, self-disclosed and statutory transparency reports, and parameters used in recommender systems.
Voter Empowerment Features	Meta maintains and launches election-specific product features to encourage voter participation in free and partly-free elections globally. Resources with information relevant to voting-age users are provided to connect them to authoritative information regarding elections.

5.2.1.8 Internal Training and Resources

Meta provides comprehensive training to employees and contingent workers, including human reviewers, to support enforcement of Community Standards and policies. Training covers Meta's Community and Integrity Standards, moderation processes, Problem Area trends, risk and compliance best practices, and regulatory requirements.

We have routine updates and retraining processes to address policy changes and enforcement issues. Additionally, Meta offers resilience, health, and wellness resources to support reviewers who handle objectionable or graphic content.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Policy Role Based Training	Meta develops and provides training to employees based on the role they undertake in order to equip them with the necessary knowledge and skills to perform their specific roles effectively. The exact nature of the training varies depending on their role, but includes onboarding, technical, and policy and compliance training, as needed.

5.2.1.9 Risk Assessment

Meta manages a complex and evolving integrity risk landscape due to the global scale of our services, rising online challenges, and rapid growth in user-generated content. To address this, we have established Risk Assessment Processes, including the annual DSA Systemic Risk Assessment and CIRAs (as applicable) to identify, analyse, and mitigate integrity risks.

As our compliance programme matures, we remain committed to strengthening risk management and coordinating both ad-hoc and annual Risk Assessments.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Crisis Response Assessments	Meta reports on Crisis Response Assessments to identify and assess whether external events impacting the functioning and use of Meta's services are significantly contributing to a serious threat. Meta's crisis response reporting includes specifically internal crisis response protocols (IPOC, Global Response Operations Crisis Protocol, etc.) using internal protocols to evaluate the impact of the risks associated with crisis response, and Crisis Policy Protocol (CPP). Assessment of the risks associated with sensitive external events, such as wars, protests, and elections, may require controls to be updated to ensure the external events are managed appropriately.
Critical Impact Risk Assessment	Meta conducts Critical Impact Risk Assessments, which are targeted Risk Assessments prior to deploying new functionalities that are expected to have a critical impact on our systemic risks. Meta utilises guided questions to assess whether a new functionality, operational change, or similar event could create or influence a systemic risk and meet the threshold to trigger the need for a Critical Impact Risk Assessment to be completed. If a Critical Impact Risk Assessment is triggered, systemic risks that could arise given the functionality being deployed are identified, analysed, and assessed with subject matter experts using a defined methodology, framework, and templates.
Election Risk Assessments	Meta conducts Risk Assessments to identify and assess high risk election events impacting how risk materialises on Meta's platforms in the context of elections. These assessments consist of examining the risks associated with the elections and assessing the effectiveness of relevant control frameworks to better understand any areas for improvement and stress-test current systems. The Risk Assessments help identify specific content spikes and operational, policy, or product gaps that may require controls to be updated to ensure risks are appropriately managed.
Human Exploitation Market Prioritisation Framework	Meta updates and maintains the Human Exploitation (HEx) Market Prioritisation (MPri) Framework tool on an ongoing basis to quantify the problem manifestation risk and solutions coverage per market in order for Meta to decide where to dedicate resources. The framework covers Minor Sex Trafficking (MST), Sex Trafficking (ST), Coordinated Commercial Sexual Activity (CCSA), Human Smuggling (HS) and Labour Exploitation (LEx). MPri employs a data-driven methodology integrating diverse internal and external data sources and uses a weighted scoring system for quantification of these risks.
Investigations - i3E	Meta conducts investigations regarding actors and their behaviours that have been internally or externally identified as potentially pertaining to Problem Areas including Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Nudity and Human Exploitation. The team reviews actors and uses their analyses of on-platform activity to improve detection signals, route for appropriate enforcement actions and, if applicable, escalate to other internal partners.
Meta AI Risk Assessment	Meta conducts Risk Assessments to systematically evaluate the potential risks associated with AI models and systems prior to launch. The Risk Assessment evaluates potential risks, documents mitigation strategies and residual risks across a comprehensive set of risk categories prior to in scope AI launches.
Comprehensive Salient Human Rights Risk Assessment	Meta manages a company-wide comprehensive Salient Human Rights Risk Assessment performed by a third-party vendor to identify and document Meta's most salient rights risks in order to provide recommendations to mitigate identified risks. The assessment is performed to develop recommendations to help mitigate risks and inform future strategy. In the event the salient Risk Assessment cannot be successfully completed, the Meta Human Rights Director will document the reasoning with appropriate sign-off. Results are shared in our annual Human Rights Reporting.

SEV (Site Events) Reviews	Meta maintains the SEV Review tool that facilitates the SEV Review process to learn from site events (SEVs) across Meta with the goal of not repeating similar SEVs. Corresponding teams at Meta discuss a selection of SEVs in periodic meetings to permit first responders to present their incident reports to an audience and discuss root causes and follow up items. The SEV Reviews happen at team, organisational and company levels, depending on the level of severity of the incident and the incident impact.
Trend and Issue Analysis	Meta generates intelligence through trend analysis, issues analysis, and discoverability stress testing methodologies to determine potential emerging risks that may impact Meta's operations. Meta works with cross-functional partners to identify, assess, and drive accountability for high risk threats through various high quality analytics reporting such as continuous intelligence update (CIU), preliminary trend analysis, deep dive issues analysis, and stress testing.

5.2.1.10 Governance

Meta maintains robust governance frameworks across the three lines of defence for integrity matters, covering decision-making, accountability, compliance, and oversight. Key components include:

- **Enforcement Decisions (First Line of Defence - 1LOD):** Monitoring and measuring enforcement accuracy against policy-violating content on Facebook;
- **Integrity System Changes (1LOD):** Managing changes to integrity systems, including multi-person review and sign-off for detection system updates;
- **Integrity Reviews (1LOD):** Assessing planned services and feature launches against defined integrity standards before release (additional control details found in Section 5.2.1.2 Systems and Product Integrity);
- **Risk and Compliance Oversight (Second Line of Defence - 2LOD):** Executing routine risk and compliance processes to identify risks and assess the effectiveness of our controls carried out by the Integrity GRC team with oversight from our EU Integrity Compliance Office (ICO);
- **Internal Audit (Third Line of Defence - 3LOD):** Independent assurance on the design and effectiveness of risk, compliance, governance, and control processes;
- **External Audit:** Independent verification of compliance with DSA requirements and governance processes; and
- **Management Body Oversight**: The DSA Head of Compliance reports to the management body, which oversees risk management for Facebook services in the EU.

Meta continues to strengthen and adapt its governance mechanisms as its compliance programme evolves.

The table below details the foundational controls assessed in the Year 3 Systemic Risk Assessment as it relates to this control domain.

Foundational Control Name	Foundational Control Description
Human Rights Due Diligence	Meta conducts human rights due diligence and impact assessments to identify salient human rights issues in the context of Meta's products, policies, and operations. The outcome of the due diligence and impact assessments aid in the creation of strategies to mitigate these risks on Meta's platforms.
Local Law Content Restrictions	Meta maintains a process to identify, process, address, and restrict (where applicable) content that is reported to Meta in violation of local law. Meta has reporting mechanisms to enable governments, regulators, courts, non-government entities, and members of the public to report illegal content. If the content does not violate Meta's policies, a review is conducted to validate the reported illegality. If it is determined the content is illegal, following a human rights review, Meta may enforce upon the content by restricting the content in the relevant jurisdiction(s) and notifying the reporter accordingly.
Local Law Review	Meta updates procedures for how they review locally illegal content in response to local law and scale these reviews.
Meta Privacy Programme and Governance	Meta maintains a programme for Meta's compliance to global regulatory privacy obligations. Meta develops frameworks to help place user privacy at the centre of Meta's products and services in accordance with our regulatory obligations. Meta partners with cross-functional teams to document current practices, scale safeguards, and identify and remediate gaps as needed.
Oversight Board	Meta maintains an independent content appeals process that is overseen by the Oversight Board. The Oversight Board is a global body of experts that provides independent review and decisions of Meta's product content decisions. The Oversight Board hears cases in instances where users disagree with the outcome of Meta's content decisions and have exhausted appeals or Meta directly submits the case for review. Decisions by the board are independent, binding (unless implementing the decision could violate the law), accessible to users, and transparent. Recommendations are not binding and are implemented at Meta's discretion. The only binding requirement for recommendations is for Meta to publicly disclose the action it takes in response.
Partnerships and Collaborations	Meta establishes partnerships with external groups to inform Content Policy development, enhance transparency around the policies and their implementation, and provide additional resources for Meta platform users. Meta's partnerships and collaborations help inform Meta's Content Policies, and they help Meta develop integrity protections and informational resources that are made available to users, in an effort to minimise harm and protect voice and well-being. Resources are shared with users via designated locations on Meta's website (e.g., the Newsroom, the Safety Centre, and the Community Standards page).
Response to Law Enforcement Requests for Preservation or Disclosure of User Data	Meta responds to requests from law enforcement for preservation or disclosure of user data in accordance with applicable laws and our Terms of Service.

Response to Law Enforcement Requests Process	Meta implements and maintains jurisdiction-dependent turnaround times for law enforcement in jurisdictions where Meta is obligated to offer it. The Legal and Operations teams identify the mandated turnaround time for a response, track resolution time, triage requests as needed, and send a response to law enforcement describing the outcome of the report .
Traffic Light System (TLS) / Geo-Blocking Policies	Meta maintains Traffic Light System Policies based off of the Regulatory Compliance Policy (RCP) Due Diligence Assessment to support Operations teams in making efficient review decisions based on identified content trends. The policies are created in collaboration with XFN to guide Operations teams in how to respond to takedown requests from regulators/courts/users from a particular country. The TLS policies create a scalable, responsive, and future proof review model to empower Operations teams to make content decisions which reduces escalations to Legal and RCP.
User/Entity Initiated Reports - Locally Illegal Content	Meta operates and maintains a service that allows users / non-users to report potentially illegal content in their local jurisdiction. Users / non-users can submit reports over potentially illegal content with relevant substantiation, such as the post, comment, profile, or other information over the content in question. The content is then reviewed to determine if it is in violation of Meta's policies and local laws. Users / non-users are updated of report decisions via in-app, or email notifications.

5.2.2 Detailed Risk Observations and Mitigating Measures

The following subsections detail some of the key trends identified in this assessment, the critical controls that are in place to manage these Problem Areas, including some of the ecosystem of controls that are detailed in Section 5.2.1 Meta's Ecosystem of Controls.

5.2.2.1 Account Integrity and Authentic Identity

We believe that authenticity helps create a community where people are accountable to each other, and to Meta, in meaningful ways. We want to allow for the many ways that identity is expressed across our global community, while also addressing impersonation and misrepresentation. To maintain a safe and open environment where people can build community, we do not allow for the creation of accounts or profiles that are created or used to deceive others.

Account Integrity and Authentic Identity is associated with various Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA, including Deceptive and Misleading, Civic Discourse and Elections, and Protection of Minors. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to deceive or mislead users through the use of compromised accounts, accounts and advertisers that are not authenticated or verified correctly, and threat actors returning to the service after being banned (e.g., recidivism). As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, there are instances in which threat actors build tools to create many accounts at once, known as "scripted abuse".

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. The EU Parliamentary Elections have contributed to activity, although at a more typical level compared to the previous year's high volume of elections. Ongoing advancements in GenAI increase impersonation of high-profile individuals and content piracy, which is more prevalent during times of geopolitical conflicts, war, or other crisis events. Additionally,

industry GenAI and evolving technology makes it increasingly more difficult to verify identity using government IDs as it has become easier to forge official identification. Lastly, we see threat actors who have been able to compromise / hack other users' account, purposefully share child sexual abuse materials (CSAM) content to get these accounts disabled, and gain control of linked business accounts.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Account Integrity and Authentic Identity,* we have built a combination of automated and manual mechanisms to block, remove, and prohibit the creation of accounts that violate our Community Standards.

On Facebook, we require people to create one account using the name they go by in everyday life that represents their authentic identity. We created Additional Profiles to help people express different parts of their identity, such as their interests or businesses. Meta has a separate Names Policy to block inherently violating words in names (e.g. users cannot create accounts called 'Hitler'); users are able to appeal blocked names with a valid ID. In some cases, such as authorisation for advertisers running ads about social issues, elections, or politics, there may be special identification requirements.

Meta protects the integrity of user accounts through proactive security measures, such as optional two-factor authentication and sophisticated machine-learning models that trigger advanced account notifications (for example, alerts following suspicious login attempts). However, because two-factor authentication is not mandatory for all users, this remains a potential vulnerability. We provide users with an in-application mechanism that enables them to view devices that have recently logged into their account and remotely log out, as needed. We have also built many impersonation related user education interventions on the platform, including in-product user messages / warnings and links to Help Centre educational resources in the event a user receives a request or message to follow or become a friend of their account from a new or unknown account with no mutual connections.

Meta has built classifiers that can help detect if a threat actor that has already been removed from the platform is behind the creation of a new account or other entities, and will remove them from our platform(s). Meta continuously improves its ability to detect scripted abusive accounts, and put in place net new actions to mitigate account takeover by introducing additional verifications, such as log-in challenges, age checks, and verification of contact points.

Identifying compromised accounts is challenging, especially if the device itself has been compromised. However, the user can recover the account using personal documents or face recognition. To prevent any further activity from compromised accounts, Meta constantly works to improve its ability to identify compromised accounts at or before the point of compromise. For example, we are looking to improve signals from users' trusted devices to reduce friction for account owners, as well as to give users more options to clear compromise checkpoints. There is also ongoing work to prevent users from experiencing initial account compromise by focusing on ensuring users have healthy contact points, protecting sensitive account changes and additions to the user experience to give users increased visibility of what is happening in their account. Significant investment is being made to identify and ingest more signals to identify compromised accounts, such as deploying compromise models to proactively identify when we think an account may be at risk of compromise. Depending on the model scores and risk type, accounts will be notified of suspicious activity, or automatically put into varying checkpoints in order to secure their accounts from potential threat actors (for example, Hack Lock Checkpoints).

Lastly, we require users to be at least 13 years old to sign up and provide a reporting mechanism for users to report an account belonging to someone under 13. If an account is reported for someone who is reasonably verifiable as being under 13, the account will promptly be deleted.[113] Additionally, services like Facebook Dating require users to be at least 18 years old. All people on Dating must follow our Community Standards. To help keep our community safe, we may ask users to verify their Dating profile to prevent impersonation or underage use of Facebook Dating.[114]

5.2.2.2 Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity

Meta understands that nudity can be shared for a variety of reasons, including as a form of protest, to raise awareness about a cause, or for educational or medical reasons, and where such intent is clear, we make allowances for the content. However, we default to removing sexual imagery to prevent the sharing of

[113] https://www.facebook.com/help/157793540954833?helpref=related_articles
[114] https://www.facebook.com/help/datingsafetyguidelines

non-consensual or underage content, as published in our Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity Community Standards.

Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity is associated with the Protection of Minors and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used by threat actors to depict or promote imagery of nude adults, adult sexual activity, or extended audio of adult sexual activity. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity* remains a highly adversarial and profit motivated space, particularly as threat actors develop new ways to circumvent detection and enforcement. We observe behaviour such as utilising multiple accounts, creating fake profiles, leading users to harmful external sites, or various obfuscation techniques, including embedding violating video clips within an otherwise benign video and harmful content through picture in picture content. In some instances, threat actors use depictions of adult nudity and sexual activity as a means to bait users for other purposes or goals.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, several key trends were identified including the continued prevalence of sexualised breastfeeding content and the use of timer videos, which are typically videos lasting a few minutes and starting with a digital countdown that appears on the screen followed by hardcore pornographic or nudity content, by adversarial actors to evade detection while distributing pornographic material. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, we have been working closely to mature our operational guidelines, banking mechanisms, and detection tools to address these evolving trends. Additionally, Meta continues to work with industry peers to identify preventative measures to reduce access to tools like these which may be misused. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview:** As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Additionally, we've updated the Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity Policy on 25 July, 29 August and on 17 September 2024 to clarify language on what is permitted under the policy (e.g., real-world art nudity), what is not permitted (e.g., any imagery, including digital), and the addition of the express mention of AI- or computer-generated nudity as something that is not allowed, just like imagery of real nudity. Other updates included the addition of language to explain when certain types of nudity are permitted with restrictions, such as age-gating and sensitive content warning screens (e.g., imagery of implicit/other sexual activity or stimulation when shared in a medical or health context). Specifically for *Adult Nudity and Sexual Activity* over the last year, we continued to increase our investments in enforcement on recidivism, increase the number of human reviewers to address risks across this Problem Area, and improve the effectiveness of manual reviews. These policy changes directly contribute to more effective enforcement of violating content on Meta's platforms. In the first quarter of 2025, globally, we took action against 64.7 million pieces of potential adult nudity and sexual activity content (globally) on Facebook, with 94.9% being identified by us before users reported it.[115]

5.2.2.3 Adult Sexual Exploitation

Meta recognises that its platforms may be used to discuss sexual violence and exploitation. To foster a safe environment, we allow victims to share their experiences but remove content that depicts, threatens, or promotes sexual violence, sexual assault, or sexual exploitation. We also remove content that displays, advocates for, or coordinates sexual acts with non-consenting parties to avoid facilitating non-consensual sexual acts. In addition, we remove any content promoting services, applications, or instructions that

[115] Community Standards: Adult and Sexual Nudity

promote, threaten to share, or offer to make non-real NCII. Content that threatens or advocates rape is removed and we may disable the posting account and work with law enforcement.[116]

Adult Sexual Exploitation is associated with the Gender-based Violence, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used by threat actors to sexually exploit adult users, including non-consensual sexual touching (NCST), necrophilia, forced stripping, sextortion, non-consensual intimate imagery, creepshots, rape threats, or references to adult sexual exploitation. This also potentially includes Facebook being used by threat actors to depict, threaten, or promote sexual violence or sexual exploitation associated with adults.

As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, *Adult Sexual Exploitation* remains a highly adversarial space, particularly as threat actors develop new ways to circumvent detection and enforcement. We observe behaviour such as utilising multiple accounts, creating fake profiles, leading users to harmful external sites, or various obfuscation techniques, including embedding violating video clips or harmful content images within an otherwise benign video or image.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, net new trends were identified that impact this Problem Area. Violating apps emerged including non-consensual AI kissing apps and nudification apps that create NCII. In addition, sextortion continues to be a risk and we have seen an increase in offenders operating through fake profiles or anonymous accounts and moving victims away from Meta applications to other platforms, making it harder to track. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, we have been working closely to mature our operational guidelines, banking mechanisms, and detection tools to address these evolving trends. Additionally, we continue to work with industry peers to identify preventative measures to reduce access to tools like these which may be misused. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview:** As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Adult Sexual Exploitation*, as it relates to our detection controls, we are aware of patterns associated with sharing of NCII, NCST, and sextortion and have automated systems that detect and remove these accounts and harmful content at scale. In order to combat challenges with understanding intent or consent with NCII or NCST content, Meta often encourages and relies more on user reporting, as well as human review. Over the last year, we continued to increase our investments in enforcement on recidivism, increase the number of human reviewers to address risks across this Problem Area, and improve the effectiveness of manual reviews. When we identify a credible threat of real-world harm, we reach out to law enforcement in accordance with our Terms of Service and applicable law. In these instances, we do not allow identification of a victim of sexual assault without their consent. Additionally, when we take enforcement action against a user for sextortion, the network of accounts and devices owned by the threat actor are taken down and we make it difficult for them to create new accounts. Furthermore, Meta collaborates with third parties to help combat these challenges across the industry. This includes supporting StopNCII.org, which allows individuals to hash their intimate images or videos directly on their devices and share these hashes with participating tech companies globally, including Meta, to prevent the sharing of these images on the different products. Additionally, through our participation in the Tech Coalition's Lantern signal sharing initiative, we have shared ~3,800 URLs of nudify apps with 26 tech companies. [117] Meta has developed more than 50 tools and features to help support the safety of minors and families across our apps, including

[116] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/adult-sexual-exploitation/
[117] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/06/taking-action-against-nudify-apps/

supervision tools for parents and guardians and specific education and resources about sextortion in our Safety Centre.[118] We also provide links to local resources available in our Help Centre if anyone is a victim of sexual exploitation or would like resources to share with a potential victim. Meta also works with smaller groups of external women's safety advisors to provide guidance whose areas of expertise include NCII, adult sexual exploitation, and other online harms impacting women. Their expertise guides the development of our approach to mitigating harm targeted at women on our platforms, as well as informing the design of our policies, products, and programmes aimed at preventing and responding to online abuse.[119]

5.2.2.4 Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language

At Meta, we do not allow content that is designed to facilitate sexual encounters or commercial sexual services between adults. We also do not allow content that asks for or offers pornographic or sexual content. We also restrict sexually-explicit language that may lead to sexual solicitation because some audiences within our global community may be sensitive to this type of content, and it may impede the ability for people to connect with accounts that they follow or are a friend of and the broader community. However, we do allow for the discussion of sex worker rights advocacy and sex work regulation as well as content that is otherwise covered by this policy when posted in condemnation, educational, awareness raising, or news reporting contexts. We also do not prohibit discussing sexual practices under the policy. However, this content is restricted to adults over 18 years of age.

Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language is associated with the Gender-based Violence, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used for the dissemination of pornographic content, solicitation of sexual services, and depiction or promotion of explicit language with graphic sexual undertones. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, this type of abuse can be difficult to identify because the line between coercion and self promotion can be unclear and complex to determine online. We remove content facilitating sexual encounters in part to avoid facilitating transactions that may involve trafficking, coercion, and non-consensual sexual acts. Also, coercion can be difficult to prove based on only the existence of emojis or other vague text.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. Content attempting to engage in sexual solicitation and prostitution continues to persist as a prominent trend especially across Reels and video surfaces. There is a demand-driven cycle of harm, where users seeking explicit content create an incentive for producers to create and share it. This cycle of harm is self-reinforcing, with both producers and consumers contributing to continued prevalence of such content.

In Year 3, we identified a trend where a combination of deceptive links and fake play buttons overlaid on sexually suggestive imagery or pornography were used to prompt engagement and direct users to off-platform pornography websites.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, we have updated our policies to enforce against the use of deceptive links and fake play buttons to direct users to pornography sites off-platform.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of

[118] https://www.meta.com/help/policies/safety/tools-support-teens-parents/
[119] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/

controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Adult Sexual Solicitation and Sexually Explicit Language*, Meta continues to curate age-appropriate experiences for minors and reduce discoverability of certain content, via features such as non-recommendation, filtering, and interstitials for content that may be suggestive of sexual practices or contain sexually explicit language. We also curate lists of slang terms across multiple markets and prevent them from being shown on search results or recommended to minors. For minor users, we do not give them the option to turn down their enforcements and default minors to the higher setting across their accounts.

We deploy classifiers, which use parts of posts such as texts and comments, to identify violations. The classifier can produce scores for solicitation and we use these scores to enqueue for human review and enforcement action. We allow for auto action of sexual solicitation and sexually explicit language violations based on confidence in the probability of actual violation and prioritisation in our review queue. Additionally, Meta recognises that sexual solicitation and prostitution may shift to off-platform activities, making it more difficult to detect and enforce against such violations. This highlights the complexity of addressing these issues, as they can manifest beyond our platforms, and underscores the importance of ongoing efforts to prevent harm from occurring on our services.

Meta also implements standard human review processes. Specific nuances include utilising holistic review to identify potential sexual solicitation and sexually explicit language scenarios, while scaled review is utilised to enforce against violations without the need for further escalation.

5.2.2.5 Bullying and Harassment

Meta is committed to maintaining a safe and respectful environment on our platforms by prohibiting *Bullying and Harassment*. According to the Bullying and Harassment Community Standard, Meta takes action to remove content that is intended to degrade or shame individuals. Additionally, when there is a heightened risk of real-world harm, Meta removes targeted mass harassment.

Bullying and Harassment is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections, Gender-based Violence, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area refers to the risk of Meta's systems being used to promote content that degrades, shames, or makes repeated unwanted contact with a user (e.g., cyberbullying, threats of harm, mass harassment, sexual harassment). We recognise that bullying and harassment can have disproportionate effects on minors' well-being and mental health, which is why we provide heightened protections for users under 18. We also recognise that the LGBTQ+ community, as well as public figures like female politicians—especially female politicians of colour—are targets of *Bullying and Harassment* at a disproportionate rate. This risk can manifest itself on Facebook when adversarial networks work together to engage in repetitive behaviour, which is challenging to identify and manage, as brigading and coordination of mass harassment happen on and off the platform and can take various forms. We also recognise that becoming a public figure isn't always a choice and that fame can increase the risk of bullying and harassment, particularly if the person comes from an underrepresented community.

As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, *Bullying and Harassment* continues to evolve with the landscape of social interaction and digital connection, as it is highly individualised and context-dependent. As a result, moderators often need to understand the relationships between users, the meaning behind content and behaviour, and the nuances of language and regional context. Meanwhile, threat actors continue to explore ways to circumvent detection and enforcement (e.g., using emojis, intentional misspellings, symbols, etc.).

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2 Assessment. For example, we continue to observe that *Bullying and Harassment* risks may disproportionately impact minors, potentially increasing the inherent risk exposure associated with this Problem Area. Additionally, it was identified that the high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, could increase the risk of bullying and harassment against political public figures on the platform. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2 Assessment. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, Meta put in place dedicated election teams to combat the likely increase in adversarial behaviour. Facebook defaults to private accounts and location settings when a minor signs up for an account, though minors can choose to turn their account to public and/or share their location. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview:** As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. We continue to provide numerous options for users to control their experiences on Facebook and limit unwanted interactions with other users. These options include blocking other users, restricting other users' ability to comment on their posts, and limiting the visibility of posts and profile information for specific users. Additional mitigations may include notifying users when they post violating content and alerting authorities if there is a safety threat. We continue to rely on detection of new content types, such as GenAI. In the first quarter of 2025, globally, we actioned 5.1 million pieces of *Bullying and Harassment* content on Facebook, with 73.3% detected proactively before being reported by users.[120] While there are no automated detection or classifiers to detect *Bullying and Harassment* violations in ads, we may rely more on user reporting and human review. We also include a link on nearly every piece of content for reporting abuse, *Bullying and Harassment*, and other issues. We encourage self-reporting as it helps us understand when a person feels bullied or harassed.[121] We provide heightened protection for minors and vulnerable users through our Bullying and Harassment Community Standards, given the potential disproportionate impact on these groups. For example, we protect against content targeting minors such as claims about sexual activity or romantic involvement; targeted cursing; calls for exclusion; negative character ability claims; allegations about criminal or illegal behaviour; and videos depicting physical bullying of minors. Consistent with the commitments in our Corporate Human Rights Policy, we offer more protections for public figures (e.g., journalists and human rights defenders) who have become famous involuntarily or because of their work, similar to protections assigned to other involuntary public figures.[122] Examples of these protections include dehumanising comparisons (in written or visual form) to or about animals and insects that are culturally perceived as inferior, bacteria, viruses, microbes, diseases, and inanimate objects, including trash, filth, faeces; content manipulated to highlight, circle, or otherwise negatively draw attention to specific physical characteristics; and content that ranks their physical looks.[123] There are many teams at Meta, including the policy and safety teams, that routinely work with external parties to understand new trends and behaviours to help improve Meta's policies and resources, as detailed in our Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement. For example, after working with over 400 women's safety organisations and experts, we established Meta's Global Women's Safety Expert Advisors to advance the safety of women online. Additionally, we work with bullying prevention experts, such as the Diana Award Anti-Bullying Ambassador Programme, International Bullying Prevention Association, and Cyberbullying Research Centre, to stay informed on bullying trends and maintain our bullying prevention resources (e.g., Bullying Prevention Tips for Youth, Online Bullying Prevention Tips for Parents, Managing Bullying and Harassment in Facebook Communities, etc.).[124]

120 https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/bullying-and-harassment/facebook/
121 https://www.facebook.com/help/1380418588640631
122 https://about.fb.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/Meta-Corporate-Human-Rights-Policy.pdf
123 https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/bullying-harassment/
124 https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/women/#partners

5.2.2.6 Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Nudity

Meta does not allow content, activity or interactions that sexually exploits or endangers minors, as published in our Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Nudity Policy Community Standard.

Child Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Nudity is associated with the Protection of Minors and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to promote or disseminate content or activity relating to non-sexual child abuse, child nudity, child sexual exploitation, CSAM, including self-generated CSAM and solicitation of CSAM, sexualisation of minors, and exploitative intimate imagery and sextortion of minors. This risk area also includes inappropriate interactions with minors and the adverse impact on minors' fundamental rights, specifically the respect for the rights of the minor and the right to human dignity as enshrined in the EU Charter.

As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, threat actor behaviour is highly adversarial and constantly evolving in this space. We observe behaviour such as intentional manipulation by threat actors to persistently adapt to evade detection, use of implicit signals like keywords and hashtags (e.g., "chicken soup"), moving conversations off the service (e.g., via posting links to off-platform sites) to take advantage of minors and/or spread violating content (e.g., CSAM), and returning to the service through new accounts despite being blocked. Additionally, some abuse types can be more challenging to detect and manage than others, such as non-sexual child abuse, which may result in greater reliance on user reporting and human review.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment period, several trends were identified that continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. Additionally, Meta continued to actively monitor the potential for generative AI to impact risks in this space as the use of generative AI advances across the industry. In Year 3, sextortion continued to be a risk, with a rise observed in apps generating and editing NCII and CSAM, AI kissing apps, and nudification tools. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, we have committed to Safety by Design principles from Thorn and All Tech is Human to proactively address minor safety risks, while also maturing operational guidelines, banking mechanisms, and detection tools to address these evolving trends. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview:** As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. When it comes to recommender systems, we have systems that proactively find, remove, or refrain from suggesting minor-sensitive content across most surfaces, including Groups and Pages, and we continue to improve these systems year-over-year by streamlining them and expanding their capabilities. Meta deploys classifiers that can proactively identify violating or potentially violating content. We also leverage technologies such as Google's classifier, in order to prioritise content for reviewers. We have also expanded the existing list of minor safety related terms, phrases and emojis for our systems to find. We have many sources for these terms, including: non-profits like Thorn and experts in online safety (e.g. Tech Coalition[125]), our specialist child safety teams who investigate predatory networks to understand the language they use, and our own technology which finds misspellings or spelling variations of these terms. We have also introduced novel techniques to find new search terms. For example, we are using machine-learning technology to find relationships between terms that we already know

[125] https://technologycoalition.org/

could be harmful or that break our rules and other terms used at the same time. These could be terms searched for in the same session as violating terms, or other hashtags used in a caption that contain a violating hashtag. We combined our systems so that as new terms are added to our central list, they are subsequently actioned across Facebook simultaneously.[126]

Meta has specialist teams focused on understanding evolving criminal behaviours to review and eliminate abusive content, accounts, and networks. Meta's investigation teams receive information off-platform (from various sources including open source, intelligence vendors, and partners) and then investigate the activity on Meta's platforms. In some instances, these investigations may result in takedowns of entire networks of bad actors. Additionally, these investigations uncover behavioural signals and keywords that are fed back into Meta's scaled systems (e.g., machine-learning), which enhanced our proactive detection of violating content. In the first quarter of 2025, globally, we actioned 4.6 million pieces of potential child sexual exploitation content on Facebook, with 95.8% detected proactively before it was reported by users.[127]

Our reviewers and automated systems consider a broad spectrum of signals, which we monitor for potential suspicious behaviour such as interactions with violating accounts, searches for violating content, or membership in violating communities. These mechanisms help prevent potentially unwanted or unsafe interactions and support Meta's enforcement actions on accounts or content that violate our policies. For example, the PYMK feature can be restricted for adults identified through our Actor Behaviour Framework for Child Safety (ABF CS) classifier. The ABF CS classifier is applied across our products to prevent potentially unwanted or unsafe interactions. The framework uses our detection mechanisms to consider evidence of content uploads, direct contact with minors and consumption, engagement or connection with minor safety violating entities before labelling actors into specific categories.

When Meta identifies an account violating child sexual exploitation, the account is disabled and all linked accounts, that we identify as being owned by the same person, are also disabled. Device blocking prevents the identified user from creating another new account on the same device after violating accounts are disabled.

Meta also has specially trained teams with backgrounds in law enforcement, online safety, analytics, and forensic investigations to review potentially violating content and report findings to NCMEC, in accordance with applicable law. For example, during the period 1 March 2024 to 30 September 2024, Meta submitted 392 CyberTips to NCMEC in relation to Facebook, concerning EU users due to the apparent sextortion of users who are under 18. Following receipt and review of a CyberTip, NCMEC determines a potential geographic location, and makes the CyberTip available to a law enforcement agency in that particular country and location for review and potential investigation. Furthermore, we continue to conduct co-design sessions with parents, minors, guardians, and experts through the Trust Transparency and Control Labs (TTC Labs).[128]

Lastly, Meta engages with CSOs, academics, minor safety experts, NGOs, and other thought leaders, including the Facebook Safety Advisory Board, law enforcement, and governments, to gather knowledge and experience as we develop our Content Policies. For more details on relevant external stakeholder engagement, see Section 4.1: External Stakeholder Engagement and Section 4.2.6: Protection of Minors. Our efforts include developing industry best practices, building and sharing technology to fight online minor exploitation, and supporting victim services. The Take It Down platform, which allows the hashes of young people's intimate images to be shared with Meta, has enabled more effective automated detection and enforcement of this type of content.[129] We work with experts especially focused on minor safety to build a collection of resources that foster conversations between parents, caregivers, and minors as they navigate and develop online safety habits in our Family Centre Education Hub, including our Parent's Guide via the Safety Centre.[130]

5.2.2.7 Coordinating Harm and Promoting Crime

At Meta, we prohibit the facilitation, organisation, promotion, or admission to certain criminal or harmful activities targeted at people, businesses, properties, or animals, as published in our Coordinating Harm and Promoting Crime Community Standard. While discussions and advocacy regarding the legality of such activities are permitted, coordinating or advocating for harm is not.

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[126] https://about.fb.com/news/2023/12/combating-online-predators/
[127] Community Standards: Child Endangerment: Nudity and Physical Abuse and Sexual Exploitation
[128] https://www.ttclabs.net/
[129] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/topics/bullying-harassment/ncii
[130] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/childsafety/

Coordinating Harm and Promoting Crime is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections, Public Security, and Protection of Minors Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to facilitate, organise, promote, or call for voter or census fraud, illegal participation in elections, coordinated interference in elections, violence against people, potentially including high-risk viral challenges, and violence against property, including vandalism of state property. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, the evolving context poses difficulties to moderating content in this space. Regional cultural barriers make it difficult to gain an adequate understanding of all regional or cultural nuances (e.g., slang or dialects from a particular neighbourhood, city, or region) and determine what is classified as coordinating harm.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2 Assessment. The high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, could increase the risk of coordinating harm and promoting crime on the platform through voter and/or census fraud and coordinated interference in elections. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2 Assessment. Meta has dedicated teams that continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes as needed. For example, during elections, Meta put in place dedicated election teams to combat the likely increase in adversarial behaviour. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview:** As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. In terms of coordinated harm or crime related to elections, our security teams work to dismantle manipulation campaigns and identify emerging threats. This includes investigating and taking down coordinated networks of inauthentic accounts, Pages, and Groups. Our team leverages image banks to detect content in regions with high-risk elections to combat voter suppression. We also implement additional processes to perform a secondary, holistic review of politically viral content. Our Violence and Harm Team actively operates an ongoing process for proposing changes to our market-specific implicit threat terms list, which includes market-specific idioms or proxy language that enable us to identify escalation cases. In addition, in our Adversarial Threat Report for the second quarter of 2024 we shared that, in addition to cycling through fake accounts, which get quickly detected and removed, Doppelganger, a cross-internet influence operation from Russia, expanded their use of compromised accounts and pages, likely in an attempt to appear authentic.[131] We continue to detect and block these attempts by using both automation and expert investigations to monitor Doppelganger's changes in tactics. In the second quarter of 2024, we detected and removed over 5,000 accounts and pages. In the third quarter of 2024, we added about 600 new threat indicators to our industry's largest repository of over 6,000 signals related to this campaign so that our peers and researchers can investigate and take action as appropriate.[132] In response to our ongoing blocking of its domains, as of July 2024, we no longer observed Doppelganger attempting to direct people on our apps to its domains mimicking websites of news outlets or government entities. We have a global workforce of content reviewers in the markets where Meta operates, including in the EU. Our human reviewers review content with expert or native understanding of the language in which the content was posted, against the Coordinating Harm and Promoting Crime Community Standards, as well as other applicable policies and guidelines. They receive in-depth training and often specialise in certain policy areas. This approach helps ensure that the policy is correctly enforced and accounts for cultural and linguistic nuances.

[131] Adversarial Threat Report Q2 2024
[132] Adversarial Threat Report Q3 2024

5.2.2.8 Dangerous Organisations and Individuals

In an effort to prevent and disrupt real-world harm, we do not allow organisations or individuals that proclaim a violent mission or are engaged in violence to have a presence on Facebook and remove any glorification, support, and representation of various dangerous organisations and individuals. These concepts apply to the organisations themselves, their activities, and their members, as published in our Dangerous Organisations and Individuals Community Standard.

Dangerous Organisations and Individuals is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections and Public Security Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used by terrorists, hate and/or criminal organisations, militarised social movements, violence-inducing conspiracy networks, groups promoting hatred, or violent non-state actors to advocate for and facilitate violence. This risk also includes the risk of Facebook being used by terrorists to recruit and/or radicalise users and the use of Live by such actors or entities to disseminate content in association with a terrorist act. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, this is a highly adversarial space in which dangerous organisations and individuals constantly discover new ways to evade detection and enforcement on Meta's systems. We also experience challenges when entities we categorise as dangerous organisations or individuals are allowed or considered legal in certain countries—and vice versa, such as when organisations we consider legitimate are deemed illegal elsewhere (e.g., groups advocating for the independence or secession of a particular territory). This makes moderating such content more challenging. Lastly, dangerous organisations and individuals that have been identified and banned can resurface and utilise our platforms before our teams and investigators detect and remove them.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. The high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, could increase the risk of dangerous organisations and individuals on the platform. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Dangerous Organisations and Individuals*, we have developed a suite of tools under our Search Interventions programme to inform and protect users on our platforms. This includes features such as Search Intercept and Search Redirect, which work together to address problematic searches by either redirecting users to relevant help resources or displaying warning screens that highlight the concerning nature of their search. Additionally, to help prevent glorification, support, or representation by individuals or groups engaging in terrorist activity or organised hate, we make hashtags associated with designated dangerous organisations or individuals unsearchable. Meta has robust policies in place that are routinely reviewed and updated to adapt to the current climate. This helps to guide our enforcement efforts. For example, at the end of 2024, we refined our Dangerous Organisations and Individuals Community Standards, including more comprehensive definitions of dangerous organisation types and tiers. However, views of violating content that contain terrorism are very infrequent, and we remove much of this content before people see it. In the first quarter of 2025, we actioned 7.5 million pieces of content related to terrorism on Facebook globally, with 99% being identified by us before users reported it.[133]

[133] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/dangerous-organizations/facebook/

We utilise advanced detection technology to identify dangerous or violent actors on Facebook and take an actor-centred enforcement approach. Furthermore, in October 2024, we expanded our internal criminal organisation designation signals beyond the historical focus on drug cartels to more comprehensively respond to the threat-landscape from criminal networks engaged in extortion, human smuggling, and other high risk harms. This update was informed by engagements with internal and external experts to align with best practices and definitions. In addition, we developed two Actor Behaviour Frameworks for criminal organisations and terrorist/hate organisations that aim to identify, detect, and enforce malicious actors involved in drug trafficking and violent activities at scale. Our Violence and Harm Team actively operates an ongoing process for proposing changes to our Market-specific Implicit Threat Terms List, which includes market-specific idioms or proxy language that enables us to identify escalation cases. Once a bad-actor network is identified, we use SND (Strategic Network Disruption) to take action against the identified network, which includes all accounts and devices that appear to be owned by the bad-actor and those in the network associated with them, in an effort to also combat recidivism.

To further manage this Problem Area, Meta's DOI Policy team oversees the process by which entities (organisations and individuals) that qualify as a DOI are added to a DOI Designation List. We assess these entities based on their behaviour both online and offline—most significantly, their ties to violence. Under this process, we designate individuals, organisations, and networks of people. When designated, measures are taken to remove all of the DOI's assets from the Product, as well as bank terms and images that represent the DOI in order to bolster continued scaled enforcement. We also updated our internal delisting process, which now provides more detailed and comprehensive criteria across all types of dangerous organisations and individuals that must be satisfied for a dangerous organisation or individual to be considered for delisting / removal from our list of designated organisations. In addition, our DOI team has continuous dialogues with other teams, such as Intelligence and Investigations, to help surface emerging risks, identify actors and objects that are connected from a network with our account enforcement propagation efforts, and drive improvements in detection and enforcement and/or policy development. Both the designation and delisting processes operate independently of each other, each having their own distinct thresholds and signals. However, they are overseen by the same DOI Policy team, who manages the historical documentation for designations and delistings and is responsible for de-conflicting any overlap between the two processes.

To help tackle dangerous organisations and individuals more broadly, we work closely with external organisations and authorities, including law enforcement. We also hold and collaborate in forums, such as the Global Internet Forum to Counter Terrorism (GIFCT).[134] In September 2024, Meta and GIFCT convened to discuss youth radicalisation prevention. The event emphasised empowering young users through positive messaging, parental involvement, and technology like age-verification tools. Through GIFCT, we collaborate with industry peers on signal sharing, threat-landscape mapping, and a hash matching service, which informs our automated systems and updates to the Dangerous Organisations and Individuals Database. We also engage with law enforcement on credible threats and partner with the EU Internet Forum on crisis protocols and joint programmes. Lastly, when we identify a credible threat of real-world harm, we reach out to law enforcement in accordance with our Terms of Service and applicable law.

5.2.2.9 Discriminatory Practices

At Meta, we don't allow ads that discriminate or encourage discrimination against people based on personal attributes such as race, ethnicity, colour, national origin, religion, age, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, family status, disability, medical or genetic condition. We require advertisers to comply with applicable laws that prohibit discrimination, as published in our Advertising Standard.

Discriminatory Practices is associated with the Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Area in the DSA. This Problem Area specifically relates to the risk of Facebook being used—primarily by advertisers and sellers—to discriminate against people, particularly in housing, employment, or credit opportunity ads, that can potentially contribute or lead to detrimental impact to users, such as excluding them from job opportunities.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends could impact this Problem Area. Threat actors continue to exploit our systems to evade detection and enforcement, such as disguising encoded content as organic. Furthermore,

[134] https://gifct.org/about/

in the context of advertising systems broadly, the misuse of brand identities, including Meta's identity through fake chat support messages, is a tactic that is becoming increasingly challenging to manage. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook.

Specifically for *Discriminatory Practices*, Meta uses automated and, in some instances, manual review to enforce our policies. Beyond reviewing individual ads, we also monitor and investigate advertiser behaviour, and may restrict advertiser accounts that don't follow our Advertising Standards, Community Standards, or other Meta policies and terms.[135]

For certain categories of ads, like ads about housing and employment, we have additional requirements designed to help protect people and provide greater transparency. If an ad is about one of these special ad categories, advertisers need to choose the correct category for their advertising campaign during its creation for the campaign to run.[136] A Special Ad Category includes specific requirements such as limited audience selection tools for ads about employment, housing opportunities, or financial products and services to help protect people from unlawful discrimination across our platforms. Anytime users run ads on Meta platforms, they are agreeing to adhere to our Discriminatory Practices Policy.[137] In addition, periodically, we may ask users to review the Discriminatory Practices Policy and certify their understanding of—and compliance with—it.

We place particular emphasis on protecting minors. Ads with locations in the EU can't deliver to audiences under 18.[138] This year, we have focused on reducing the exposure of minors to restricted goods and services content on Facebook. Our efforts include automated review mechanisms that analyse ads, sponsored Marketplace listings, for-sale posts, and other commerce listings, before they go live. For more details, see the mitigation overview in Section 5.2.2.17: Restricted Goods and Services.

We're strengthening the review process and continuing to enforce ad policies against discriminatory behaviour across our technologies.

5.2.2.10 Fraud and Deception

At Meta, we aim to protect users and businesses from being deceived out of their money, property, or personal information. We achieve this by removing content and combatting behaviour that purposefully employs deceptive means—such as wilful misrepresentation, stolen information and exaggerated claims—to either scam or defraud users and businesses, or to drive engagement. This includes content that seeks to coordinate or promote those activities using our services.

Fraud and Deception is associated with the Deceptive and Misleading, Public Health, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to provide instructions on, engage in, promote, recruit, facilitate, or distribute fraudulent and deceptive content that could potentially impact public health; public health related investment, financial, product, or inauthentic identity/fake engagement scams; stolen information, goods, and services related to public health; or deceive or misrepresent themselves to others for financial or personal benefit related to public health. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, threat actors are using evolving technologies, such as GenAI, to come up with new ways to defraud and deceive people, including studying how our detection and enforcement controls are designed and to evade them. There are also instances where content may promote a service or product through sensationalist or exaggerated language, whereby the product may not exist in reality or do not match to their

[135] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/
[136] https://www.facebook.com/business/help/505720160452817?id=434838534925385
[137] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/unacceptable-content/discriminatory-practices
[138] https://www.facebook.com/business/help/229435355723442

promises, but are not necessarily illegal i.e. hair growth shampoo. Additionally, threat actors use signposting which leads users to harmful external sites.

What are we doing to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, net new trends were identified that impact this Problem Area. A rise in the use of celebrity likeness and AI deepfakes to deceive users emerged. Usage of brand identities, such as in scam job listings, or even Meta's identity with fake chat support messages, are tactics that are becoming more challenging to manage.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Fraud and Deception,* we use several machine-learning models to identify users that are misrepresenting themselves or displaying common scam tactics. These models are constantly evaluating our entire user base and removing accounts deemed to be violating per our Community and Advertising Standards. Meta reviews any reported content either through automation or manually. We use the insight from these cases to further iterate on our proactive detection and internal policies. Additionally, we include a reporting opportunity on nearly every piece of content to report scam, fraud, false information, and other issues as part of our enhanced user initiated reporting experience. Our teams work 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, to review content reported. We also deploy features to protect users such as product interventions with safety notices and prevention features like adding friction to the discovery of harmful content.

We continue to look for and block attempts by criminal syndicate-run scam centres to create fraudulent accounts on our platforms. Since the beginning of 2024, our expert teams have detected and disrupted over seven million accounts associated with scam centres across Myanmar, Laos, Cambodia, the United Arab Emirates, and the Philippines. The criminal organisations behind these financial scams target people globally, through a variety of means such as social media and other apps.[139]

Meta has taken proactive measures to combat financial sextortion on Facebook by investigating individuals selling scripts that facilitate this type of exploitation. We have found that financial sextortion extorters are known to use scripts that are publicly available online when interacting with their victims. As a result, we have removed assets found to be selling or purchasing these scripts, as well as additional assets controlled by the same individuals. In October 2024, Meta removed over 1,620 assets—800 Facebook Groups and 820 accounts—that were affiliated with Yahoo Boys, fraudsters who coerce online users out of millions of dollars by luring them into various scams such as offers of love and companionship, and were attempting to organise, recruit, and train new sextortion scammers. This comes after the announcement in July that Meta had removed around 7,200 Facebook assets that were engaging in similar behaviour.[140]

In Q1 2025, we launched optional measures on Facebook that use facial recognition technology to help detect and prevent celeb-bait scam ads and enable faster account recovery on our platforms in the European Union (EU). As part of this launch, public figures in the EU who are eligible will see an in-app notification letting them know they can now opt-in to receive the celeb bait protection with facial recognition technology. We have vetted these measures through our robust privacy and risk review process and built in important safeguards, like providing information to educate people about how they work, making these measures optional and ensuring we delete people's facial data as soon as it's no longer needed.[141]

Meta has developed a library of tools and resources for improved online safety to help educate users, provide guidance about scams (e.g., romance and financial scams), and encourage our users to report content they believe violates our Community Standards and policies in our Facebook Help Centre, our Scam Safety Centre, and Anti-Scams Hub.[142]

To supplement internal improvements, the Fraud and Deception operations and product teams continuously engage with a number of external trusted third parties to gather information about scam-related accounts and content and use this information to continue evolving our environment and response to managing these risks. In 2024, Meta vastly expanded its external partnerships with the Fraud Intelligence Reciprocal Exchange (FIRE) programme, an intelligence-sharing forum designed to prevent fraud and scams. Meta also joined

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[139] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/05/avoiding-investment-payment-scams-online/
[140] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/10/instagram-campaign-protect-teens-sextortion-scams/
[141] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/10/testing-combat-scams-restore-compromised-accounts/
[142] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/topics/safety-basics/tools/scams

the Global Signals Exchange (GSE), managed by GASA, which facilitates information sharing between government and private sector partners. Additionally, Meta is one of the founding members of the TASC.

5.2.2.11 Hateful Conduct

At Meta, we define hateful conduct as direct attacks against people—rather than concepts or institutions—on the basis of what we call protected characteristics (PCs): race, ethnicity, national origin, disability, religious affiliation, caste, sexual orientation, sex, gender identity, and serious disease, as described in our Hateful Conduct Community Standard. Additionally, we consider age a protected characteristic when referenced along with another protected characteristic.

Hateful Conduct is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections, Gender-based Violence, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used by users to propagate, endorse, or amplify content containing slurs or attacks directed at individuals or groups based on their protected characteristics. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, the associated risks can be complex to manage due to the types of content and terms used for hateful conduct changing frequently. For example, threat actors continue to explore ways to circumvent detection and enforcement by implying rather than explicitly making statements targeting protected characteristics. New trends can emerge as contentious depending on regional nuances. Additionally, often users can post content that is borderline but not explicit hateful conduct, which creates a risk of mistakes in enforcement.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2 Assessment. The high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, could increase the risk of *Hateful Conduct* on the platform. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2 Assessment.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, during elections, Meta put in place dedicated election teams to combat the likely increase in adversarial behaviour.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to proactively detect and enforce against hateful conduct on Facebook. For *Hateful Conduct*, Meta has enhanced our approach to managing this Problem Area over the past year.

For example, in January 2025, Meta updated our Community Standards related to hateful conduct, formerly called hate speech, to enable more public debate and discussion about issues of political and social interest, such as immigration, gender identity, and gender. At a high level, we are allowing more speech around topics that are the subject of current public discourse. We also simplified the policy to reduce complexity, lessen mistakes, and focus our efforts on the most harmful content.

Alongside the Hateful Conduct Community Standard, Meta provides dedicated reporting channels for users in the EU to submit legal removal requests to Facebook when they believe the content violates applicable hate speech laws in their jurisdiction.[143]

As it relates to detection of images for this Problem Area, we utilise classifiers and, in some cases, a central bank of content that has previously been flagged and enforced against to try to proactively identify instances of these images being posted again. In the first quarter of 2025, we actioned 3.4 million pieces of hateful conduct content on Facebook globally, with 88.6% being identified by us before

[143] https://www.facebook.com/help/874680996209917/

users reported it.[144] To help manage the linguistic and cultural nuances of this Problem Area, Meta maintains and leverages a market-specific slurs list, consisting of inherently offensive words that are used as an insult for a protected characteristic in specific jurisdictions. This list is used to identify slurs and surface them to our reviewers for review and labelling, where applicable.

We have educational interstitials to deter users from posting violating hateful conduct content or from encountering potentially hateful content, groups, and pages. This includes issuing warnings or providing a link to relevant resources in our Safety Centre based on the terms used. Additionally, we empower users with tools like blocking. When a user's content is reported and found policy-violating, the user is notified of the specific policy they have violated and may be given the option to edit their content for potential reinstatement. We also implement a Strike System, where once the threshold for repeated policy violations is met, the user's account is removed.

We collaborate with external stakeholders, such as governments, watchdog groups, and Trusted Partners, to help us identify instances of hateful conduct. We also engage with multiple governments during rollouts of EU hateful conduct tests to collect feedback for improvements regarding perception of hostile speech mitigation measures on our platforms and services.

In our Safety Centre, we have developed expert-backed safety resources and tools based on topics such as mental health, bullying and harassment, and communities (e.g., women and LGBTQ+), to help our users as they face issues related to hateful conduct.

5.2.2.12 Human Exploitation

At Meta, we do not allow content that facilitates or coordinates the exploitation of humans, including human trafficking and smuggling, as described in our Human Exploitation Community Standard. Meta defines human trafficking as the business of depriving someone of liberty for profit and the United Nations defines human smuggling as the procurement or facilitation of illegal entry into a state across international borders.

Human Exploitation is associated with the Gender-based Violence, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used by threat actors to, ask for, or facilitate human smuggling; human trafficking; and/or facilitating content and activities that adversely impact the dignity and rights of users. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, human exploitation actors are highly adversarial and motivated to get around our enforcement tools. The signals of exploitation may not always be apparent in content online, meaning this harm can be difficult to detect without offline context. For example, it may be challenging to determine whether someone is being exploited or if they offered their services as an adult without force, fraud, or coercion. This Problem Area is also subject to adversarial actors that on the surface look to be engaging in exploitation, but in reality are engaging in fraud and scams. Distinguishing between these actors requires resources to triage and may draw away necessary resources from managing policy-violating events involving trafficking.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. It was noted that conflicts in adjacent regions could increase the risk of human exploitation, including human smuggling. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of

[144] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/hateful-conduct/facebook/

controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Human Exploitation*, we continue to refine our Search Interventions Programme which includes features such as Search Intercept and Search Redirect, which work together to address problematic searches by either redirecting users to relevant help resources or displaying warning screens that highlight the concerning nature of their search. In these interventions, we include links to resources for support. Other system and in-product mechanisms we implement to help protect users include cross-platform enforcement and device blocking.

Meta continues to build upon Year 2 identified improvements to our human exploitation detection mechanisms. Those Year 2 improvements included incorporating new trends and signals from sources, such as Trusted Partners, updating our blocklist databases, and updating our routine classifier training to more effectively remove content that violates our Human Exploitation Community Standards. We continue to leverage Media Match Service, Severity Framework, and High Risk Early Review Operations (HERO) to minimise human exploitation content on our platforms.

Within the EU, law enforcement agencies in various member states can report harmful situations related to human exploitation to Meta through multiple channels, including our Law Enforcement Online Requests (LEORs) portal, Regulatory Escalation (RegEsc), or the EUropol Internet Referral Unit (IRU). We also report instances of minor sex trafficking to the NCMEC inclusive of any minors within the EU.

We encourage anyone who encounters content on Facebook that indicates someone is in immediate physical danger related to human exploitation to contact local law enforcement immediately and report this content to us. Additionally, we may remove content that offers a job in locations that are high-risk for labour exploitation when confirmed by law enforcement, local non-governmental organisations, or other Trusted Partners. Meta collects feedback from our human content reviewers regularly to understand the trends they are seeing and update our policies accordingly to improve our detection capabilities. This includes making nuanced policy distinctions where necessary, such as Meta's recent policy enhancements to differentiate between minor sex trafficking and adult sex trafficking. Furthermore, Meta maintains established local market teams to help identify dialects and trends related to human exploitation in order to improve our detection and enforcement capabilities.

Meta consulted with experts across academia, advocacy, victim services and support, and law enforcement to develop more than 50 tools and features to support the safety of its users and provide guidance to users.[145] We provide links to local resources available in our Help Centre if anyone is a victim of human exploitation or would like resources to share with a potential victim. We work with more than 400 safety organisations worldwide, and among them, we work closely with key anti-trafficking experts, including NCMEC, International Centre for Missing and Exploited Children (ICMEC), Stop The Traffik, International Justice Mission, and End Child Prostitution and Trafficking (ECPAT) International.[146] We are founding members of Tech Against Trafficking, a cross-industry group that works with companies, non-profits, academics, and relevant stakeholders to support and accelerate the impact of technology solutions combating human trafficking.[147] We also collaborate with organisations to provide ad credits and/or ad support to educate users on human trafficking, including across the EU (e.g., labour trafficking campaigns), to help prevent and raise awareness of human exploitation risks.

5.2.2.13 Inauthentic Behaviour

At Meta, we do not allow people to misrepresent themselves on our services, use fake accounts, artificially boost the popularity of content, or engage in behaviours designed to enable other violations under our Community Standard. *Inauthentic Behaviour* refers to a variety of complex forms of deception, performed by a network of inauthentic assets controlled by the same individual or individuals, with the goal of deceiving Meta or our community or to evade enforcement under the Community Standard. Additionally, the Inauthentic Behaviour Policy encompasses CIB (Coordinated Inauthentic Behaviour), which we define as networks of people or Pages working together to mislead others about who they are and what they are doing for a strategic goal. CIB networks are typically a higher complexity, well-resourced form of *Inauthentic Behaviour.*

[145] https://www.meta.com/help/policies/safety/tools-support-teens-parents/
[146] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/audiences/women/#partners
[147] https://techagainsttrafficking.org/

Inauthentic Behaviour is associated with the Deceptive and Misleading and Civic Discourse and Elections Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to deceive or mislead users by misrepresenting themselves or organising coordinated efforts, in addition to the coordination of assets and manipulation of public debate across private users, organisations, and governments. In some instances, threat actors target users with wilfully deceptive content or misleading information. This also includes the misuse of Facebook's systems, potentially including attempts to circumvent Facebook's detection systems. Furthermore, there are cases involving groups participating in covert influence operations to create fictitious identities resembling media organisations and other credible sources to spread misleading and deceptive content in order to pursue a strategic objective. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, the ever-evolving *Inauthentic Behaviour* ecosystem makes it more difficult to identify these behaviours. In some cases, covert influence campaigns have shifted away from Meta platforms and onto other online spaces, increasing challenges with identifying and countering these operations. If we continue to see more "offline" forms of influence, we may need to approach the issue from a whole-of-society perspective, as Meta may not be best positioned to identify this kind of behaviour outside of our platform.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. It was noted that conflicts in adjacent regions and the high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, could increase the risk of inauthentic behaviour on the platform. Trends include the targeting of political groups, increased methods to evade detection by coordinated groups (e.g., Doppelganger), financially motivated organisations, and foreign influence operations. In Year 3, the following inauthentic behaviour trends emerged, between May 2024 and March 2025: ● **GenAI:** Throughout 2024, we continued to watch for and assess the risks associated with evolving new technologies like AI. Our findings so far suggest that GenAI-powered tactics have provided only incremental productivity and content-generation gains to threat actors, and have not impeded our ability to disrupt their covert influence operations.[148] ● **Russia:** Since the start of Russia's full-scale war in 2022, their operations have largely consolidated around undermining Ukraine at home and abroad, though some networks also focused on other countries in Russia's immediate vicinity such as Georgia, Moldova, and others. Additionally, since 2022, for-hire operators have shown a much stronger persistence. For example, in response to detection, the network known as Doppelganger has continued creating new assets. On Facebook, the Russian-run Doppelganger campaign uses text obfuscation and simple memes to evade automated keyword detection and test our systems. Russian operations continue to use Pages to spread influence campaigns, often utilising compromised Pages which have no topical or geographic relation to the message they are attempting to disseminate. Recently, a number of Russian operations engaged people, likely witting and unwitting, to create content and amplify harmful campaigns, in many countries (e.g., Armenia and across Europe).[149] ● **Cross-internet nature of CIB campaigns:** The vast majority of the CIB networks we disrupted globally tried to spread themselves across many online apps, including Facebook, YouTube, TikTok, X, Telegram, Reddit, Medium, Pinterest, and more. We've seen a number of influence operations shift much of their activity to platforms with fewer safeguards.[150] Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, Meta has dedicated election teams, deployed targeted tactics to manage known groups and attempts to engage in recidivist behaviour, and has a crisis management tool to help decide on

148 Meta Quarterly Adversarial Threat Report Q3 2024
149 Meta Quarterly Adversarial Threat Report Q4 2024
150 https://about.fb.com/news/2024/12/2024-global-elections-meta-platforms/

trends that should be deployed when conflicts arise.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Inauthentic Behaviour,* we have implemented a number of updates over the last year. We updated our Inauthentic Behaviour Community Standards in July 2024 to include detailed definitions of different prohibited behaviours on Meta's platforms (e.g., inauthentic distribution, inauthentic audience building, foreign inauthentic behaviour, inauthentic engagement). Additionally, Meta has implemented additional targeted system and product measures to address the risk of propagating false or misleading GenAI content, including visible labelling of AI-generated or edited content; building a feature for people to disclose when they share certain AI-generated media so we can label it; building invisible markers to help detect deep-fakes; and requiring advertisers running ads on social issues, elections, or politics to identify digitally altered and/or AI-generated content. We also implemented a number of in-product mechanisms to limit the spread of state-controlled media, including blocking ads; placing content lower in a user's feeds; and adding nudges that ask users to confirm they want to share or navigate to content from these outlets.

Given inauthentic behaviour is a complex area that is primarily behaviour driven, we focus on the actor's behaviour itself rather than the actual content. For example, we typically enforce against adversarial networks (e.g., a covert influence operation) at the network level rather than at the user level. At a user level, we provide explicit warnings to Facebook users through the platform user interface when they are demonstrating violating behaviour under some of our protocols.

To help manage this Problem Area, Meta leverages tools trained to detect and analyse behaviour related to coordinated threats. We actively maintain and track behaviour-based signals and indicators that we feed into our classifiers to detect coordinated activity. Findings are escalated to our investigation team for deep-dive analysis to identify recall gaps and support improvements. In early 2025, we updated a key indicator used to determine if an account is engaging in inauthentic behaviours, adopting a new index that allows greater flexibility against specific abuses. Additionally, Meta has a dedicated threat disruption working group which consists of product, policy, and investigation team members that analyse novel cases and false negatives to identify inauthentic behaviour trends. The output of the working group informs product teams as they adapt and mature our detection systems, which helps us identify other threat actors engaged in similar violating behaviours. We also monitor networks attempting to return to the platform after being previously removed. Some of these networks may attempt to create new off-platform entities (e.g., websites, social media accounts, etc.) as part of their recidivist activity. Furthermore, Meta has dedicated election teams, targeted tactics for managing known groups, and a crisis management tool (Athena) to help deploy mitigations when conflicts arise. Using both automated and manual detection, our teams are engaged in daily efforts to find and block threat actors' attempts to acquire new accounts, run ads, and share harmful links before these are ever seen by our users.

As an output resulting from some of our detection and enforcement efforts, Meta began publicly reporting on adversarial threats in 2017 when we first shared our findings about CIB by a Russian covert influence operation linked to the Internet Research Agency (IRA). Since then, we have identified and removed over 250 covert influence operations and evolved our capability to respond to a wider range of adversarial behaviours as global threats have continued to evolve.[151, 152] Within the time period of this report, we removed 17 additional covert influence operations. In September 2024, we banned Rossiya Segodnya, RT, and other related entities from our apps globally for violations of our policies prohibiting engaging in or claiming to engage in foreign interference.[153] In our Adversarial Threat Report for Q2 2024, we shared how Meta dealt with networks targeting the EU with disinformation, including three then-newly reported CIB networks originating from Russia, Doppelganger, and one CIB network originating from Vietnam.[154] In Q1 2025, we took action against a network of 658 accounts and 14 Pages on Facebook for violating our policy against CIB. This network originated in and targeted Romania across multiple internet services including Facebook. We detected and removed this activity before this operation was able to build an audience among authentic communities on our apps.[155]

Meta uses Facial Recognition Technology (FRT) to support account verification and detect impersonation and scams. FRT enables selfie-based authentication for secure, low-friction account recovery, and helps identify manipulated images and impersonation attempts—particularly of public figures who have consented to inclusion in detection systems.[156]

We remain vigilant and continue to monitor Facebook as threat actors and malicious tactics continue to evolve. One way in which we do

[151] Meta Quarterly Adversarial Threat Report - Q1 2023 to Q1 2025
[152] https://about.fb.com/news/2022/12/metas-2022-coordinated-inauthentic-behavior-enforcements/
[153] https://about.fb.com/news/2022/12/metas-2022-coordinated-inauthentic-behavior-enforcements/
[154] Meta Quarterly Adversarial Threat Report Q2 2024
[155] Meta Quarterly Adversarial Threat Report Q1 2025
[156] How We Are Using Facial Recognition Technology To Protect You From Scams That Use Your Image?

this is collaborating with the industry on common standards and guidelines. For example, we are a member of the Partnership on AI and, in 2024, we signed on to the Tech Accord, which aims to combat the spread of deceptive AI content during elections.[157] Furthermore, Meta leverages feedback from government authorities, law enforcement, research organisations, security experts, civil society, and industry peers to identify and stop emerging threats, inform our protocols and policies, and build new detection and enforcement tactics. Meta also allows vetted researchers to access our Influence Operations Research Archive, where they can analyse content from CIB networks that we've disrupted. As mentioned previously, we also share information from our investigations through our Adversarial Threat Reports to provide a more comprehensive view into the risks we tackle and ways in which we detect and counter malicious activity on the internet, as well as Community Standards Enforcement Report.

5.2.2.14 Intellectual Property (IP) Infringement

Meta takes intellectual property rights seriously and believes they are important to promoting expression, creativity, and innovation in our community. Meta requires its users to respect copyrights, trademarks, and other legal rights, as published in our Terms of Service, Intellectual Property Community Standard, and other applicable policies.

IP Infringement is associated with the Illegal Content Systemic Risk Area in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to adversely impact intellectual property rights, including copyright and trademark infringement. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, these risks are challenging to manage as enforcement of IP rights is primarily undertaken at the discretion of rights holders, which means that Meta relies extensively on reporting from rights holders to identify potential cases of infringement.

What are we doing to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, there were no new trends identified that could potentially impact the inherent risk exposure of risks within this Problem Area.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *IP Infringement*, while much of the violating content is proactively removed through Meta's automated systems, Meta strives to help businesses that use our platforms fight against brand impersonation, IP infringement, and infringing content. Meta has several tools to help rights holders protect their IP at scale.[158] Brand Rights Protection makes it easier for brands to protect their IP across all our platforms using cross-surface searching, which allows simultaneous searches across different platform areas, including ads, commerce, accounts, and posts and eliminates the need for repetitive search term entries, effectively optimising the process. Rights Manager helps Rights Holders manage and protect their copyrighted content at scale, such as performing automatic blocking of matching images and videos, image and video attribution to rights holders, and bulk actions, which allow for enforcement against multiple image reference files at once.[159]

In order to identify potential violations, we use various automated detection tools that take into consideration a range of different signals such as insights from machine-learning models, LLMs, and the presence of certain keywords associated with piracy and counterfeit activity and prior IP violations from problematic accounts.

To supplement our detection mechanisms and ensure quick and accurate handling of IP reports, we provide dedicated channels for rights

[157] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/02/how-meta-is-preparing-for-the-eus-2024-parliament-elections/
[158] https://www.facebook.com/business/help/611786833293457
[159] https://www.facebook.com/rights_manager

holders to report content they believe infringes their rights, including our online reporting forms available in our Help Centre. Additionally, we have custom forms dedicated to copyright, trademark, and counterfeit issues, which ensure that we receive all the information we need to process an IP report. Meta's IP Reporting API allows rights holders to automate and streamline the reporting of infringing content by filling out the same fields as Meta's IP reporting forms in a secure and trusted way. Furthermore, Meta provides rights holders with access to the IP Reporting Centre which allows them to save account information and reporting history to track and manage their reports more efficiently. Rights holders can report different types of content they identify on our platforms, ranging from individual posts, photos, videos, or advertisements to an entire profile, account, Page, Group, or event. Most reports submitted by a rights holder are processed by our IP Operations Team, which is a global team of trained professionals who provide coverage in multiple languages. If the report is complete and valid, the team will promptly remove the reported content and confirm that action with the rights holder or user that reported it. In specific instances, we use automation to close fraudulent reports or send correspondence.

From an enforcement perspective, only rights holders know with complete certainty what content is or is not authorised. However, if Meta has a strong basis to believe that something may be infringing, we take action—from removing or blocking the content, to disabling the responsible account, or removing it across all of our recommendation surfaces.

Lastly, Meta provides users with guidance to choose the tools that fit their needs in a section of its Business Help Centre dedicated to Intellectual Property Tools. We also have a section dedicated to Intellectual Property in our Help Centre where we provide guidance related to copyright and trademarks. When we take down content, we provide links to the Help Centre to help educate the user and prevent recidivism. Additionally, under the DSA Trusted Flagger programme, we have onboarded 13 trusted flaggers with expertise in intellectual property. Each of them has access to a dedicated priority channel to report illegal content within their area of specialisation.

5.2.2.15 Misinformation

Misinformation is different from other types of speech addressed in our Community Standard because there is no way to articulate a comprehensive list of what is prohibited. With graphic violence or hateful conduct, our policies specify the speech we prohibit, and even persons who disagree with those policies can follow them. With misinformation, however, we cannot provide such a line. The world is changing constantly, and what is true one minute may not be true the next minute. Additionally, people have different levels of information about the world around them, and may believe something is true when it is not.

Misinformation is associated with the Deceptive and Misleading, Civic Discourse and Elections, Public Health, and Public Security Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to promote and distribute false or misleading content including false or harmful information, content digitally created or altered in order to deceive, defraud or mislead the public. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, there is no society-wide consensus on what constitutes misinformation and how it should be addressed. User perspectives vary on what is false or misleading and similarly may differ as to whether enforcement is appropriate to safeguard information integrity versus the risk of limiting voice. Additionally, striking the right balance between protecting user voice and ensuring safety remains a critical challenge, particularly when addressing misinformation that poses an imminent risk of physical harm. We are continuously pursuing adjustments and improvements to our policies and systems, in order to reduce the spread of misinformation, while ensuring that we are not erroneously enforcing against users.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?

Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. It was identified that the high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, the use of generative AI, and crises in adjacent regions could increase the risk of misinformation on the platform.

Additionally, with an increase in GenAI use, there is an increase in risk that more users may upload organic content with photorealistic video or realistic-sounding audio that was digitally created or altered.

Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. Our measures against state-controlled media, in-feed labelling, and targeted user notifications are designed to reduce the distribution of misinformation. For example, Meta continues to monitor and manage trends in GenAI and crises in adjacent regions. We have dedicated election teams, keyword detection for content related to the EU elections, and have a crisis management tool to help identify trends that should be mitigated when conflicts arise.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Misinformation*, in order to manage this nuanced Problem Area, we apply our Remove, Reduce, Inform approach.[160] We remove misinformation or unverifiable rumours that clearly violate our Community Standards. In many countries, our technology can detect posts that are likely to be misinformation based on various signals, including how people are responding and how fast the content is spreading. It also considers if users flag a piece of content as "false information".

As a result of our misinformation policies and measures for the June 2024 EU Parliamentary elections, we treated over 11 million pieces of content on Facebook, with fact-checks in the month leading up to and including the electoral period. On average, 48% of people who started to share fact-checked content on Facebook did not complete this action after receiving a warning from Meta that the content has been fact-checked, demonstrating the impact of labelling efforts in reducing the spread of misinformation on both platforms. In addition, we removed over 3,000 ads for violating our misinformation policies.[161]

In May 2024, Meta began labelling a wider range of video, audio, and image content when we detect industry-standard AI-image indicators. If Meta determines that digitally created or altered image, video, or audio content creates a particularly high risk of materially deceiving the public on a matter of importance, we may add a more prominent label, so that people have more information and context. Throughout 2024, Meta launched a number of programme enhancements designed to improve our ability to combat misinformation in the paid advertising space. For example, we launched enhanced technical measures to detect and enforce against inauthentic accounts trying to run foreign-targeted political ads and compromised accounts trying to run targeted political misinformation ads.

To better inform people, Meta also implements proactive mechanisms that connect users to reliable information from trusted experts with the goal of countering misinformation. This is done through centralised hubs like our Information Centre, or Voting Information Centre. Specifically for the June 2024 EU Parliamentary Elections, Meta launched an in-app Voter Information Unit and provided Election Day Reminders directing people to local authoritative sources and reminding people to vote. Meta may also place election-related notifications in user's feeds on Facebook, such as voting day reminders. Meta also launched a media literacy initiative in the EU to educate people on how to better vet the information found online. As a part of our effort to remove misinformation or unverifiable rumours that contribute to the risk of imminent physical harm or violence, we work with Trusted Partners with experience in social media monitoring, an interest in learning about our Content Policies, and a commitment to keeping online communities safe. Additionally, Meta has a Misinformation Repeat Offender (MRO) Programme which limits the distribution of accounts that repeatedly share or publish content that is determined by third-party fact-checkers to be false or altered for a period of 90 days or longer if the account continues to share misinformation.[162]

As part of EU Parliamentary Elections efforts in June 2024, Meta engaged in several media literacy efforts including two campaigns in France. One example was a collaboration with the local fact-checking partner Agence France-Presse (AFP) Fact Check and participation in a multi-platform campaign operated by the French partner NGO Génération Numérique, consisting of a series of educational short videos gathering tips and recommendations on avoiding becoming a victim of misinformation. Additional efforts included wider campaigns with the EFCSN on how to spot AI-generated and digitally altered media, with the European Disability Forum (EDF).

5.2.2.16 Privacy Violations

Our services aim to protect the privacy and personal information of our users. We work hard to safeguard a user's personal identity and information and we do not allow people to post certain types of personal or

[160] https://transparency.meta.com/features/approach-to-misinformation
[161] https://transparency.meta.com/sr/european-parliament-report-2024
[162] https://socialmediaarchive.org/record/10/files/US2020_FB%26IG_Elections_External_Codebook.pdf

confidential information about themselves or others. We provide people with ways to report imagery that they believe to be in violation of their privacy rights. We also remove content that shares, offers, or solicits personally identifiable information or other private information that could lead to physical or financial harm, as described in our Privacy Violations Community Standard.

Privacy Violations is associated with the Protection of Minors and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being misused to adversely impact a minor's rights to the protection of personal data and respect for private and family life, as enshrined in the EU Charter. This can manifest on Facebook when the service is exploited by threat actors to search for and publish personally identifiable and private information without permission, a practice known as doxxing. This Problem Area also includes the risk of minors being exposed to threat actors attempting to access their data or target them with ads using unapproved data. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, the associated risks can be challenging to manage, and while Meta has robust safeguards in place for privacy, we also rely on user reporting to identify when a user's privacy may be at risk due to an adversarial actor. Additionally, as the regulatory landscape is constantly evolving, Meta needs to consistently monitor for changing or new laws. While Meta maintains safeguards to control what data is shared with third parties, it is difficult to control how data is used once shared, and threat actors may abuse Meta's platforms to obtain data through scraping and malicious links.

What are we doing to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, there were no new trends identified that could potentially impact the inherent risk exposure of risks within this Problem Area. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Privacy Violations*, since 2019, we have invested over $8 billion in our Privacy Programme and related initiatives and have grown the teams focused on privacy to more than 3,000 people.[163] We continue to keep the elements of our Privacy Programme up to date, by strengthening our governance and compliance functions, and leveraging our core technology expertise to address privacy at scale. We've continued to enhance the rigour and speed of our Privacy Review efforts which now cover review of an average of 1,400 products, features, and data practices every month.[164] Furthermore, our Privacy Risk Management Programme enables us to identify and assess privacy risks related to how we collect, use, share, and store user data. We leverage this process to enhance our Privacy Programme and to prepare for future compliance initiatives. As part of our Privacy Programme, we have designed safeguards, including processes and technical controls, to address privacy risks and we conduct internal evaluations on both the design and effectiveness of the safeguards for mitigating privacy risk. To help us track and manage remediation of privacy issues, we have established a centralised Privacy Issue Management function that spans the privacy issue management lifecycle from intake and triage, remediation planning, and closure with evidence. We have also established a Privacy Red Team who proactively tests our processes and technology to identify potential privacy risks. Part of ensuring that everyone understands their role in protecting user privacy at Meta is driving continuous privacy learning and education. At Meta, we have developed foundational, required privacy training and also maintain a catalogue of all formal privacy training deployed across Meta, which we review annually and make regular updates to. We disseminate privacy-related content (i.e. relevant updates) through a variety of internal communication channels. This includes updates from our privacy leadership, interactive Q&A sessions, and dedicated programming on Data Privacy Day. Furthermore, we have built tools to help users secure their information and make the right privacy choices, such as Privacy Check-Up, Two-Factor Authentication, and Why Am I Seeing This Ad, which provides more

[163] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/01/meta-8-billion-investment-privacy/
[164] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/01/meta-8-billion-investment-privacy/

transparency about how user activity may inform the machine-learning models we use to shape and deliver ads.

Meta has an Anti-Scraping Team dedicated to detecting, investigating, and blocking patterns of behaviour associated with scraping.[165] To combat data-scraping on our platforms, we implement rate limits and data limits. Rate limits restrict the frequency of interactions with Meta's services in a given amount of time, while data limits control the volume of data accessible to ensure it aligns with normal usage needs. Additionally, Meta's Bug Bounty Programme engages external researchers to identify and report security vulnerabilities, enhancing the protection of user data and platform security. This proactive approach is complemented by ongoing reviews of any additional user profiles to maintain robust privacy and security standards.[166] We also continuously work to improve and enhance our capabilities to implement further mitigations on Facebook, such as our Network Disruption approach, where we take down each adversarial network of accounts and Pages as a whole, rather than removing them piecemeal.

Lastly, our Privacy Centre has been designed to help users learn more about our approach to privacy across our apps and technologies so they can make better informed decisions about their privacy.

5.2.2.17 Restricted Goods and Services

At Meta, we prohibit attempts by individuals, manufacturers, and retailers to purchase, sell, raffle, gift, transfer, or trade certain goods and services on our platform. We do not tolerate the exchange or sale of any drugs that may result in substance abuse covered under our policies. Brick-and-mortar and online retailers may promote firearms, alcohol, and tobacco items available for sale off of our services; however, we restrict visibility of this content for minors. We allow discussions about the sale of these goods in stores or by online retailers, advocating for changes to regulations of goods and services covered in this policy, and advocating for or concerning the use of pharmaceutical drugs in the context of medical treatment, including discussion of physical or mental side effects as described in our Restricted Goods and Services Community Standard. Our Advertising Standard and Commerce Policy provides additional measures, which may limit the visibility of this content on our platform.

Restricted Goods and Services is associated with the Deceptive and Misleading, Civic Discourse and Elections, Public Health, Public Security, and Protection of Minors Systemic Risk Areas. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to purchase, sell, raffle, gift, transfer, or trade goods and services that could impact public health, potentially including firearms; alcohol, tobacco, prescription drugs and drug paraphernalia; adult sexual businesses such as adult entertainment, sexual enhancement products; hazardous goods and materials/explosives; gambling and games; and medical and healthcare products. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, this space can be challenging to manage as threat actors continuously use new ways to evade detection to offer or solicit restricted goods and services, and circumvent detection and enforcement methods. We consistently observe threat actors attempting to sell or solicit restricted goods and services in covert ways, such as using emojis, using slang in private Groups and Pages, signposting leading users to harmful external sites, and posting branded content as organic without paid / partnership labelling to circumvent our ad safeguards. Meta is continuously working to improve and enhance our capabilities to implement further mitigations on Facebook.

[165] https://www.meta.com/en-gb/actions/privacy-progress/
[166] https://www.meta.com/en-gb/actions/privacy-progress/

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2 Assessment. Meta continues to observe the trends of masking various scams as drug sales, increased risk of exposing minors to content related to alcohol, tobacco, and real money gambling, and threat actors targeting minors with weight loss products and cosmetic procedures. In addition, we observed the increase in videos, pictures, and ads sponsored by gambling companies featuring gambling branding in the background, but otherwise do not contain any gambling content (e.g., fortune tiger gambling ads, which don't have money in and out signals but were actually real money gambling ads). Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. For minors, Meta applies age-gating restrictions to content related to cosmetic and weight loss products or services, real money gambling and games, social casino games, free-to-play games with gambling context, alcohol, and tobacco, among others, and leverages age enforcement infrastructure to make this type of content less visible to them. Meta also has a long-term, age-appropriate content strategy to reduce minors' exposure to harmful and age-inappropriate content, and has invested in classifiers and infrastructure to support this solution. In the EU, ads are not currently served to minors. This year, we have particularly focused on reducing the exposure of youth populations to restricted goods and services content on Facebook. Our efforts include automated review mechanisms that analyse ads, sponsored Marketplace listings, for-sale posts, and other commerce listings, before they go live. These mechanisms proactively block policy-violating content using keyword detection and machine-learning models. Furthermore, we block hashtags where the hashtag name represents or is consistently used to share violating content. As a result, we assess views of violating content that contain restricted goods and services are very infrequent, and we remove much of this content before people see it. We continue to invest in enhancing our automation efforts. We are focusing more on mitigating our highest risks in this area (e.g., high risk drugs and gambling). We're also refreshing our models to ensure we keep performing at a high precision while reducing prevalence on the platform. Additionally, we deploy empty search results and enforcement interstitials for users searching restricted goods, such as high-risk drugs, guiding them to resources for reporting such content. In the first quarter of 2025, globally, 96.3% of violating content we actioned for Drugs and 97.8% for Firearms was detected and actioned on Facebook before users reported it. Additionally, in the first quarter of 2025, the upper limit for violations of our Restricted Goods and Services Policy for Facebook was 0.05%. This means that out of every 10,000 views of content on Facebook, we estimate no more than 5 of those views contained content in violation with our Restricted Goods and Services Community Standards.[167] We are improving our human review capacity to support machine-learning training efforts and specialised workflows for drugs. We also work with external stakeholders to source information on coded keywords used in the drug space to inform our reviewer guidelines. Meta has also been exploring programmes with external stakeholders and other tech companies (e.g., a cross-industry collaboration on illicit drugs with Snap including sharing adversarial behaviour signals using Media Match Service and Cross Problem Multimodal Matching). We also provide blueprint training modules for advertisers on different topics, such as alcohol. Advertisers can also sign up for an online course that explains how ads work and the restrictions that apply.

5.2.2.18 Spam

At Meta, we do not allow content that is designed to deceive, mislead, or overwhelm users in order to artificially increase viewership, as outlined in our Community Standard.[168] This type of content detracts from people's ability to engage authentically on our platforms and can threaten the security, stability, and usability

[167] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/regulated-goods/facebook/
[168] https://transparency.meta.com/policies/community-standards/spam/

of our services. We also seek to prevent abusive tactics, such as spreading deceptive links to draw unsuspecting users in through misleading functionality or code, or impersonating a trusted domain.

Spam is associated with the Deceptive and Misleading Systemic Risk Area in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to share deceptive or misleading content, artificially inflating viewership through fake engagement, or sharing duplicative and unwanted material. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, online spam is a lucrative industry, and our policies and detection must constantly evolve to keep up with emerging spam trends and tactics. Management of spam reporting is also complex and challenging as it's often a tactic utilised by threat actors to increase their likelihood of success by increasing the potential for human review error. Additionally, in taking action to combat spam, we seek to balance raising the costs for its producers and distributors on our platforms, with protecting the vibrant and authentic activity of our community.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2 Assessment. One persistent trend is that threat actors repeatedly spam user reporting systems with false reports and appeals. These actors continuously evolve their methods to circumvent policies and detection. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Similar to other Problem Areas Meta manages, we launch SNDs to help manage adversarial spamming, which involves in-depth identification of key offenders and enables disabling of multiple threat-related accounts at once. This can address coordinated attacks deployed at global level or local level. As mentioned previously, we are also investing more to remove accounts that coordinate fake engagement or fake pages that exist to inflate reach as well as exploring steps to lower the reach of accounts sharing spammy content.[169] For each type of content, we investigate the methods and behaviours conducted via adversarial spamming that attempt to abuse our systems, such as audio being created by models for spreading fake information. Enforcement remains the same irrespective of how content is generated, and trend-specific enforcements are proactively implemented using existing policies as a foundation. As a result of policy enforcement, globally, in the first quarter of 2025, 366 million pieces of spam content were actioned, with 99.2% of this content being found and actioned by us before users reported it.[170] Lastly, we develop and provide resources within the Meta Help Centre to guide users with understanding and identifying phishing, approaches to when users believe they have been phished, and how to proactively avoid scams and phishing.[171]

5.2.2.19 Suicide, Self-Injury and Eating Disorders

At Meta, we do not allow people to intentionally or unintentionally celebrate or promote suicide, self-injury, or eating disorders as described in our Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders Community Standard. However, we allow people to discuss these topics because we want Facebook to be a space where people can share their experiences, raise awareness about these issues, and seek support from one another, which creates challenges in managing and balancing voice and safety for this particular Problem Area.

[169] https://about.fb.com/news/2025/04/cracking-down-spammy-content-facebook/
[170] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/spam/facebook/
[171] Avoid Scams and Phishing Attempts

Suicide, Self-Injury, and Eating Disorders is associated with the Public Health and Protection of Minors Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to promote, speak positively, encourage, coordinate, or provide instructions for SSIED, potentially including ads that could impact public health. In some instances, this can manifest on our platforms in the form of content that coordinates and encourages engagement in SSIED*,* which could result in viral trends that impact public health. This also potentially includes: depictions of graphic self-injury, suicide attempts, death by suicide, instructions for extreme weight loss, content admitting to extreme weight loss behaviour when shared together with terms associated with eating disorders, depictions of body parts with terms associated with eating disorders, and content mocking victims or survivors of suicide, self-injury, and disordered eating. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, this space can be difficult to manage as intent can be challenging to assess and we are unable to always intervene or apply interstitials due to our privacy protection safeguards. Additionally, SSIED content is nuanced, and it is challenging to assess individual pieces of content without broader context and history, which limits the effectiveness of automation at scale. Furthermore, we are heavily reliant on user reporting as we cannot use our classifiers to proactively detect in Facebook groups, due to legal restrictions.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the assessment, there were no new trends identified that could potentially impact the inherent risk exposure of risks within this Problem Area. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, to stay informed, we engage with experts to refine our understanding and adapt to changing circumstances, while also acknowledging cultural differences in the use of terms across jurisdictions, such as variations in terms or emojis used between regions. We continuously collaborate with our Suicide and Self-Injury Expert Advisory Group and Trusted Partners to gain deeper insights into complex issues ensuring our approach remains effective and responsive to the evolving needs of our community. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *SSIED*, we have blocklists and banks of images that are regularly updated to help our detection and enforcement capabilities. When the content is not graphic or promotional but may still be upsetting (e.g., depicting healed cuts), we include a warning screen for sensitive content. To support addressing threats of real-world harm, we have an escalation pathway specific to this Problem Area called Credible Intent of Suicide (CIS), which sends resources to users who have posted content that is identified as being suicidal or self-harm related where we are able to, as well as shares information with Local Enforcement (LE) for welfare checks. This helps quickly identify and provide support to users who post content that indicates a CIS. Additionally, our Community Standards explicitly prohibit content that promotes or encourages SSIED. However, we allow content that discusses recovery and healing from self-injury, as it can be a supportive space for users to share their experiences and seek help. Our policy is flexible enough to handle both violating content and sensitive content. In particular, we have a specific approach for managing and identifying recovery content. In the first quarter of 2025, 6.8 million pieces of SSIED content were actioned globally, with 98.9% of this content being found and actioned by us before users reported it.[172] Furthermore, Meta maintains a repository of in-app mental health resources, including "The World Health Organisation (WHO) Digital Stress Management Guide", which provides easy-to-follow techniques designed to reduce stress and promote mental well-being. Our Emotional Health Hub offers an array of expert mental health tips and education related to suicide, anxiety, depression, and managing well-being.[173] We also offer eating disorder resources in our Safety Centre. Meta's resources have been updated to include more targeted

[172] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/suicide-and-self-injury/facebook/
[173] https://about.meta.com/actions/safety/topics/wellbeing/emotionalhealth/

country specific resources, including hotlines for SSIED. In addition, Meta partners with the Crisis Text Line to support SSIED crises. We have developed a resource that can be accessed via the Safety Centre called #Chatsafe which helps young users communicate safely online about SSIED and encourages awareness and reflection on difficult topics. We also have #Chatsafe for Educators to help them better equip young people to talk safely on social media about SSIED.

Meta also collaborates with suicide prevention experts, via its Global Suicide and Self-Injury Expert Advisory Group, to seek input on current research and best practices related to suicide and self-injury. We use these collaborations to inform our safety work as we develop new services and resources to support users who may be experiencing challenges relating to suicide and self-injury. This collaboration alongside Meta's external expert advisory group informs development of policies across our platform. Lastly, Meta partnered with the Mental Health Coalition to launch Thrive, a pioneering programme designed to enhance cross-platform collaboration in addressing suicide and self-harm content. Thrive enables participating tech companies to share signals about violating content, such as hashes of images and videos, to prevent its spread across different platforms.[174]

5.2.2.20 Violence and Incitement

At Meta, we do not allow language that incites or facilitates violence and credible threats to public or personal safety. This includes violent speech targeting a person or group of people on the basis of their protected characteristic(s) or immigration status. We remove content, disable accounts, and work with law enforcement when we believe there is a genuine risk of physical harm or direct threats to public safety. We provide further details regarding what content and activity is considered prohibited and the corresponding actions Meta may take against users in our Violence and Incitement Content Community Standard.

Violence and Incitement is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections, Public Security, and Gender-based Violence Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to incite violence, including against marginalised groups, promote kidnapping and abduction, disseminate instructions on how to use or make weapons or explosives, and promote or solicit services for hire to kill. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, Meta's policies are defined at a global level, which may result in complications for our content moderation mechanisms to understand the language and regional nuances in hostile and violent behaviour. Furthermore, threat actors circumvent detection and enforcement by using slang and emojis; therefore we may require additional information and/or context to enforce.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the Year 3 Assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in the Year 2 Assessment. The high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, along with the increase in anti-semitism, Islamophobia, anti-immigrant, and anti-refugee sentiment in the EU could increase the risk of violence and incitement on the platform, particularly against marginalised communities. Another example to note is the potential risk of over-enforcement as it relates to interactions between opposing sports teams when they use certain words such as "kill [the enemy team]". Additionally, younger users, such as Gen Z, may use terms or phrases that are not yet detectable by our systems. No net new trends or impacts have been identified since Year 2. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, we continue to improve our detection and enforcement capabilities by identifying and documenting words and idioms commonly used as implicit threats to help manage the trends and

[174] https://about.fb.com/news/2024/09/preventing-suicide-and-self-harm-content-spreading-online/

limitations mentioned above accordingly.

Problem Area Mitigation Overview: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, we have an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Violence and Incitement,* Meta has made changes to our Violence and Incitement Policy between August and September 2024, which includes an expanded definition of what is prohibited by our policy when we have additional information and/or context to enforce. We also clarified that in cases where threats are veiled or implicit, and the method of violence is not clearly articulated, the policy extends protection to situations where the target is a minor. Additionally, we updated our context-specific policies to allow threats of high- or mid-severity violence in the defence of self or another human when certain criteria are met. In the first quarter of 2025, globally, we have seen a decrease in actioned content for the *Violence and Incitement* Problem Area as a result of policy changes that allow for greater online discourse and actioned 3.4 million pieces of content related to violence and incitement, with 94.6% of this content actioned proactively before users reported.[175]

We have developed proactive detection and enforcement technology to help enforce our policies, such as Athena—a detection tool that provides a view of risks across our services before they become a bigger problem. The tool helps us take a proactive approach by highlighting early warning signs, such as unusually high classifier scores, accounts with multiple recent strikes, or an uptick in violent content. These signals are used by our Integrity Teams to craft proactive and reactive mitigations in response.

We assess high risk events using our Crisis Policy Protocol to identify those likely to pose a heightened risk of on-platform challenges. If we designate an event, we conduct an operational assessment to determine the scale and complexity of these risks and whether additional levers are required.

In terms of enforcement actions, we leverage a Strike System, where once the threshold for violating multiple policies is met, the user account will be removed. Additional enforcement actions include reducing visibility, device blocking, and account restrictions. Lastly, when a user's content is reported as hostile or violent speech and found to be violating, the user is notified of which policy they violated and may be given the ability to edit the post for potential reinstatement.

To help support users who may be experiencing abuse and/or violence, Meta has developed safety tools, such as the anonymous Domestic Violence Helplines in our Safety Centre where trained experts are available to offer support and specific guidance to create a safety plan. In addition, if Meta becomes aware of information giving rise to a suspicion that a threat to the life or safety of a person or persons exists, Meta promptly notifies the applicable authorities and provides relevant information in accordance with our Terms of Service, international standards, and applicable laws. In our Safety Centre under Crisis Support Resources, we provide a global directory of crisis support resources that was compiled in partnership with UN Women, the National Network to End Domestic Violence, and the Global Network of Women's Shelters to provide more urgent and expert support.

5.2.2.21 Violent and Graphic Content

At Meta, we are committed to preventing the dissemination of violent and graphic content that could lead to offline harm. Our policies prohibit the most graphic violent content of people, living or deceased, in non-medical contexts and sadistic remarks that express joy or pleasure from the suffering or humiliation of people or animals.

We recognise that users may share this type of content in order to shed light on or condemn human rights abuses, especially in the context of armed conflict. Our policies consider when content is shared in this context and allow room for users to discuss and raise awareness accordingly. We add warning labels to other types of content so that people are aware it may be sensitive before they click through. Additionally, we restrict the ability for minors to see content that may not be suitable or age-appropriate for them. We provide further details regarding what content and activity is considered prohibited and the corresponding actions Meta may take against users in our Violent and Graphic Content Community Standard (and other applicable policies).

[175] https://transparency.meta.com/reports/community-standards-enforcement/violence-incitement/facebook/

Violent and Graphic Content is associated with the Public Security, Protection of Minors, and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook being used to disseminate, promote, or possess content depicting graphic imagery and or explicitly violent behaviour of people and animals, violent acts, graphic violence, gore, or mutilation. This includes content depicting dismemberment, visible innards, or burning, which is flagged with a warning screen and restricted. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, the Violent and Graphic Content Policy relies primarily on visual indicators to detect and enforce on potential violating content. However, a small section of the policy relies on text based indicators whenever users post graphic imagery accompanied by sadistic remarks with humorous intent or showing enjoyment of human or animal suffering. The detection and enforcement of this policy line is difficult as text based elements require a more nuanced and contextualised assessment based on marketised humour and cultural practices.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and trends in 2025: During the assessment, net new trends were identified that impact this Problem Area. An increase in violent and graphic content as a direct result of armed conflicts around the world emerged as a trend. In the past year, we have seen an uptick in graphic imagery of humans originating from conflicts in Gaza. Notably, a growing trend has emerged globally, where users are posting content related to the conflict in Gaza, often accompanied by imagery depicting violent death and mutilation. Meta's dedicated teams continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and adapt our approaches as needed. For example, as a result of these emerging trends, we've developed internal protocols to prioritise content enforcement in high-risk situations, such as war zones, while respecting freedom of expression. We've also updated our policy definition of a "medical setting" to include medical tents, urgent care, and humanitarian aid. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, Meta has an extensive ecosystem of controls that work together to manage risks associated with this Problem Area on Facebook. For harms related to obscene content showing torture of humans and animals, mitigating controls include our global workforce of content reviewers and a variety of advanced detection tools for violent and or graphic content. Meta has been vigilant on periodically refreshing our automation detection and calibrating enforcements for animal abuse and animal rescue content. This includes integrating new data sources, refining our machine-learning models, and upgrading our infrastructure to improve detection and removal of graphic content. We've also optimised our image matching systems to ensure they align with our policies, enabling more effective protection for our users. We also encourage people to report such violating content. In conjunction, we leverage a Strike System, where once the threshold for violating multiple policies is met, the user account will be removed. Other enforcement actions include reducing visibility, device blocking, and account restrictions.

5.2.2.22 Voice and Free Expression

At Meta, we are committed to respecting our users' voices and helping them connect and share safely. Our Community Standard aims to create a place for expression and give people a voice.

Voice and Free Expression is associated with the Civic Discourse and Elections and Fundamental Rights Systemic Risk Areas in the DSA. This Problem Area relates to the risk of Facebook adversely impacting users' fundamental rights, specifically the right to freedom of expression and information as enshrined in the EU Charter. This can manifest on Facebook through over-enforcement of non-policy-violating content, disproportionate enforcement of policy-violating content, language/dialect limitations of human reviewers or classifiers, failure to take down policy-violating content, activity that limits or discourages a users' freedom of expression, and the inherent difficulty in balancing freedom of expression and safety concerns. Additionally, Meta evaluates government takedown requests for consistency with our policies and complies with legal obligations to notify the appropriate authorities when required. As it relates to persistent, ongoing challenges and adversarial behaviour inherent to this Problem Area, cultural norms, behaviours, and politics are challenging to navigate across regions as there may be different viewpoints and expectations to balance. For example, the European Human Rights Standard can, at times, be stricter than Meta's policies which are globally driven. Another challenge is how threat actors leverage product functionality to infringe on other user's voices, such as adversarial spamming in comments, reporting, harassment, and intimidation. However, we have robust processes in place which help manage these challenges accordingly.

What are we doing to try to prevent and mitigate these risks?
Considerations and Trends in 2025: During the Year 3 Assessment, it was identified that several trends continue to impact this Problem Area, similar to those observed in Year 2. The high number of elections in the EU, including the EU Parliamentary Elections, and crises in adjacent regions could increase the risk of voice and free expression on the platform, however it was determined that these factors do not impact inherent risk. In Year 3, we observed a change in the risk environment due to an increase in over-enforcement and false positives driven by the increasingly complex systems required to manage content. Meta has dedicated teams who continuously monitor the evolving risk landscape and work cross-functionally to adapt our approaches and implement necessary adjustments to our processes, as needed. For example, for elections, Meta put in place dedicated election teams to combat the likely increase in adversarial behaviour. **Problem Area Mitigation Overview**: As detailed in Section 5.2.1: Meta's Ecosystem of Controls, Meta employs an extensive ecosystem of controls to manage these Problem Area risks on Facebook. Specifically for *Voice and Free Expression*, the right to freedom of opinion and expression is fundamental to Meta's mission. Meta maintains processes and systems to gather user feedback and regularly reviews its approaches against international Human Rights Standards, such as Article 19 of the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR). We conduct human rights analyses on policy developments related to freedom of expression and prioritise input from marginalised communities by actively seeking feedback from diverse groups worldwide. This includes organising regional roundtables with representatives from marginalised communities and other stakeholders. Additionally, we apply an Inclusivity Framework to ensure diverse perspectives inform our policies and Community Standards. Meta's policies define what's allowed and not allowed on our platforms with freedom of expression as our north star. For example, Meta permits recovery content, such as healed wounds related to suicide and self-injury. Regarding minor voices, we collaborated with global data protection regulators and organisations—including the UN, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), and minors' rights groups to develop Meta's Best Interests of the Child Framework. This Framework outlines six key considerations for product teams during product development, including "empowering youth, parents, and guardians to understand and exercise their data rights". This includes supporting minor's autonomy, freedom of association and play, free expression, and identity exploration on Facebook. We monitor our content moderation enforcement to avoid unnecessarily restricting freedom of expression. We continuously improve AI models to detect hateful, violent and graphic content, and user enforcement technologies to determine whether to remove, demote, or escalate content for human review. When taking enforcement actions, we provide clear reasons and offer users the ability to appeal, except in cases involving severe safety concerns like child exploitation imagery. Appeals are reviewed through a combination of human and automated processes, with possible reinstatement if content complies with our Community Standards. If the original decision stands, users may further appeal to the Oversight Board, which helps balance free speech with policy enforcement. Consistent with our commitment to freedom of expression, in January 2025, Meta updated its Community Standards related to hateful conduct, formerly called hate speech, in order to enable more public debate and discussion about issues of political and social interest, such as immigration, gender identity, and gender, as well as to reduce over-enforcement concerns. The changes aim to enable a user's right to freedom of expression and information, and to better reflect user expectations, while continuing to maintain a safe and inclusive environment on our platforms that supports the right to non-discrimination. Meta provides dedicated reporting channels for users in the EU to submit legal removal requests to Facebook when they believe the content violates, for example, applicable hate speech laws in their

jurisdiction.[176]

6. Risk Mitigation Enhancements

As required by Article 35 of the DSA, Meta implements reasonable, proportionate, and effective mitigation measures to address Systemic Risks. We continuously evaluate our Integrity Ecosystem through various methods, including our DSA Systemic Risk Assessment Process, monitoring of controls, user feedback, and collaboration with experts.

In addition to our ongoing efforts to address Systemic Risks, we are also continuously enhancing our mitigation measures. In our Year 2 report we shared several mitigations that were implemented following the assessment. Below are some examples of enhancements implemented during the Year 3 assessment, which is not an exhaustive list.[177]

Enhancement Name	Enhancement Description
Detection	Meta refined classifiers with a high enforcement volume to optimise overall content moderation on the platform. In addition, Meta enhanced the HEx classifier by retraining it to improve detection of policy-violating content, including Organic and Ads across platforms, targeting violations such as Labour Exploitation and Human Smuggling.
Recommendation Surfaces	Meta has implemented automated keyword sourcing to identify for general search violations and improved enforcement on signposting accounts in Search and Recommendation surfaces, making it more difficult for bad actors to promote themselves.
Strike Policy Scope	Meta expanded the HEx Strike Policy to ensure that non-admin users can receive a strike or be disabled for any policy-violating content, regardless of whether they are an admin of the group.
Prevalence	Meta implemented a comprehensive framework to address emerging risks and protect user safety, including establishing a robust escalation process for drug-related content, enhancing enforcement of Deceptive Identity policies on Facebook to combat sextortion and online exploitation, and implementing targeted measures to reduce celebrity bait ads in its Ads Library.

[176] https://www.facebook.com/help/874680996209917/
[177] EU Digital Services Act: Systemic Risk Assessment Results Reports, September 2023 – August 2024, Facebook

Enhancement Name	Enhancement Description
	Meta has significantly increased the number of Facebook Groups correctly identified and enforced for violations of Child Safety policies, thereby demonstrating its commitment to safeguarding minors.
	Meta achieved a reduction in compromised account prevalence on Marketplace.
Support Functions	Meta reduced compromised accounts for invested users and developed a defensible end-to-end last resort account recovery experience for account access recovery when accounts are hacked or compromised.
Mistake Prevention	Meta expanded Mistake Prevention systems to include additional user groups and surfaces, including expanded support for sensitive entities (i.e. high-profile individuals) as well as enhanced the overall effectiveness of these systems.
Enhanced Escalation Processes	Meta has strengthened its approach to combatting sex trafficking by deploying engineering solutions that improve the escalation of sex trafficking-related cases. Additionally, Meta has developed comprehensive guidelines to empower human reviewers to accurately identify, enforce policies, and monitor Minor Sex Trafficking content. This enables tailored interventions for both minor and adult sex trafficking cases.
Research	Meta strengthened its processes by introducing robust accountability and review protocols for Social Issues UX Research. These improvements ensure that clear action plans are developed to address any potential risks identified through this research, and that cross-functional teams are actively involved in the approval of relevant action plans.
Transparency on Enforcement Policies	In November 2024, Meta published an update in the Transparency Centre regarding its approach to *Dangerous Organisations and Individuals*, detailing the criteria for designation.
	In December 2024, Meta announced an initiative to enhance transparency by better explaining its policies. Meta empowers users to deepen their understanding of our enforcement policies by enhancing transparency around account-level

Enhancement Name	Enhancement Description
	enforcement. Educational self-remediation features for first policy violation strikes have been launched, complementing existing information on strike severity available in the Transparency Centre.
	Meta expanded notifications related to content removals globally following the initial rollout to the EU. These notifications are shared with users when Meta restricts access to content in particular jurisdictions on the basis of formal government reports of alleged local law violations, except where we are legally prohibited from doing so.
Cross-Check Policies	As part of long term commitment, Meta will conduct periodic reviews of the cross-check system, including content with the longest time to resolution. We already conduct periodic sampling to determine where high-profile violating content is left on the platform.

7. Conclusion

This Report documents the findings of Facebook's third annual Systemic Risk Assessment as required under Articles 34, 35, and 42 of the DSA. In Year 3, we assessed 71 risks across 22 Problem Areas through an improved methodology. Our risk management measures are effective, but we continue to refine and enhance them.

As part of our maturing Integrity GRC Programme, we are prioritising improvements in areas where risks remain elevated—focusing on targeted mitigation where needed.

Looking ahead, we remain committed to transparency and continuous improvement. We will continue to evolve our risk governance practices, collaborate with the European Commission and other stakeholders, and work toward the shared goals of minimising harm, protecting people's rights, and strengthening public trust in digital services.

8. Appendix

8.1 Risk Assessment Process

As part of Meta's Integrity Risk Management Framework, Meta has a Risk Assessment Process and Methodology designed to enable Meta to operationalise Risk Assessments for multiple integrity Problem Areas in a standardised and scalable manner. The Risk Assessment Process detailed below explains the steps to conduct Risk Assessments at Meta, including the assessment of Systemic Risks that can materialise on Meta's services.

Our Risk Assessment Process consists of six steps and is used consistently to execute Risk Assessments, including our annual Systemic Risk Assessment. Outlined below is an overview of the annual Systemic Risk Assessment Process:

- **Identify and Qualify:** Meta leveraged a diverse set of signals and inputs to scope the risk assessment. These inputs were used to define the in-scope Problem Areas and the associated risks that collectively create a systemic risk to users in the EU.
- **Assess:** Meta leveraged a combination of risk and control effectiveness signals including surveys, Problem Area workshops, questionnaire, documentation review, external input, Integrity Issues, Assurance Testing, CIRA, Metrics and Data, and Integrity Control Self-Assessment (ICSAs) to understand how the overall risk landscape, including current and emerging risks and the control environment, changed over the last year using a standardised Risk Assessment framework.
- **Measure:** Using the results from the assess phase, Meta finalised the list of relevant in-scope risks and calculated the inherent risk and effectiveness of the controls in place to mitigate the risks using Meta's Risk Measurement Framework. See Appendix 8.2 for more information on Meta's risk and control measurement approach.
- **Validate:** Meta documented the results and engaged with stakeholders to validate the findings.
- **Respond and Mitigate:** In conjunction with inputs from other risk management efforts, Meta worked cross-functionally (and does so on a routine basis) to determine mitigation priorities and determine what is reasonable, proportionate and effective to reduce residual risk on Facebook.
- **Report:** Meta documented the findings and results in a detailed report.

8.2 Rubrics and Scoring

8.2.1 Inherent Risk Rubrics

The following measurement approach is used to determine inherent risk.

8.2.1.1 Severity Rubrics

The Severity Rubric is used to measure the level of impact the risk has on users and society.

IMPACT (SEVERITY) RUBRIC

NAME	DEFINITION	TIER 1 (L)	TIER 2 (M)	TIER 3 (H)	TIER 4 (VH)	TIER 5 (EH)
Scale	Harm is likely to be more severe when it impacts more people. Harm is considered least severe when impact is isolated to Meta systems or processes.	Isolated to Meta systems or processes	Isolated to individuals	Ramifications to segments or across industries	Broad ramifications to democratic processes/systems, way of life, societal norms, public safety	Severe ramifications to healthcare or finance sector; or country level critical infrastructure impact; broader society stability
Harm Type	Harm is most severe when it impacts offline life. Harm is more severe for humans than it is for businesses and the platform. Prioritise targets of harm, then viewers of harm.	General Meta user experience	Economic impact (individuals ability to earn an honest living, maintain financial health, pursue legitimate business interests)	Impact to democratic systems	Physical and psychological impact	Impact to fundamental rights - such as Human Dignity, Freedom of Expression, Non-Discrimination, Rights of the Child, etc.
Vulner-ability of Impacted People	Harm is more severe when vulnerable and/or defenseless groups are the target (e.g., children, marginalised groups) or impacts specific people/ groups of people.	General users, Developers	Elements of society	Society at large	Specific targeting of societal groups	Minors/Children; Marginalised groups (e.g. Women, People with disabilities, elderly)
Intention-ality	Harm is more severe if committed intentionally and with the purpose of causing harm.	Benign / unintentional action	Intention is to cause financial harm to a person or group of people	Intention is to cause psychological harm to a person or group of people	Intention is to cause physical harm to a person or group of people	Intention is to cause widespread harm to people and/or society

8.2.1.2 Likelihood Rubrics

The Likelihood Rubric is used to measure the possibility that a given risk will occur in a specified timeframe.

LIKELIHOOD RUBRIC

	40% TIER 1	50% TIER 2	60% TIER 3	90% TIER 4	100% TIER 5
Scope	Risks can be seen by <5% of people in a given scope **MAU** = <5% of population	Risks can be seen by >5% of people in a given scope on platforms with limited reach **MAU** = 5 - 10% of population	Risks can be seen by >5% of people in a given scope on public platforms **MAU** = 5 - 10% of population	Risks can be seen by >10% of people in a given scope on platforms with limited reach **MAU** = >10% of population	Risks can be seen by >10% of people in a given scope on public platforms **MAU** = >10% of population
Volume	Risk is rarely seen by users on the platform and must be deliberately searched for	Risk is infrequently seen by users on the platform	Risk is sometimes seen by users on the platform	Risk is often seen by users on the platform	Risk is persistently seen by users on the platform

The following limitations should be considered when evaluating the likelihood of a risk arising:

- Likelihood is a subjective, qualitative measure and does not guarantee a risk will occur;
- All users are not equally likely to be impacted by the same Problem Area; and
- Volume is primarily assessed from a qualitative perspective as indicated by the absence of quantitative thresholds within the relevant tiers. The volume sub-category is designed to reflect anticipated frequency at which users may be impacted by a risk if it materialises on the platform without the application of controls, while taking into account that this cannot be definitely measured as controls have been in place on Meta’s platforms for many years. Where available, validated data may be used to help provide insight into the relative differences in volume at the risk or Problem Area level to ensure relative scores between these areas are sensible. However, it should be noted that there are a number of limitations with this data.

8.2.2 Control Effectiveness Rubrics

These questions aim to prompt the evaluator to enable a qualitative assessment of the effectiveness of controls in place to manage a risk.

Applicability	Is the control required based on the risk profile and applicable risk factors for the service?
Appropriateness	Does the control exist and is it built in a robust manner to mitigate the risk of all in-scope problem areas?
Coverage	Does the control cover all the in-scope sub-services and applicable problem areas?
Documentation	Is there record of the control development process?
Balance	Is the control designed with a balance of recall and precision?
Review and Monitoring	Are there set performance targets and is the control periodically tested against it?
Resourcing	Are there sufficient resources deployed to effectively implement the control?
User Rights	Is the control designed in a way to safeguard user's rights to freedom of expression and privacy?
User Friendly	Is the control easily accessible, understandable, and usable by the users?

8.2.2.1 Control Effectiveness Calculation

Once the effectiveness for each control is determined, the following measurement approach is used to calculate the effectiveness of the control suite.

1 Principles

1. **Limits, not Maximums** - While we can approach 100% effectiveness, it would be unlikely to actually achieve
2. **Diminishing Marginal Returns** - It should be increasingly difficult to improve the overall effectiveness
3. **Additive** - Introducing additional Controls should add to the overall effectiveness of the Control Suite

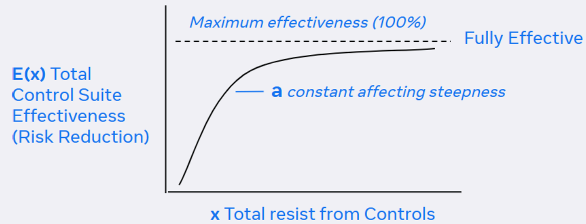
Control Groups

- Controls may be operating effectively and **fit-for-purpose**, but mitigate less risk relative to others. When deriving the total additive value of all in-scope controls, a **weighted sum** is taken to balance this reality

2 Calculation

- **E(x)** is the total control suite effectiveness
- **x** is the total additive resist value of all in scope Controls
- **a** is a constant that affects the steepness of the curve

$$E(x) = 1 - e^{-ax}$$



3 Illustrative Example

Step 1 | *Columns A-C*	Controls are mapped to Risks and Capabilities	
Step 2 | *Columns D-E*	Capabilities are scored based on metrics, where available	
Step 3 | *Columns F-G*	Capability scores are assigned a Confidence Tier based on the reliability of available signals	
Step 3 | *Column H-K*	Qualitative signals (First Principle Issues) modify the initial Capability score at the individual Control level	
Step 4 | *Column L*	The Resistance (contribution) of a control is then a combination of the Effectiveness and Weight.	
Step 5 | *Column M*	The Total Resistance of applicable controls sums up the Resistance contributions.	
Step 6 | *Final Column*	Control Suite Effectiveness converts this resistance to a percentage using an exponential function.	

a	*1 / (# of Integrity Controls)*

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J *IF(F>4,-3,IF(F>2,-2,IF(F>0,-1,0)))*	K *G * J*	L *E + K*	M *Sum(L:L)*	*E(x) = 1 -e^-ax*
			1LoD Signal				2LoD Signal						
Risk	**Capability**	**Control**	**Metric**	**Capability Score**	**Metric Confidence Tier**	**Adjustment Weight**	**Tested / I-CSA?**	**Count of First Principle Issues**	**Unweighted GRC Modifier**	**GRC Modifier**	**Control Score** *(Resist)*	**Total Resistance** *(x)*	**CSE %**
Risk A	**A2** *Proactive Solutions to Address Violations*	Control 1	**Proactive Rate**	6	1	20%	Yes	1	-1	-.2	5.8	66.3	73%
		Control 2		6	1	20%	No	0	0	0	6		
		Control 3		6	1	20%	Yes	0	0	0	6		
		Control 4		6	1	20%	Yes	6	-3	-.6	5.4		
		Control 5		6	1	20%	Yes	0	0	0	6		
		Control 6		6	1	20%	Yes	0	0	0	6		
		Control 7		6	1	20%	Yes	0	0	0	6		
		Control 8		6	1	20%	Yes	1	-1	-.2	5.8		
		Control 9		6	1	20%	Yes	1	-1	-.2	5.8		
	A5 *Ability to disrupt coordinated networks*	Control 10	*N/A*	7	3	50%	Yes	0	0	0	7		
		Control 11		7	3	50%	Yes	1	-1	-.5	6.5		

8.2.3 Residual Risk Calculation

The following measurement approach is used to determine residual risk.

$$\text{Inherent Risk} - \left(\text{Inherent Risk} \times \text{CSE \%}\right) = \text{Residual Risk}$$

8.3 Principles for ensuring Reasonable, Proportionate, and Effective Mitigation Measures

One way to approach making informed decisions to determine whether to invest in deploying a mitigating measure or enhancement is by considering the principles below. When making such a determination, we consider the impacts on fundamental rights.

Criteria	Mitigation Measure	Further Details
Reasonable	• Within Meta's control to deploy with limited dependencies on external parties or non-Meta entities • Appropriate, fair, and designed to address integrity risks or issues	Due to the residual risk exposure and/or the extreme criticality of a control in managing a systemic risk, it is appropriate to make investments to adapt, test, reinforce, initiate, adjust, and/or make changes to our systems, processes, and/or activities.
Proportionate	• Adequate, relevant, suitable and necessary to address specified systemic risks • Not excessive in relation to a declared and specified purpose and residual risk exposure	The investment needed from a financial, technical, and operational perspective is commensurate with the current risk exposure or the risk exposure that will be created if the investment is not made. Additionally, in instances where rights, including fundamental rights, are in tension with a potential mitigation measure, a decision about a mitigation measure is based on the correlative impact a risk could have on users within the EU and society.
Effective	• Able to prevent, mitigate, or control the residual risk exposure as designed and intended • Able to be monitored in order to measure its effectiveness	The investment needed to adapt, test, reinforce, initiate, adjust, and/or make changes to our systems, processes, and/or activities will effectively reduce the residual risk exposure of a systemic risk.